

The Holy Spirit: Eleven Bible Classes

Jim Brinkerhoff, Auburn Christian Student Center, Spring 2011

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These files are edited from Whisper AI transcriptions of eleven Bible classes. The cleanup preserves the informal cadence of a live class while correcting obvious transcription errors, adding structure, and identifying major Scripture references. Bible quotations are set off in source notes when the passage is clearly being quoted; the audio does not consistently identify a translation, so most are marked as NIV-like or version not stated.

Table of Contents

Class	Source File	Title	Summary
1	hs01.txt	The Forgotten God and the Spirit's Personhood	Jim opens the series by challenging the habit of ignoring the Holy Spirit. He begins with the Shema, the Trinity, and the Spirit as a personal divine being, then introduces the class refrain: the Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ.
2	hs02.txt	The Spirit of Truth in the Words of Jesus	The second class works through Jesus' promises in John 14-16. The Spirit is the Paraclete, teacher, witness, and convicting presence whose ministry points away from himself and toward Jesus.
3	hs03.txt	Receiving the Spirit: Faith, Jesus, Baptism, and Fullness	Jim begins the question of how Christians receive the Holy Spirit. He argues from Romans, Psalm 51, Galatians 3, John 7, Acts 2, and Colossians 2 that the Spirit is received by grace, in the beginning, through faith centered on Jesus.
4	hs04.txt	Fullness in Christ and the Washing of Rebirth	This class completes the receiving-the-Spirit question. Jim connects 1 Corinthians 12, Colossians 2, Titus 3, and John 3 to present faith, baptism, fullness in Christ, and the Spirit's renewal in the new birth.

Class	Source File	Title	Summary
5	hs05.txt	What Does the Spirit Do? History, Hysteria, and Holiness	After showing the Toronto Blessing as a case study, Jim traces a theological family tree from Wesleyan perfectionism through revivalism, the holiness movement, Pentecostalism, and the charismatic movement. He then turns the question back to sanctification and the body as the Spirit's temple.
6	hs06.txt	Sanctification, Scripture, and the Spirit's Power	Jim develops the Spirit's sanctifying work through Romans 6-8, Philippians 2, 2 Thessalonians 2, and 1 Thessalonians 4. The Spirit does not replace human effort or Scripture; he works through the word to empower a holy life.
7	hs07.txt	Hope, Intercession, Seal, and Power	The seventh class moves from sanctification to hope. Jim teaches Romans 8 on groaning and the Spirit's intercession, Ephesians on the Spirit as seal and deposit, and several texts on the Spirit's power to form endurance, patience, joy, and hope.

Class	Source File	Title	Summary
8	hs08.txt	Acts Begins: Mission, Pentecost, and the Message of Jesus	Jim turns to Acts, where the Spirit empowers mission from Jerusalem to the ends of the earth. Pentecost is presented as a unique public event whose miraculous signs serve the Spirit-inspired message of Jesus.
9	hs09.txt	Samaria and the Gospel Across the First Barrier	Acts 8 becomes Jim's first major test case for interpreting unusual Spirit events. He argues that the Samaritan episode is not a normal conversion pattern but a unique bridge over Jewish prejudice, publicly marking Samaritans as equal recipients.
10	hs10.txt	Cornelius and the Gentile Breakthrough	The Cornelius account in Acts 10-11 is treated as another decisive bridge. God uses visions, Peter's reluctant obedience, the Spirit's visible coming, and the church's response to show that Gentiles are received without becoming Jews.

Class	Source File	Title	Summary
11	hs11.txt	Acts 19, Baptism in the Holy Spirit, and Experience Tested by Scripture	The final transcript studies the disciples of John in Acts 19, summarizes Jim's view that salvation is an organic whole, explains baptism with the Holy Spirit as the historic outpouring begun at Pentecost, and then weighs Jim's own charismatic experience against Scripture.

Scripture Index

Scripture	Discussed In	External Passage
Genesis 11:1-9	Class 8	Open passage
Genesis 1:2	Class 1	Open passage
Genesis 1:26	Class 1	Open passage
Leviticus 20:25-26	Class 10	Open passage
Deuteronomy 6:4-5	Class 1	Open passage
1 Samuel 16:13	Class 3	Open passage
2 Kings 17	Class 9	Open passage
Psalms 113-118	Class 3	Open passage
Psalms 119:11	Class 6	Open passage
Psalms 51	Class 4	Open passage
Psalms 51:11	Class 3	Open passage
Isaiah 12:3	Class 3	Open passage
Isaiah 44:3	Class 3	Open passage
Daniel 1	Class 9	Open passage
Joel 2:28-32	Class 1, Class 2, Class 8, Class 11	Open passage
Matthew 28:18-20	Class 8	Open passage
Matthew 3:11	Class 11	Open passage
Matthew 3:16-17	Class 1	Open passage
Mark 7:18-19	Class 10	Open passage
John 14:15-17	Class 2	Open passage
John 14:16-17	Class 1	Open passage
John 14:25-26	Class 2	Open passage
John 14:26	Class 1	Open passage
John 15:26-27	Class 1, Class 2	Open passage
John 16:13-15	Class 2	Open passage
John 16:7	Class 8	Open passage
John 16:7-15	Class 1	Open passage
John 16:8-11	Class 2	Open passage

Scripture	Discussed In	External Passage
John 17:20-23	Class 1	Open passage
John 17:6-20	Class 2	Open passage
John 3:3-5	Class 4 , Class 5	Open passage
John 4	Class 9	Open passage
John 7	Class 4	Open passage
John 7:37-39	Class 1 , Class 3	Open passage
Acts 10-11	Class 9	Open passage
Acts 10:1-48	Class 10	Open passage
Acts 10:39-42	Class 1 , Class 2	Open passage
Acts 10:44-48	Class 11	Open passage
Acts 11:1-18	Class 10	Open passage
Acts 11:15-18	Class 11	Open passage
Acts 15	Class 3 , Class 8	Open passage
Acts 16	Class 11	Open passage
Acts 16:6-7	Class 8	Open passage
Acts 18:24-28	Class 11	Open passage
Acts 19:1-7	Class 10 , Class 11	Open passage
Acts 1:1-26	Class 8	Open passage
Acts 1:1-3	Class 2	Open passage
Acts 1:1-8	Class 1	Open passage
Acts 1:4-5	Class 11	Open passage
Acts 1:8	Class 8 , Class 9	Open passage
Acts 2	Class 9 , Class 10	Open passage
Acts 2:1-39	Class 2	Open passage
Acts 2:1-41	Class 8	Open passage
Acts 2:16-18	Class 11	Open passage
Acts 2:38-39	Class 1 , Class 3 , Class 4	Open passage
Acts 6	Class 9	Open passage
Acts 8	Class 11	Open passage
Acts 8:1-25	Class 9	Open passage
Acts 9	Class 8	Open passage
Romans 14:17-18	Class 7	Open passage
Romans 15:13	Class 7	Open passage
Romans 6	Class 6	Open passage
Romans 7	Class 6	Open passage
Romans 8	Class 4 , Class 5	Open passage
Romans 8:1-14	Class 6	Open passage
Romans 8:18-30	Class 7	Open passage
Romans 8:9	Class 3	Open passage
1 Corinthians 12-14	Class 5	Open passage
1 Corinthians 12:12-13	Class 1 , Class 4	Open passage
1 Corinthians 15	Class 5 , Class 7	Open passage
1 Corinthians 15:14-20	Class 11	Open passage
1 Corinthians 1:10-17	Class 2	Open passage
1 Corinthians 6:18-20	Class 5 , Class 6	Open passage
2 Corinthians 12:7-10	Class 7	Open passage
Galatians 3	Class 4	Open passage
Galatians 3:1-5	Class 3 , Class 11	Open passage

Scripture	Discussed In	External Passage
Galatians 5:16-25	Class 5	Open passage
Galatians 5:22-23	Class 6 , Class 7	Open passage
Ephesians 1:13-14	Class 7	Open passage
Ephesians 1:19-20	Class 7	Open passage
Ephesians 3:16-17	Class 7	Open passage
Ephesians 4:30	Class 5 , Class 6	Open passage
Philippians 2:12-13	Class 6	Open passage
Philippians 4:7	Class 7	Open passage
Colossians 1:11-12	Class 7	Open passage
Colossians 2:6-15	Class 3	Open passage
Colossians 2:8-15	Class 4	Open passage
1 Thessalonians 4:1-8	Class 6	Open passage
1 Thessalonians 5:19	Class 5 , Class 6	Open passage
2 Thessalonians 2:13	Class 6	Open passage
Titus 3:4-7	Class 4	Open passage
1 Peter 1:1-2	Class 5	Open passage

Quote Verification Notes

Source	Verification Note	Classes
A. W. Tozer, The Counselor	Verified source for the personhood wording; the transcript paraphrases the quote.	Class 1
R. A. Torrey, The Person and Work of the Holy Spirit	Verified in the public-domain text; the transcript paraphrases the contrast.	Class 1
Attributed in the transcript to Francis Schaeffer	Not verified as Schaeffer. The statement appears in several forms, but I did not find a reliable primary citation tying it to Schaeffer.	Class 1
Francis Chan, Forgotten God	Verified in widely quoted excerpts and reviews of the book; the transcript paraphrases it.	Class 6 , Class 7

Class 1: The Forgotten God and the Spirit's Personhood

Original transcript: `hs01.txt`

Summary: Jim opens the series by challenging the habit of ignoring the Holy Spirit. He begins with the Shema, the Trinity, and the Spirit as a personal divine being, then introduces the class refrain: the Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ.

Key Scripture References

- [Deuteronomy 6:4-5](#)
- [Genesis 1:2](#)
- [Genesis 1:26](#)
- [Matthew 3:16-17](#)
- [1 Corinthians 12:12-13](#)
- [John 7:37-39](#)
- [John 14:16-17](#)
- [John 14:26](#)
- [John 15:26-27](#)
- [John 16:7-15](#)
- [John 17:20-23](#)
- [Acts 1:1-8](#)
- [Acts 2:38-39](#)
- [Acts 10:39-42](#)
- [Joel 2:28-32](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

The Holy Spirit is a person. He is not enthusiasm, courage, energy, or a personification of good qualities.

– [A. W. Tozer, The Counselor](#). Verified source for the personhood wording; the transcript paraphrases the quote.

If the Spirit is treated as a power, the question becomes how to use him; if he is a divine person, the question becomes how he will use us.

– [R. A. Torrey, The Person and Work of the Holy Spirit](#). Verified in the public-domain text; the transcript paraphrases the contrast.

How many churches and ministries would carry on as usual if dependence on the Holy Spirit and prayer disappeared from the New Testament?

– Attributed in the transcript to Francis Schaeffer. Not verified as Schaeffer. The statement appears in several forms, but I did not find a reliable primary citation tying it to Schaeffer.

Cleaned Transcript

We are here for a class on the Holy Spirit. First of all, class, you hear the word class, you think sitting here in some sort of, you know, academic environment, me downloading some information and then moving away from this and find something else to learn to download on top of that, go to another event download on top of that. In a way, we should probably not talk about having classes in the Kingdom of God. I'm not sure what to call them. Discipling moments are really better the way to define them. Discipling in Jesus' mind not only affected what you thought but affected how you lived. And this is not simply a

cerebral exercise. Although in saying that I will strongly encourage you and I see some of you have this and I will encourage you to do it. I hope you read my email. I meant what I said in that thing.

I just kind of prepare your mind that this is, you know, this thing, you have to engage this thing. I'm not teaching a graduate course on theology on the Holy Spirit although many of the things that would be in a graduate class, I'm going to talk about. And because it's important and you'll find in, you know, if you think clearly, you act clearly. That's the way Christianity is framed. You'll notice that Paul and all of his letters, if you pay attention, he always gives us kind of a deep theology. And then he says now because of all of this way of thinking, the way God wants you to think, here's how to fix your life on a practical level. Well, I will try to mimic that framework as well. But it starts with your ability to think healthily and substantially and with integrity.

And I'm hoping to kind of draw you along with some of this. But part of that is, take some notes. You're not going to remember this next week. All these things I'm going to get into. Any more than you can download it unless you have photographic memory and everything you hear, everything you read just as implanted. And you can recall it a year later. 99.999% of the people in the face of the earth cannot do that. That means we actually have to write notes. We have to memorize. We have to study. We have to rethink it through. I have multiple exposures to it before it actually begins to make sense and go through this learning curve.

So please, please, do more than just sit there. And don't go to sleep. Stay home and take a nap if that's what you want to do. Get in here. Let's engage this thing. Let's make this thing happen. And God has some things for you. And I am going to do my best to begin to ease into this and hopefully share some things. Obviously this is not exhaustive. I was literally on some very serious levels and on some very intense levels. I was studying the Holy Spirit ever since I was in college. And since about the age of 23, which I will reflect on here in just a little bit, explain why that was true. I am 53 now. I have read more books on it than I can mention to you. Things I get, things I don't get, things I am perplexed by and things that I have changed my mind on.

I haven't taught in Holy Spirit in a few years. Probably four years, five years. I've taken four or five years. I've kind of changed and tweaked some things. And so left and I taught it. It can be a little bit different than I taught it back then. But I still have somewhat the same framework on trying to ease into this thing. As I called in the email, the kind of a Holy Spirit 101. So let me start with two questions. How many of you have ever had a class? I don't mean just one, but a series of classes, a study on the Holy Spirit. Go ahead and raise your hand.

How many of you had raised your hand? Or raised your hand because you were involved in that small group that studied, forgotten God last semester? And you went in that small group last semester. Okay, some of you. That would count by the way. It was a whole semester kind of going through and looking at some basic premises, the Francis Chan talked about. Well, let me, let us kind of go here. Title of that book was forgotten God. I think that's a legitimate title dealing with this issue. Francis Schaeffer said this and I'm somewhat resonating with this.

How many churches and ministries would not even notice? And would carry on exactly the same manner as usual. Even though every reference to the dependence on the Holy Spirit and to prayer were suddenly to disappear from the page of the New Testament, get the idea. I think when it comes down to those of us who claimed to have certain beliefs about the Holy Spirit, if you're like me growing up as I have in church, why I heard very little of anything about the Holy Spirit. It was, in my heritage, basically, it wasn't ignored. It was purposely and intentionally sidestepped. And to my deep regret. And I think there are certain reasons for that. Perhaps because of all the aberrations, the things associated with the Holy Spirit that seemed to be excessive and so to stay away from some of those excesses is to basically the theology or the principle of the philosophy.

It's just don't talk about it, then you don't have to worry about stepping off in the wrong direction. Because when you start talking about it, then people start thinking about it, then they start doing things they ought not do. Although I don't think anyone would actually say that's what they do, I feel that's basically behind much of the disappearance of the Holy Spirit in our dialogue. At least those of us who grew up in the restoration movement, churches of Christ, although in the early part of the restoration movement, it was a very prevalent talk about and recurring theme. But by the time I came around, born in 1957 in that church context, other than saying this is what it doesn't do, there was really very little said about it. And so I really grew up rather ignorant about this. But I will tell you that the truth is, not talking and not studying something and not opening your mind and going through a learning curve on any issue of scriptures doesn't, you know, that silence doesn't save you from, you know, going down distracted and false pathways.

I think it makes you vulnerable to that. I think when we actually start engaging the words of God and actually engaging and trying to explore what this means, what the Spirit means in my life, I find myself more capable of sifting through and filtering and coming from understanding and I think prevents me in many ways from getting off into things that are just, you know, maybe not associated with the Spirit that perhaps so often is said, belongs to it. And, anyway, having gone up in that, when I got to college, you know, I left God when I was in high school, really in junior high, I came to college, God found me, I found Him. And in the context of that, I, when I came back into the, you know, searching for God and asking the hard questions in my life and, you know, people like C. S. Lewis and Francis Schaeffer and people like that trying to, you know, that I read and got me to thinking again and processing who is Jesus and really being convicted. Yeah, he actually is who he claims to be.

I really started believing it. I did so in the context I started visiting churches for about three, four years. I was very deeply involved in what people would term a charismatic church background. And so I began to encounter almost the, almost the antithesis of the church of Christ, which was my fundamental upbringing, where I was in a church context where the Holy Spirit was almost every other word. I was spirit this, spirit that, spirit was, you know, everywhere doing things. And it was overwhelming. And I will, and I will be sharing about some of those experiences and it is influencing some of my thinking, but how I look at certain scriptures. And so I share a part of that because I bring some of those things up. I want you to know that I'm not just speaking hypothetically, but I've read someone else doing.

I've actually engaged those things. And so all those things that you've heard about, I've probably done, or believed, on some level or another, in a serious enough way, that I can tell you how I got to believing, whatever. And I said, well, we'll kind of sift through some of that and talk about it. I also emerged with a much more, I don't know, active understanding of what the spirit is doing in my life. I think when it comes down to us, if we have any view of the Holy Spirit at all, which is probably downloaded, not really searched and thought out for most people, it's really like God just kind of gave us a paperweight as, you know, congratulations for joining the club, you know. He just kind of gives us the positive, call the spirit, and there it is, and just sits there, and, and, and, and, and, and, and, you know, so I've got this little paperweight on my desk.

I'd say that I, you know, donated to the cause. And I think there's a great deal more to it than that, and we'll talk about that as we go through this semester. What strikes me as I get into the New Testament is that talking about the spirit was embedded in the very language of the first century church, starting with Jesus himself as what we're about to enter into. But here, you know, you see that it was very common, it was not avoided, but it was a sought after a way of defining the Christian lifestyle and Christian walk, to talk about the spirit's activity in one's life and define one's life through the spirit of God, the Holy Spirit. You know, phrases like, do not quench the spirit. Let me ask you, do you have any idea what that means? We didn't even talk about the spirit. How can you know whether you're doing it or not?

Since we live by the spirit, let us keep in step with the spirit. They're in the context of this letter of

Galatians, where they struggle with all these, you know, Christ plus religion issues and circumcision, all this. He plants this concept in there that we are to keep in step with the spirit. Are you keeping in step with the spirit? If we've never really studied it and really engaged what the spirit means in my life, how do you know that you're keeping in step with the spirit? Does it mean you just show up to church and show up to classes like this? Do not I could drunk on wine which leads to debauchery instead knows the converse that be filled with the spirit?

By the way, it's a command by Paul. If you look at the grammar of that, you are to be filled with the spirit. How do you know when you're filled with the spirit? Do you even have the spirit? What difference make if you are filled with the spirit? You feel drunk? How would I know? Unless I've actually spent time engaging these things and really meditating on them and thinking about them in context and trying to come to some understanding in my life. But again, just the basic understanding that it was the common language of the first century Christians. Why is it not the common language of 21st century Christians? In turn, it's a surprise if that's your background. I would tell you that these lessons that I'm going to bring are building blocks. I'm not going to presume that you know anything.

So if I say something that seems rather elementary, I'm not insulting your intelligence. I'm just trying to take us all along depending on where you're at along this thing. But if you were like me at your age, when I was your age, I didn't know anything other than how to spell it. In fact, and I'm not being facetious, I actually thought this first name was Holy and the second name was Spirit. Some of you think? But I did. I was that ignorant of this idea and it sounds stupid, but no one ever told me different. And when I read it, I just seemed Holy Spirit, Holy Spirit, or Holy Spirit. You know, I kind of thought it was an apparition, you know, and Casper the Friendly Ghost is kind of trotting around as my paperweight. And let me ask you this. Just a generic question. When you hear the word Holy Spirit.

Now, to me, you were to play the game of word association. Just tell me what ideas, concepts, thoughts come to your mind. Just anything. Just go them out. One of the times I can hear you. Holy Spirit, what comes to your mind? A dog, okay. Okay, we're going to Romans chapter 8, okay. What else? So again, influences you, okay? Okay, kind of associated with my conscience and how I sense things. The Trinity. That's interesting word. We'll get to that in a minute. Anything else. What other things come you want to think? There's a lot of other things come my mind. You know, you guys giving all these nice, difficult answers.

What are some of the things stepped back when you're Holy Spirit in our culture with what you think? Why do you think we have avoided all this? What are the things that we keep going in the path way of defining Holy Spirit that we feel a bit tense about? Okay, speaking in tongues. Okay, what else? Indwelling? What else? What do you think of? A guide. Kind of a pillar of clotted day, a pillar of fire at night. Kind of just light around and you just follow? Say again. Okay, yeah, oh, yeah. And my generation, they call them the Holy Rollers. I remember we did, we did, you know, kind of the exciting pew jumper. You know, church services, very emotionally charged. I did mission work in Jamaica for some years. And there was this church. I mean, it rocked. I mean, it was unbelievable. And we could, you know, we were probably a couple of miles away.

And just over the regular music that you heard, almost 24 or 7 was, you know, when it's Christmas and session, you knew it. And all worldwide. And it was just really something. I have those images growing up, whether it was in a tent, whatever, you know, the healings, the miracles, the tongues speaking, the slain in the Spirit, things like this. And we'll talk about all of that in this class. What I've experienced and what I think is isn't all that kind of stuff. Point is, there's a lot of things associated with the Holy Spirit. Is it just a big free for all, is it just whatever you want it to be, whatever church group you're in, so just buy into it? I don't know. I think that we ought to be thoughtful and substantial in our study about this. And really kind of work through some things.

I think ignorance is not bliss. I am thankful, as I said in the email, that God can bless us even in our

ignorance. Otherwise, even if I don't understand what the Spirit is doing for me, the Spirit can do it for me. And I'm thankful. It's by grace, to gift. I don't fully get God, but I'm so glad He's in my life doing what He's doing. But I think there is a deep richer blessing and understanding what God is doing this in my life. And it helped me be more directive and more substantial in my walk with God. But what happens if you leave the Holy Spirit out of the picture, or rather anemic about your understanding of it, I think that it would make your walk with Jesus to that degree anemic. And so I think it is worth studying. So let's kind of ease into this thing and kind of explore together and kind of go through this learning curve together.

Yes, take your notes. Yes, you can ask your questions. Sometimes you ask a question. I might put you on hold, because I know we're going to talk about it later. So I may give you a quick now and move on and we'll come back to it kind of thing. Other times, you know, it may just be the relevant thing at the moment, and I'll give it my best shot. Some things I'll have to go back and maybe think about. I've certainly been asked a lot of questions about the Holy Spirit in the past that, hmm, you know, really good thought and not sure. And some things I've got ideas on that I didn't before. Anyway, there we go. Now, a place to begin, the Shema. It's found in the Old Testament. We want to know what the Shema is. And you want to know what Shema means in Hebrew. You do what you realize or not.

It means 'hear.' Now, is there a text you can remember? It's very famous in the Old Testament of Deuteronomy. It just starts with here. Does someone say it out here? Oh, hair. No, no, it's here. Now, I might have thought you said hair when you said it here. Hear, O Israel. The Lord our God is one. Love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, with all your strength, and when Jesus was asked what's the greatest commandment? What did he say? Is there a pecking order to the importance, the priority of truth? Yes. In Jesus said so. But he didn't stop there. Everyone else said, either way, he didn't ask for the first and second. I'm going to give you both because you can't, you can't just associate them and love your neighbors yourself. Love God. Love people.

Every time if you were a Jew and you got together to worship in a synagogue, you quoted this verse to this day, they still do it. That's how they start every service. So if you go to a service and you have to be in a synagogue and it's in Hebrew and when they start off, you can say, hey, that's the Shema. No, be rather impressed by you, though you don't understand the word they're saying. They're just quoting the Shema. Now, but immediately I find myself at somewhat of a dilemma. Why? Stay out of that last part again. They wouldn't accept Jesus as being the son because they denied him being the Messiah, correct? Okay, but what about the Holy Spirit? They don't. Old Testament talked about the Holy Spirit. How about in Genesis in the very beginning? What was the creating power? The Spirit of God moved across the voice.

The Spirit has been very prevalent in the Old Testament. They had a very strong theology of the Holy Spirit, but I would say it was not a, it was a, you know, not Trinitarian, but dietary and view. God the Father, God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob and the Spirit of God. Although I'm interested in the progressive revelation of God revealed himself, what they really understood precisely about the Holy Spirit, but they certainly knew it was, it's talked about its reference. It's what it's prophesied about in Old Testament. Prophecy all talked about the Holy Spirit of God. So it was very prevalent. If you think it's not in there, then it's just one of those misnomers. There's still some of the troubles made though. In fact, it goes back to Genesis chapter 1, I think, verse 26 in the creation. What did God say when it came to creating man? Let us create man in our own image, plural.

The Bible, you. Lord, your God is one. It's the basis of belief in both Judeo and Christian roots. Jesus reinforced it. It's primary. Yet it speaks in terms of God being a plurality. So let's start there, the big picture, and then let me just kind of walk through a few things. What do you learn by simply being exposed to that simple idea? God refers himself to plurality, the idea is one. What do you learn about God? Because really when you talk about what is Holy Spirit like, you're asking the broader question,

so what is God like? What is the nature of God? That's where you have to start. What do you learn? It's more familiar to you than you realize when I start talking about it. Yes.

How does that phrase actually? The God is unity and diversity. Do you ever hear that phrase? Do you ever hear that phrase in the context of Christian framework? Say again, the church. Interesting. Now let's just kind of explore this for just a moment. The body of Christ, 1 Corinthians 12, though we are many, we are one body, the spiritual body of Christ, so it already begins to speak about this principle of God, of we being a cohesive oneness, at least by spiritual inside of God, intent, yet recognizes the multiplicity of personalities and individuality. These and individuality and gifts and directions and things that we do belonging to that one, that framework of oneness.

Now it has ever done in you that the things that God creates carry his own fingerprint in it. Does that make sense to you? Should it surprise us that God is far more complex than what He creates? And it's very important. What John 17 says, this oneness, Father, I pray that the disciples will be one just like you and I are one. May they be enough as I am in you and you are in me. I mean, I'm talking about intimacy, a relationship between the Father, the Son, Father, God as that prayer is being said. And he's asking us to take place in our lives. And so you see that there is a, if you get the right thinking theology, you get the right lifestyle that comes out of it. But you fragment God, what happens to us? What happens to your life? It becomes fragmented. It's unhealthy. Just things you just cannot get if you get the wrong theology.

And so he's speaking terms of a Trinity, Father, Son, Holy Spirit. They are not identical, yet they are one and the same. Now, can you understand why, especially in the launching pad of Christianity, the first few centuries as they were beginning to deal with these enormous principles of Christianity that were very important to our thinking. That it created an enormous amount of conflict as they tried to find what these things meant. And so they spoke in terms of how do we describe God? And so there was all of these teachings that came out of this, like in the third century, Sabellianism. That basically suggests, okay, this is how we look at it. God basically is like a Greek actor. The same Greek actor would come out and he would hold different masks. And so he would be the same actor, but he would wear one mask, and then he would come out and stage again, same actor with another mask, and then he came out the stage with another mask.

And that basically the civilian described God this way, that God came first as the father, and then he came as Jesus, and then he came as the Spirit of God throughout history, not simultaneously, but one at a time on the stage. But then again, I have a problem with that, and I begin to think of, for example, the baptism of Jesus. Remember that situation? For example, in Matthew 3, what happened in that scenario? Who shows up in that scenario? First of all, you have Jesus himself as the son, right? And when he's baptized, what happens? A visual, kind of a video plays, you get the Spirit descends upon Jesus like a dove, and say, as a dove.

So there was some visual event that took place that people could see, or at least John the Baptist could see, and then there was a voice from heaven that said, what? This is my son, whom I love, and him I am well pleased. So you see this interaction at that one moment, rather significant moment, by the way, where the father, some Holy Spirit, are all simultaneously active. If you were there on the stage, and so you can see how that created some problems, and now that can't be yet, there's Arianism in the fourth century that basically said, well, you know, it says that Jesus was begotten, the only begotten of God.

– [Matthew 3:16-17](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

In other words, the mantra was, there was a time when Jesus did not exist. He was created, and that later, God the Father created Jesus, and then Jesus created the Holy Spirit. And that theology was thrown out. Now, you see how they're fragmenting God, and it created all sorts of problems. And by the

way, that's very, very common in Jehovah's Witness theology today. And then there was the tritheism. That is suggesting that there were just three separate distinct gods, which, by the way, if you catch that, that's polytheism. No difference in all the Greek mystery religions that you hear about mythology. But, by the way, is very common in basically framework for Mormonism today. So, what do I do with this thing? Trinity means threefold. It is one at the same time, unity and diversity, unity and purpose, unity and communication, unity and unity.

In nature and yet, there's a distinguishing between them. A. W. Tozer put it this way: Holy Spirit is a person. He is not enthusiasm. He is not courage. He is not energy. He is not personification of all good qualities, like Jack Frost with personification of cold weather. Actually, the Holy Spirit is not a personification of anything. He has individuality. He is one being, not another. He has will and intelligence. He has hearing. He has knowledge. He has sympathy and ability to love and see and think. If you know the scriptures, when it refers to the Holy Spirit, he can hear, speak, desire, grieve, rejoice. He is a person. So, I find that the Spirit can be grieved. I find that he can possess knowledge. And he doles that knowledge out to human beings. That he has purpose. That he determines what gifts you have. He intentionally decides, I want this person to do this, this person to do this, this person to do this within the one body of practice.

– [A. W. Tozer, The Counselor](#). Verified source for the personhood wording; the transcript paraphrases the quote.

He says, the Spirit does this. So, R. A. Torrey says, if we think Holy Spirit only has an impersonal power or influence, then our thought will constantly be, how can I get a hold of and use Holy Spirit? But if we think of him in the biblical way as a divine person, a relationship with God, infinitely wise, infinitely holy, infinitely tender, then our thought will constantly be, how can the Holy Spirit get hold of and use me? You see, at the very practical implications, I use the Holy Spirit. It's not just something argued about it and hashed out, decide who had the right truth you didn't. They understood that where they came down on an understanding Holy Spirit actually affected what their light looked like day in and day out with other people as they lived. Someone said it's somewhat like the atom, you know physics, atom.

The democrat just called it a Thomas, meaning that which cannot be cut or split or divided in any way. Of course, with our technology, we've actually been able to split atom. And we find out they're actually made of multiplicity of things. They've got what the neutron, the proton, and the nucleus, that it actually is even the smallest element of our universe has complexity to it. And it reflects the unity and diversity of God, and it does matter. So a good place to begin. He is God. He is a person whom you relate to. And if you have that understanding, not a force like in Star Wars, not some sort of hovering helicopter of power that kind of zapped people with abilities as need to superhero's kind of stuff. There's a lot of Christians to think that way. It's a wonder we're so deranged spiritually in America today.

Really across the globe. Now, let's first this. I said this about heaven when I preached on that two weeks ago, Sunday. I said, if you want to learn about a topic, what were the first things you ought to do? Do you want to learn about any topic in terms of how God sees it? Where's the primary place to start? Take a stab at it. Yes, ask what Jesus is. Read the letters and read. And heaven, because he's been there, and he knows what we say about him is true. He comes to Holy Spirit because he knows him personally. He and the Spirit are one.

So if I listen to what Jesus says, Holy Spirit, it's a good place to begin to bring some understanding what he wants us to understand about our relationship with Holy Spirit. Now, Jesus had referenced the Holy Spirit throughout his ministry, if you pay attention. For example, John 7, he said, the greatest last day of the feast, he stood up and said, if any man is thirsty, let him come to me and drink. And wells of living water will flow through him. And the John says, gives a parenthetical what John is used to doing. He said, let me define it for you, of this he spoke of the Holy Spirit who has not yet been given,

because Christ has not yet been glorified. Jesus had not yet been through death, burial, resurrection, and ascension. And so there was this already, Jesus is already alluding to something that's coming.

That's very tangible and very real and very profound, because all the Old Testament prophets prophesy about this time, the Holy Spirit can be put out in all mankind. And they awaited this moment with baited breath. I mean, it was an exciting moment when God brought again and poured out of the Spirit upon all those people. No, this is for free, but did the Holy Spirit show up in people in the Old Testament? Yes, how do you think prophets prophesy? What about Samson? Do you think God has strength from? What's different between the Old Testament and the Old Testament is that God was very selectively endowing people with the Spirit of God. Kings, prophets, the judges, but the promise of the Old Testament is that everybody gets it. Anyone in the kingdom gets this. Whatever it is, whoever he is, we get it.

No. Jesus was doing some very specific things. The greatest concentration of teaching of Jesus on the Holy Spirit is found in John 14, 15, and 16. Now, does anyone remember what the context of John 14, 15, and 16 is? I heard a voice. Okay, the last supper, what else took place during that time? Okay, washing the feet. Anyhow, what's the timing of it? Where does it fall and turn the context of the history of his life on earth? Right before his death. So the shadow of the cross is completely covering his life at this country. I mean, it's literally knocking out the door. The time has come, right? And it starts with that wash of the feet that moves into this taking ownership of the feast of the Passover and owning it himself and turning the last supper into the Lord's supper that which uniquely belongs to him and redefining the whole thing through his life.

What's going to happen in terms of the death, the burial, the resurrection? And Jesus, of course, is also talking about disappearing, leaving. You guys are about to go into some real grieving here, I'm about to leave. Now, put yourself into the disciples shoes who have been following Jesus, who have given up everything to follow him and he's telling him, by the way, I'm about to orphan you. That's the context of John 14, 15, 16. And Jesus knows this about happening, by the way, in a Jewish understanding, when your rabbi left, you were considered, if you lost, if he died or whatever, if you lost your connection with him as a relationship, you were considered to be an orphan. It was a very intimate, profound relationship. A lot more than simply a teacher and a student, the way we tend to think here.

You really can take a leave, most of it like a leave, right? Not this. And so here Jesus is about to enter into cataclysmic events. They're going to be thrown in absolute confusion, disarray, upheavals, doubt, testing. I mean, they just run as in fear. And so Jesus, before all this happens, gets them together and says, let's talk. And in the context of this, He's basically doing three things. He's comforting them, preparing them for this moment. If you let them know what happens, it's going to happen before it happens. That helps a little bit now. Although they didn't quite get it. He said, I'm about to go into Jerusalem. I'm going to be arrested. We're here right now. It's about to happen. All these things I've been telling you throughout the last year or so. I'm going to be arrested. I'm going to be abused.

I'm going to be crucified in the cross. I'm going to be put in a grave. I'm going to get up three days later. And they got none of this. Because they didn't want to get any of this. It was just too overwhelming to them to grasp. If he was the Messiah, Messiahs don't die. And they don't suffer. They flex their muscles and beat people up and get what they want. That's why we're following you. But Jesus is speaking about death. It must be metaphorical then. And so He's trying to help strengthen the face to crucifixion.

Then He's trying to also help them learn some survival skills, which are known as unity and love. If you want to survive in this world, that's why He washed their feet. He wanted them to get this. If you want to survive in this world as a believer, not a watered down believer, but a true believer, you've got to stay together and you've got to love one another. In a way that's so unique the world that wouldn't understand it. If we wash their feet, says you get it now, you understand? And thirdly, you'll notice He spoke in concentration about the coming of the Holy Spirit. He's saying, well, although I'm leaving,

you're not really going to be orphans. And the reason you're not going to be orphans, although you, me, the rabbi is going to physically be removed from your presence.

Not just temporarily in the grave, but when he ascended, he was gone. He went into another dimension of life, we call it heaven. In a physical body, by the way. He says, but I'm going, that's a good thing because now, I've asked the Father to send you the Holy Spirit in my stead. So kind of thinking about this way, as Jesus incarnated, the presence of God in this world. So in the spirit of God, incarnate Jesus in this world through us. I'll say it again. As Jesus came into the world, in physical form, incarnate God in the flesh, and brought the presence of God with Him. If you've seen me, you just told Philip, you've seen the Father. We're one and the same. We'll stop asking what the Father is. He's right here in front of you. You're looking at Him.

You can teach Him. But when He did go, the Holy Spirit comes, and then He invests all of us and re-creates Jesus in all of us, and Jesus is still on the earth through us. There's the big framework. That's why it's important. I have a key up here. This is the key, emerging one, emerging point that you've got to get. Consider it now just a contentment and now just a contemptee container. I'll fill it as we go through the quarter. And here's the statement. The Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. I would like to actually repeat this after me out loud. The Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. Rather than now just mimicking it, I want you to actually think about while you say it again. The Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ.

Now you've got this nice framework, and I would like to spend the rest of the semester filling that up. But this is extremely an important filter to use. And we'll see it played out, even as we deal with John 14, 15, and 16. Jesus can keep hammering it out. The Spirit come to do what I want it to do. If the Spirit doing something, it'll point not to Himself, but to me, Jesus, the Son of God. And if you can't understand that, and understand the substance of it, it also will help you filter out all the myriad of things, I think, that tend to be associated with the Spirit that kind of give you some, I'm not sure if that's in God or not. And you can think for yourself, and filter for yourself, these things.

So let's just go to one text. I think I did this first. Yes, let me do this first. As I'm talking about John 14, 15 and 16, and we'll end with this, and we'll pick up actually in the context of John 14, and look at that specific passage, basically, Jesus goes through a series of five promises of the Holy Spirit. I think it's important to understand context. You know, they talk about exegesis and hermeneutic, have you heard those words? Okay, let me define them for you. Exegesis. When you read the Bible, you asked the question, what did it mean? Back then, in context. That was when Paul wrote a letter, he wrote a letter to say the Church of Corinth, or Philippi, or Ephesus, and he wrote it for a very specific reason, or they call it an occasion.

What was the occasion of writing this letter? Obviously, there was something going on in Corinth, or Ephesus, or Philippi, or whatever, or Thessalonica, that prompted Paul to say what he said in those letters. There was an actual context, the social context, of which he was addressing. And when you read the letters, you're hearing one side of the phone conversation, but if you pay attention to the context, you can understand what took place on the other side of the conversation by what was going on in that church. That's the original context, what it originally meant past tense. I must first always ask that question. But when I do a healthy, thorough, thoughtful study of scriptures, I must first ask the exegetical question. So, what did it actually mean when it was first written? But context is important. The social context, what was going on in their lives, what was going on in the context of the letter, all those things matter.

And by the way, you have to do some little sweat act, ready to get there. But then I asked her, an integral question. Now that I understand its original intent, now how do I then do the second bridge of applying it to my life today in the 21st century? If I don't do a good job with the exegetical, I'm going to be really warned when I get to the hermeneutic. Understand? So, this is part of the exegetical. When we're reading all these passages, remember who is Jesus actually talking to specifically at this moment?

He's not speaking to the masses that are following him. He has requested himself with just a 12 and he's talking to these men that re-term apostles, the apostles of Jesus Christ.

Now I just wanted just to see that there's some uniqueness to this. And I have to maintain some sort of context with this because as I've really read in these passages, about what the Spirit's doing, I have to figure out, well, so how does that have been applied to me? I see how it applied to them, but does it transition to me or is it just them that it was referring to? Does that mean it makes sense? Okay, for example, look at this text out of John 17. Here, Jesus is praying, and notice what he prays. I have revealed you, God, the Father, Father, Father, to those whom you gave me out of the world.

Now we're going to see in a minute, he's speaking specifically about the 12th. They were yours. You gave them to me, and they have obeyed your word. Now they know that everything you have given me comes from you. I gave them the words you gave me, and they accepted them. They knew a certainty that I came from you, and they believed that you sent me. I pray for them. I'm not praying for the world, but for those you have given me, for they are yours. And then he goes on to say, now my prayer is not for them alone, but I pray also for those who will believe in me through their message. That refers to us. So, already Jesus, even in his prayer, he just seems, there's something unique about these 12 men, and their role, and how God interacted with their life.

Then he would go on to say this, for example, in Acts chapter 1. Luke, who wrote the Gospel of Luke, and then his second chapter, his second chapter of the book was the Book of Acts. He says, in my former book, the office, the Gospel of Luke, I wrote about all that Jesus began to do into teaching until the day he was taken up to heaven. After giving instructions, through notice, the Holy Spirit too, the Apostle, not just anybody, but specifically to these men. He had chosen. After his suffering, he showed himself to these men. Who did Jesus show up to? Specifically, these 12s. And then there were some other disciples that got into this, like the women. In fact, the first, oh, I witnessed this in Jesus' resurrection for women. Right? He appeared to them over a period of 40 days, about a month and a half, and spoke about the kingdom of God.

And then I had the word nest, I don't know why that got stuck in there. Bad timing. But again, most unique. Then finally, if you would say this, in Acts 10, this is, and we're going to actually look through very carefully at the book of Acts later on in this semester. In Acts 10, this is the event about Cornelius. That had been happened. And it says, Peter is speaking to this house, and he says, we are witnesses of everything he, Jesus, did in the country of the Jews and in Jerusalem, those were witnesses. We apostles, and I'm one of those, Peter says, and they killed him by hanging him on a tree, but God raised him from that of the third day and caused him to be seen. He was not seen by all the people, those but by witnesses, whom God had already chosen, by us, who ate and drank with him after he rose from the dead.

There was historical reality of relationship between these men and Jesus, and it gave them unique qualifications to do certain things that no one else in the face of the earth could do. Did you get the idea? There was a context of this. He commanded us to preach to the people and to testify that he is the one whom God appointed as judge of the living and the dead. So as we enter into John 14, 15, and 16, that's who Jesus is talking to, this unique group of people, and he's going to make certain promises, and the spirit is going to be a primary generator of these promises. And we're going to see what he's promising the spirit is going to do. Like, if you love me, you will obey what I command, and I will ask the Father and He will give you another counselor to be with you forever if the spirit approved.

We'll stop here, but there's the first promise. If you'd like to do a little homework between now and next week, I would suggest you read through chapters 14, 15, and 16, he will not take you that long, and every time you see the word spirit, a spirit of God, a spirit of Christ, or not a Holy Spirit been in there, stop, and notice what it says about it, and you'll note that there are five promises that follow through, that Jesus gives them because the spirit is going to come into their life.

So I just have to, I just have to, who out when we're in wine? And we're just going to kind of walk through that, and that's where we're going to begin. And yes, I do think that there is a hermeneutic of applying those promises to your life, but you have to be very careful. It's not just big free for all anything you want. There's certain things he's saying, there are things he's not saying. Okay? Let's pray.

Class 2: The Spirit of Truth in the Words of Jesus

Original transcript: hs02.txt

Summary: The second class works through Jesus' promises in John 14-16. The Spirit is the Paraclete, teacher, witness, and convicting presence whose ministry points away from himself and toward Jesus.

Key Scripture References

- [John 14:15-17](#)
- [John 14:25-26](#)
- [John 15:26-27](#)
- [John 16:8-11](#)
- [John 16:13-15](#)
- [John 17:6-20](#)
- [Acts 1:1-3](#)
- [Acts 2:1-39](#)
- [Acts 10:39-42](#)
- [1 Corinthians 1:10-17](#)
- [Joel 2:28-32](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

The Holy Spirit will teach and remind the apostles of what Jesus said.

– [John 14:26](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

The Spirit testifies about Jesus, and the apostles also testify.

– [John 15:26-27](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Cleaned Transcript

Let me do a very quick review of where we went last year, the images will help you. As we started talking about, we're dealing with the study of the Holy Spirit, using the phrase in the book by Francis Chan, *Forgotten God*. We are not alone in this, but certainly within our heritage, within the Restoration Movement, somehow or another, the Holy Spirit got dropped from the dialogue. I think there's a lot of reasons for this, but I can't find any of them that are good. I do know this that when you listen to the Scriptures, the Holy Spirit was unabashedly and evidently, demonstratively present in the dialogue of the first century church, and it should be today too. Talking about the Holy Spirit doesn't mean that it's not going to lead us into the abusive ways, perhaps it has been used over the centuries, and therefore we don't talk about it somehow we won't fall into it.

Now I think we don't talk about it, we do become more vulnerable falling into the problems. So we need to talk about this and understand it, and work through it. The Holy Spirit is a wonderful promise of God. It comes with enormous blessings, and not talk about it as to just handicap our ability to understand how wondrous God is. And it accepts one basic premise that without God, we can do nothing. You take the Spirit out of the picture, which makes us very vulnerable, thinking that we can do this on our own. And we don't see how those dots connect, that's one of the primary reasons we need to study this issue, and you need to do it in your personal life.

So we began with the shame, I remember, Deuteronomy 6.4, where the Jews began, and by the way, Jesus absolutely affirmed this, and showed that God is Lord, Lord the Lord, Lord the God with all your heart, mind, soul, and strength. But we also notice that God's vocation is presented to us as a form of

plurality. That is, God the Father, God the Father, God the Son, God the Holy Spirit. And we talked about the Trinity idea. And an idea, which is hard for me to fully grasp, but it should not surprise us when you look at the very fingerprints of God in the creation, whether just the body of Christ, which is written, but yet we are many, many members, or even the very smallest molecule of God's creation. We call it an atom, which we didn't think could be split, but can be split and found that in there is even a complex unity.

So why should we be surprised that God is infinitely more complex than what He creates? And so we shouldn't, although we may not fully understand how God can be run, and yet have three very distinct personalities, Father, Son, Holy Spirit, which we see actually played out in different roles in the gospel themselves. We mentioned the baptism of Jesus, God the Father speaking, the Holy Spirit descending, and Jesus Himself in the incarnate stage, in the flesh actually being baptized by John. And you find this recurring throughout the New Testament. And there, there in that one does an example.

So perhaps there is certainly a mystery to this. I think when we see God in face to face, this will make sense in ways that in our limited exposure to the whole world, an physical the spiritual world as well, we do not say, we just can't fully put it together. But God certainly points and gives us enough descriptors to understand the implications and get the idea. It's kind of like understanding having. I mean, I understand everything about heaven because I've never been there, but I can know a lot about it if you pay attention. And so, you know, the main thing I want you to grasp is that, therefore, this spirit is not a force. It's not some sort of inanimate energy field of God. It is a person who thinks, acts, feels, read the scriptures. All of those descriptors are used to define the spirit of God, the spirit of truth, the Holy Spirit, the spirit of Christ has called many things.

Spell it out. Listen a couple of letters. The Holy Spirit is a person. He is not enthusiasm. He is not courage. He is not energy. He is not personification of all good qualities like Jack Frost, the personification of cold weather, actually, the Holy Spirit is not a personification of anything. He has himself individuality. He is one being and not another. He has will and intelligence. He has hearing, has knowledge, sympathy and ability to love and see and think. He can hear, speak, desire, grieve, rejoice. He is a person. And there's a lot of implication of this, but certainly one of those, if you just see the practical implications of why your theology matters to you, if we think the Holy Spirit only has an impersonal power or influence, which is if you look at other religions in the world like animism that tend to invest objects with power, same idea, then our thoughts will come to be, how can I get a hold in use the Holy Spirit?

But if we think of him in the biblical way as a divine person to relate to, and if only wise, infinitely holy, infinitely tender, then our thought will constantly be how can the Holy Spirit get hold of and use me? You see, it matters. So I place before you this key, I want you to repeat it with me again, because this is a filter that I hope that as we go throughout semester will become one that you can fill this, if you will, this framework up, and it has deeper and deeper meaning to you. And it will become very practical ultimately, because it will help you ask the question, so how do I know something is from God or not? All these things, supposedly, they said they're coming from the Spirit of God.

How do I really know, other than the fact the person says so? The statement is this, the Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ, and I'll say it with me, the Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ, say it again with conviction. The Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. Okay, now, I then took you to the Gospel of John, and before I did that, I just why left you off, I took a few months to say, let's remember that the text we're about to read are, we're specifically spoken when Jesus has sequestered Himself in seclusion with the Twelve. This is just before the crucifixion. Jesus is troubled with these men for three and a half years. He has been predicting them, by the way, I'm going to go to Jerusalem, I'm going to be arrested by the religious leaders there, I'm going to be abused, I'm going to be crucified on the cross, I'm going to be begged in three days later, I'm going to write in the grave.

And we keep on being told, they don't get it, they don't want to get it, they're bewildered, they just

cannot connect the dot between Jesus being the Christ of Messiah, the one they've awaited for, the promise of the Old Testament prophets, this great and wondrous person is going to save all mankind, starting with the Jews, and then this idea that now he's going to come and die on a cross. They just put him in cognitive dissonance, they could not connect those dots, they refused to connect those dots.

So they said, Jesus, we think you're a God, but you're wrong. That's basically how it boils down to this dimension. So now we're right, now I'm knocking on the door, the last day or two. The disciples almost in resigned spirits have followed Jesus into Jerusalem. I remember one of them said, well, we might just go with him too, so that we too may die with him. A bold statement, a courageous statement, but a one of little hope. You know, we can't, who else are we going to follow? We just follow Jesus, but we're all going to get crucified for doing this. It doesn't make sense.

So you know, it's all about to happen and life goes downhill. So to prepare these men for this, Jesus, just them together, and to the best that he can, given their limited ability to process all of this. Besides, let me help you face what you're about to face. Because I'm telling you the truth, read my lips. I'm about to go into Jerusalem now. It's imminent. You know, they're up in the upper room. He's washed the feet. He's redefined the Passover Feast to the special now it's Jesus' supper, referring to what it's about to take place on the cross and its implications, something that will take place for the rest of history and event. And then he makes it with some teachings that come with all of these promises, and he's really trying to just give them strength. And embedded in this long dialogue of chapter 14, 15, and 16, we find the most concentrated teachings on the Holy Spirit by Jesus.

Because built into all these promises he's making to them, be it peace, be it courage, this is how it's going to play out, everything's going to be fine. Let me tell you why. And woven into all that are five promises of the Holy Spirit. Very prominent. And of course I ask, and why is it that we don't talk about it today? It was rather important to Jesus. Why is it safe to be important to us and its significance and understanding to us? But understanding that I talk about the uniqueness of the apostles. And I struggle with this, and I want you to as well, because you first, when you're ever looking at scriptures, we're rather lazy sometimes, and we shouldn't be. It leads to a lot of, you know, just anything goes, you know, you don't want to check the things, don't let it mean that.

You know, because it's comfortable for you. A text, let me throw it at the statement, a text cannot mean what it never meant. Let me say again, a text, whatever it is. And the scriptures cannot mean today what it never meant back then. You must first understand that we call the exit Jesus, the original intent of the passage. When Jesus said this to these 12 men, what was his point? I will tell you that's the same point today. So what a text did mean back then does mean today. But before I make the leap of applying it to my life, I have to kind of see it in this context first, and say, okay, now how do I, what do I do with this thing? And it's not always that easy. But I'm going to do my best with this, and there'll be plenty of people that disagree.

But I can tell you what I understand from the scriptures and looking at these passages, which I have done so for many, many, many years. And I'm not devoid of having read a massive number of scholars on this, many of them who disagree. But you know, you study, you learn, you pray, and then you just make some decisions along the way. So now we enter into this, you know, because I hear the passage I read last week about the uniqueness of the disciples. And of course, remember what was unique about them, is that they were actually historically connected with Jesus in person. They actually, I witnessed all of these things, and that's who Jesus is talking to. And so we keep bringing those. You who have been with me from the beginning. Well, you and I have not been with Jesus from the beginning.

That's when he came over to see, and he started preaching and called them with disciples. You know, I read about, see through them, eyes of faith, Jesus healing, the blind, the deaf, the demon possessed. But they were actually there. And even amongst that, you got Peter James and John that saw some things, and none of the others saw. Like the raising of the little girl, the mountain of transfiguration, you know.

I just know what happened, read about it, and get the basic context, see the wonder of it, and think, man, think about what it was like to actually be there, and then to give, I witnessed testimony to this thing. Well, you'll see how that comes to the play in just a minute.

So I want to play through each of these passages. Let's look at them one at a time. Let me extract some things. I could talk, rather lengthy on any one of these passages. We don't have time to do that. I don't want to, you know, so load you with cerebral challenges that you do what I've actually not to fall asleep. But I do want you to think, and yes, you are going to have to exercise some discipline in this thing, to really think through. And it's like, what is it going on in this text? Why? Jesus saying this? And what am I supposed to get out of this for today?

So in the midst of all of this, Jesus says this. If you love me, you will obey what I command, and I will ask the Father, and He will give you another counselor to be with you forever, to find again here the spirit of truth. Okay, let's look at this. Sometimes I'll throw out a few little ideas that I think will come to make more sense and emphasize it later. So, but let me throw it out. First of all, why the spirit comes on whose request? You ask them for the spirit or someone else. Say again. Jesus, okay. No, just a small item it seems, but the disciples are not told to pray for the Holy Spirit. The spirit comes upon the request of Jesus Himself. He does the ask it.

So my first question is, who are you pursuing? I find that to be a significant question in our culture today. Notice He says, He will give you another counselor. Now, another counselor assumes there is a present counselor, and the present counselor is Jesus. Like the answer is always Jesus, right? The, by the way, the using this word counselor is unique to John. He's joining one does this. He does it in concentration here, but he also uses it in the first John, where he refers to Jesus as being a counselor. Or the word is advocate. One who speaks to God in our defense.

Notice it's got kind of a legal framework to it. When we are counselor, and I'm just trying to get you to tweak this idea of, we are going to seek more therapeutically. That's not how the word is used. The word is used more in terms of legal counsel. Let me help you a little bit there. The word actually in the Greek is the word paraclete. P-A-R-A-K-L-T-O-F. Paraclete. Paraclete. Paraclete. Paraclete. You've heard that word. You might have heard Germans on this. Paraclete. That which comes up alongside you. Kind of, put this down around here. Walks along with the help shout. That's kind of a blue collar definition for it.

All right? To give strength to. Now, I'm already beginning to get sensitive to spirit is doing something. That's what we're going to have to try to start building on here. He's a helper. And he continues to work the work of Jesus through the disciples to defend the truth of Jesus in the life of the rebellion of the believer. Remember when Jesus was on earth himself as the first paraclete? He was always put under trial. If you read, for example, the classic chapter in John 5, you see Jesus on trial and Jesus standing up in the courtroom, before the world, and making his case. He throws all of these witnesses in front of him. He says, we're about Moses and John the Baptist, the spirit of God, and all these things are witness to who I am. And he turns the table and becomes their judge.

The people who are judging him end up being judged by Jesus himself. This is what you see taking place here where now the spirit and dwells the believer and now that same context moves towards us. Well, we'll see how that plays out here as we go. There you go, a simple idea. Jesus is a paraclete. Jesus is going to leave, but they're not going to be orphaned. They're going to get another paraclete. But as it was promised back in Jesus' own words, and John's interpretation, back in John 7, that the spirit had not yet been given, because Jesus had not yet been glorified. He will even argue in this long context of 14-16. He tells us, it's better than I leave you, because until I leave, speaking of the death, burial, resurrection, and the ascension, which is all part of the all-in-one, when you say, glorified Jesus, until I'm glorified, the spirit does not come.

Because I wonder, why can't they just both come at the same time and be there? I'm not sure why. I know that's how Jesus said it works. When I go, then that releases the spirit of God by my request. And he will be poured out in all mankind with nothing rather unique and prophesied throughout Old Testament scriptures. And it was that wondrous day was being pointed to. And they, of course, I'm thinner thinking the disciples choose. Remember, these guys are bewildered and denial. Are they processing all the stuff I think not? But they would later understand, because of the spirit's work. And we'll see how this works here in the few verses that come along. I just think these guys are overwhelmed in just in survival mode. All they can think of, Jesus isn't going to die. Jesus isn't going to die. Jesus can die.

Jesus, what would happen to us if Jesus died? That's all they can think of. And Jesus is trying to get through to them. It's okay. That's why I come. And if you will process this on the other end, it would be wonderful. Well, it's going to be wonderful anyway. It's just going to take you guys a little while to catch up. That's all. Next promise. Chapter 14, starting in verse 25. All this I have spoken to you while still with you. And there's this language of He's not going to be with them longer. So, again, His very language is creating pains in their hearts as He's speaking. But the counselor, the paraclete, the Holy Spirit, referred to earlier as the Spirit of truth, whom the Father will send in notice. My name. I'll come back to that. We'll teach you all things and we'll remind you of everything I have said to you.

Okay. Now, otherwise break this down. The Spirit comes in Christ's name to teach and to remind. Notice the goal was not to take them into future things. It was to get them to see back clearly to where they've already been with Jesus. To teach and remind. To be able to recall and fix their minds. What is it? Jesus had been sent to them all along. And so you'll notice, like, for example, in John's Gospel, and I brought this up to you before if you've all listened, John will often speak in parenthesis. And it was, he will quote Jesus that Jesus said this. And then he'll put in parenthesis, by this, Jesus meant this.

Then we didn't get it, but now we do. Why are we getting it out? Because the Spirit of God has helped illuminate that and helped us understand what we didn't understand when he first said it. So he first brought it back to their memory. Then he helped them understand it. Teach and remind. Now, let me step back and get this end. When I say my name, the word my, M-E-M-F, or E-K-D-E-M-E-M-F, it's my being emphasized, like I versus I. Well, it's very important that you look in the Greek text that those emphasis are noted. Here Jesus is saying, the Father will send in my name. The Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. Who is being pointed to tells you whether it's from the Spirit or not. So, catch this simplicity of model. The Spirit does not come to point away to Himself and say, look at me, look at me!

If you want to understand the Spirit's goal, it is always to point away from Himself to Jesus Christ. When you see that happening, you know the Spirit is involved. I think you can hang your hat on that. Who is the center of attention? And we'll see this bear born out in other texts that we're about to look out of John. Because it keeps being emphasized over and over and over again. Jesus keeps saying this over and over again. It's up to me! And the Spirit comes to make sure that point is made true.

So Jesus does not point away from Himself to lead Spirit rather than the Spirit points away from Himself to Jesus. That is, He will represent Jesus, not displace Him. Does that help you? The Spirit comes not to displace Jesus's role and attention. It puts precisely Jesus in the center of attention. When that's being done, I know the Spirit has been active. Now, what do I do with this teach and remind issue? I struggle with that. Is there a sense where the Spirit of God can help me be reminded of the historical statements of Jesus? I read the scriptures too and put them in memory and tried to... And I do a certain circumstances and I find myself capable of... See, yeah, I remember Jesus said this and be able to speak to those moments. Is that the Spirit's activity? I believe so.

I believe so. Does the Spirit of God help me and teach me with the assumption that I am immersed in the scriptures and read and try to understand? Yes. Because I too need reminding and understanding. I too find myself like the disciples, maybe not getting at the first time I read, but through prayer. Why do we pray then? And ask for understanding as we study the Bible. If it's just matter of your own intellect,

just live it up to yourself. You don't need God. So if you're praying for understanding, what are you asking for? God's intervention and help or not? Or is that just pious activity with no meaning? So, whereas I see this promise was made primarily to the 12th and initially, I think the Spirit is active in my life and yours. Reminding you and helping you understand what you've exposed yourself to understand through scriptures.

They just did it in person. Next promise. John 15. By the way, he's talking about the vine and the branches. All of us are teaching woven into all of this. And he's also been talking about, it's very important with this context. Jesus has been talking about if the world hates you. Many of these scriptures are written in the context of alienation from the world and being as a Christian by the very nature of being connected with Jesus. You find yourself in intimidating circumstances because the world is in rebellion to God.

So if you're in a relationship with God that puts you in a tenuous position, then we really get it. We're really trying to live this way. And he knows and he's been telling you to cycle all along. By the way, time can come when you're going to be arrested and you're going to be just shoved in front of magistrates and kings because of me and in chains. But don't worry at those moments because God will help you articulate in those moments. And he proved himself true over and over and over again as you look even in the first centuries to disciples when they were being arrested like John and Peter. And it's the same they had the words to say.

What do you think they got those from? They just conjured them up because they're just really intelligent men who can be courageous and meet the moment boldly. No, because the spirit of God was helping them. At least that's what the scriptures tell us. You have to decide whether God is true or not. It's really faith or we just saying we believe in something that we're not really sure is true. So the context of this, we will all face the social consequences of being in relationship to Jesus. And you'll see that kind of connect us from other things. That maybe our difficulty in understanding the truth of these passages is because we have so accommodated ourselves to the nature of the culture in which we live as Christians. That we really don't need the spirit to help us out because we don't feel any tenuous tension with it.

With me. I'm suggesting, oh, go out and be caustic. People can persecute you so you can say, oh, the spirit of God is helping me. That's not the point. But anyway, if you look at this, it says, when the counselor comes whom I will send to you from the father, the spirit of truth who goes out from the father, notice. He will testify about me. And notice, and you also must testify. So there's kind of a collective effort here. We're not allowed to hook here. There's going to do some things for you. Testify for you have been with me from the beginning. And there's one of those qualifiers that made those twelve men uniquely qualified as I witnesses. You and I are not I witnesses of Jesus. We are faithful witnesses of Jesus. The word used here for testifies the word material.

M-A-R-T-U-R-E-O, which is the same word from which we get the word martyr. Martyrs were not just those who got killed. They were those who were witnessing for Jesus and were persecuted and died because of it. They were testifying Jesus and paid the price. That's a martyr. Now, what that does not mean, what this does not mean in the context, it doesn't mean that one looks into his heart and shares the warm and moving experience that he has had with God with others. Not what it means. But a person with firsthand knowledge giving testimony about objective facts that gains verdict in a court. That's what that means. And what does the Holy Spirit say when he's testifying why he speaks about Jesus? Not about himself, but about Jesus. That's how you recognize the Holy Spirit. He doesn't come to testify to great and thrilling experiences that a person has had.

We cannot recognize that someone has the Holy Spirit because of some exciting personal experience. By the way, in our world today, and I can share with you a few of myself when I was in the charismatic realm of church going in belief. And I'll share with some of that later on. That did not validate and legitimize the fact that I was a child of God. Those were dime a dozen in the circles that I walked in and met stuff.

And of course, you see, again, this idea of the apostles being uniquely qualified because they had been with Jesus from the beginning. But I do see here how do I apply this to myself that in the context of intimidating when I am actually living for Jesus and find myself living out because of the genuineness of my Christianity. Do not run in fear from but stand courageously and boldly in faith in God in those moments with other individuals who are not believers.

Snatchers draw to the wind. How about sitting in a class where you have the professor making fun of Christianity? And you want to withdraw and hide in the background. We said, okay, who are you in Christmains in here? Not I. That I will be empowered by the spirit of God to point to Jesus and that I do not have to do it on my own. People are doing that all over the globe in countries where Christianity is being persecuted. Again, we live in a very peaceful world with that. And so perhaps it just misses our notice. But you talk to those other countries, they see this in stark reality and this is the text they would tell you and say, this is why I have been able to do this. Next text. John 16, 8 to 11. When he comes, the spirit of God, he will convict the world, notice, a guilt in regard to sin, righteousness and judgment.

He breaks it down for you and says, in regards to sin because men do not believe in me, in regard to righteousness because I am going to the father where you can see me no longer. And in regard to judgment because the prince of this world now stands condemned, most of present reality of that in Jesus' mind. So we have this kind of convicting another word that's translated in this part of the discussion here, is it convict or convince? Is you trying to convince believers of the truth of this or convict non-believers of the truth of this? See, depending on which words you use and how you interpret that word, a linko, in the Greek, it tells you which way the emphasis of this is. You'll see, for them, just an IV translation, they choose the word, convict. They say, why can't it be both? Perhaps all, but the choice of word does suggest the basic direction to its spirit's activity.

Now I do know this, and I look at this, a spirit doesn't force or coerce anyone to believe. If so, I assume that since God's more powerful than everyone in the face of the earth would be a Christian then, unless someone has more might than God does. Obviously he's not coercing. But there is a convicting nature to this. And remember, this is also in the context of facing a hostile world. And all of a sudden, where I see the spirit helping me survive and defend against the hostile world, all of a sudden now it puts me on the offensive. There's almost attacking. You see this? Just as the world first came and judged Jesus, Jesus turned the tables and judged the world. He had a way of doing this. Before you know it, all these people are saying all these horrible things about Jesus in that same conversation.

How did he get the upper hand here? I don't know how that happened. Well, there's the idea. And he didn't do it through ugliness and argumentativeness and belligerence and antagonism. He did it very lovingly, very gently, very thoughtfully, but very boldly. Now, Holy Spirit, relationship to the world is one of convicting or convincing. It's exposing the world, it's exposing that the world was wrong and it found Jesus guilty. It's not Jesus that was guilty. It was the world that was guilty. So when I see this taking place, I know the Spirit of God has been very active and involved. And it unveils the nature of certain things. First of all, sin in order to bring about faiths. In terms of righteousness, I say, well, who's righteousness? Because the people were not righteous, but Jesus was righteous. When I hear the Spirit's testimony, I realize that the truth is that death in the cross was not the death of a criminal.

An insurrectionist who got what he deserved, but what it really showed was that this was the death of the sinless son of God that was for the sins of the whole world because everyone else was guilty. And when I see that truth being played out and reinforced and affirmed, I know the Spirit of God has been very active in the context. In terms of judgment, Christ's death on the cross meant God's judgment upon evil. It was not the mere tragedy of or execution of a criminal. Jesus has not been judged and found guilty. The world has. And the Spirit comes to expose the truth of that. But you can remember here the context. Jesus speaking very clearly here in the context of a dealing with the hostility of a world around us. It assumes this. And then finally, I come to the text, the fifth context.

And this is after it's speak about the Spirit is going to, you know, just so there's something you're just not prepared to hear right now. So I'm not going to tell you now, but later on the Spirit will bring out those progressive revelations to you. Help you meet the moment in the future. You're with me. And he goes on to say this. He, the Spirit will bring glory to, and the word is emphasized again, me. By taking from what is mine and making it known to you, all that belongs to the Father is mine. That is why I said the Spirit will take from what is mine and make it known to you. But we get the whole bottle of wax. We get everything. It all belongs to Jesus. He's offering to us. And we step back and see the normity of that promise.

You may not fully understand it, but he's offering you something. Now, I think we can certainly understand the basis of glory. Step away from the Spirit's activity of glorifying Jesus. The Spirit's work is centered in Jesus, points to Jesus, glorifies Him. It's not really that hard to understand. How many of you have ever read the first Corinthians letter? Just kind of basic. Do you remember how it begins, how it kind of gets on to him about something? Do you remember right in the front end? He says, you guys are all divided.

How were they divided? What were they saying at Corinth? If you were one of the members, you were doing something. There were certain legions. But what in the Jesus, it was to who? I'm a Peter. Another group of here. I'm a Paul. Another group of here. I'm a Paulos. And it seems you understand the context that the people were identifying themselves with the spiritual leader that came in and taught them at the time in which they made the choice to be baptized into Jesus. So the person that baptized them became their hero, if you will, and it became the focus of their attention. And so they broke up in all of these little fragments. And so Paul starts with these rhetorical questions. He said, now stop and take a minute. Was Paul crucified for you? And the answer to that is, no.

Were you baptized in the name of Paul? No. Jesus is the focus and center of all this, right? Because I've come, and this made Paul very uncomfortable dealing with this church, although there were some of them that were marching around with raw, raw, you know, cheers on behalf of Paul. You know, who's for a Paul? It's stand up and cheer. And you know, part of the church would get up and wave their confetti and all that kind of stuff. And Paul said, whoa, time out. Then you guys have gone caddy-wanker here. Jesus is the focus. Now, the spirit of God works in me, and I've come to glorify Jesus just as the spirit has.

So let's get the attention on Jesus. Let's glorify Jesus. So that's what Paul did. He called the attention to it. And he adamantly, verbally, written form, and in actions with them, when he was around them, said, you stop, you know, putting me on a pedestal. I'm just another servant just like you. Our role may be different, but people, if they ain't about Jesus, then we've missed the whole point. So let's go back to Jesus. Now, here's saying the spirit's doing this. Not that complicated to understand the intent. It cases back to that model. The spirit does not come to place attention upon himself. When you see that taking place, you should at least stop and pause and be somewhat suspicious. Think it through. If the attention is solely on Jesus, then I can rest assured that the spirit has been active in my life, and that person's life, or in the context in which I'm dealing with.

But where's the attention? Rather than Christ, the Holy Spirit has never has people centering on or interested in an experience of himself, which I've encountered a Norse Mount and used to teach that people should. So I come to Acts 2 as we close. Here we see, for the first time, historically, all of this being played out. Not the only time, but the first time. And we're going to come back and look at the Book of Acts in thoroughness in terms of, because it's really all about the activity of the Spirit of God. We talk about Acts of whom. It was actually apostles. Well, my understanding is really the Acts of the Holy Spirit. And how the Word spread from Jerusalem and to Judea and to Galilee and into the whole world, and how to get there, because the Spirit of God.

Let me just say this. I never applied this to me currently. How I look at this. Let me just say this real

quick. Do I believe I read, you know, the verses before they're talking about the supplemental revelations? I do not believe, I believe the Scriptures are completed. Anyone who suggests they're actually writing additional scriptures, words of God that take the authority in my life, I would be very suspicious of it, don't agree with. But do I believe the Spirit of God does open up for me new vistas to meet the new context of things that I'm dealing with in life, and we as a church dealing with an archetymparade culture, and coming to understand and meet the challenges for us.

So I think the Spirit engages that in helps us in that area. Yes, I do. I think the Spirit of God is actively doing that. If we're open to it. Well, we could say more of it. There it goes. Book of Acts. So we're going to look at this detail. Remember basically what happens. You know, that's where resurrection, ascension is taking place. The disciples have been sitting around twiddling their thumbs into Jerusalem because Jesus is just going to wait and it'll take place. Don't do anything just wait.

So there are. And damn, it happens. I'm Pentecost. Fifty days after the Passover, which is when Jesus was crucified. So, you know, you're dealing with almost two months later after the actual events, the horrific events. Remember, Jesus has been appearing for forty days. They've eaten with them. They've touched him. They've seen what the resurrected body looks like. And why the way what your resurrected body is going to look like. Didn't seem to have the same limitations as these earthly cursed bodies of ours. But the new ones we're going to get. They can beam in, beam out. They can think in ways you can't think right now. I don't know how to put it to you. But it was tangible. He ate with them. They could touch him. He was a physical human being. And he raised that way, by the way.

And he says the same way he left. He's coming back. That's all in the heaven series. I'm going to get to later on. Great stuff. And things that I'm not really sure we've thought through. You know, when you die and go to heaven at any end of the story, that's just the waiting tank until the real moment. When you get your resurrected body. I'm going to have judgment. Well. Holy Spirit. So they're waiting around and boom, it happens. And it's very manifest. You have very tangible issues. The tongues as of fire, lighting on their heads. You have the sound as a mighty rushing wind, which is what drew the masses.

Remember in Pentecost it's thousands of people around. They heard the noise. They started gravitating towards it. And they ended up in front of the apostles. You know, there they are. And they're speaking in tongues. And we're going to talk about all of this. And so Peter wants all the crowds gathered and God's done his thing on his own initiative. The apostles are now filled and emboldened and ready to go. I think the lights are starting to go off. The Spirit's showing up and bam, they're getting it finally. After 40 days of asking Jesus all these questions, oh, are you now going to have a kingdom of God? Jesus. And now it's just the other lights are going off. And I mean, all the synapses are going and life is good. The kingdom of God is ready to launch in ways that haven't before.

So Peter gets up as a spokesman. Now notice what he does. He simply quotes Joel and says, you know that promise that all of us have been waiting for for hundreds of years. Our God is going to pour forth His Spirit upon all mankind. That's what made this era so unique. The launching of the newness of recreation. They started with the resurrection of Jesus. And it was the foreshadowing of what's going to happen to all of us. There's now a whole new energized dimension to life that was not there before. Jesus the first fruits and we're, you know, we possess this new life now, but we get to realize that fullness later, it's a great thing. But the Spirit's coming was what inaugurated all of this. And goes, well, this moment is happening for you right now. And he quotes Joel to shoot Joel to two to them.

And then he goes, now, let me tell you about Jesus. And you hear the first articulated sermon, gospel message, good news from the mouth of Peter. And what did he say? Well, you know this Jesus, you know, the one from Nazareth that no one good and come from. Well, he was good. And fact, he performed a lot of miracles and a lot of you sitting here in his audience were witnesses of those things. Or you least you heard about them. And that was God's seal or approval of this guy was telling the truth.

Why didn't you listen to him in the first place? And you, and by God's four ordained design, he let you kill him. What a surprise to God. It's all falling right as God planned because he came to die for our sins. And you kill them and you bury them in three days later. God raised them from the dead. And he goes on and spent the bulk of that sermon. And it's not word for word, plenary. He's giving you the framework in which Peter preached. But he spent the most of his time patching out to the Jewish monk, multi-Muscriptors, that you see this Messiah was supposed to die. And he was supposed to raise them the grave. Resurrection. Everything hinges on the resurrection. And then he, of course, comes to the conclusion, says, this Jesus who you have crucified, God has made both word and Christ.

And what notice what the result was. So there's the testifying. Here's a man doing it with the embolded presence and fellow accompanied testimony of the Spirit of God himself. Notice, Spirit can testify inside with you. And notice what happens, what's the next verse. And they were cut to the heart. And the Greek is the most intense, gut-riching God got out, got their attention. He said he was just broke. And they say, what do we do? What do we do? We kill God. And God could have turned that place into a crater and been justified. This is what you get. I'm all disappeared. You know, evaporate into a smoker. That's what I would be expecting. Didn't that the world's way? Power. You're on my side. You're in good shape. You ain't on my side. You're in bad shape. And then Peter says, peace.

I've got some for you that's so good you can't imagine. God's going to let all of us in on this anyway. I'm going to save every one of you. If you want. And you invite them all to come in. Repent. Turn. Look me. Be baptized. Every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ. And you shall receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. This promises for you. Jews. That's who is in front of them. And your children. And all those who are far off. By the way, involving all of us here in this room. Unless there is some date of Jews here. Gentiles. As many as the Lord will call. It's just now starting. So. Who got the attention this day. He did. That's how I know the spirit. All those things that were going on. I knew they belonged to the spirit of God.

Because Jesus was the bottom line. Right. And that's the purpose of this class. We will pick up next week. I will begin to ask the question. So. How do I receive the spirit? How do I know I've got it? What the dimensions are there to that. Just a cerebral acknowledgement. Experiential acknowledgement. Can I know? Is it just kind of guesswork? And what does it mean that I actually possess it? You know. Can I? If I had to the question though. If I understand that the spirit is God.

So we're going to talk about. How do I receive God? If you're most it's the same question. But we're going to tweak it in specific context with. Because spirit talks about you receiving the Holy Spirit. Just like in Acts 2 as an example. But it's mentioned a whole lot of other times. So have you? How do you know? Good question. I'll try to kind of peel that one back a little bit. Starting next week. Let's pray.

Class 3: Receiving the Spirit: Faith, Jesus, Baptism, and Fullness

Original transcript: hs03.txt

Summary: Jim begins the question of how Christians receive the Holy Spirit. He argues from Romans, Psalm 51, Galatians 3, John 7, Acts 2, and Colossians 2 that the Spirit is received by grace, in the beginning, through faith centered on Jesus.

Key Scripture References

- [Romans 8:9](#)
- [Psalm 51:11](#)
- [1 Samuel 16:13](#)
- [Galatians 3:1-5](#)
- [Acts 15](#)
- [John 7:37-39](#)
- [Psalm 113-118](#)
- [Isaiah 12:3](#)
- [Isaiah 44:3](#)
- [Acts 2:38-39](#)
- [Colossians 2:6-15](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

Did you receive the Spirit by works of law, or by believing what you heard?

– [Galatians 3:2-3](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Whoever believes in Jesus receives the living water John identifies with the Spirit.

– [John 7:37-39](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Cleaned Transcript

Alright, we are doing a study of the Holy Spirit. I am building I hope in some way that y'all kind of step up with each of these things. I'm framing them around questions and the question that we're now going to enter into and not complete is how do we receive the Holy Spirit? Because I could ask you, you know, so do you have the Holy Spirit? And the downloaded answer is, well I was told I did. Everyone talks about it like I'm supposed to because I'm a Christian. So I guess, yeah I do. And of course that's somewhat of a mindless perception and I'm not sure if that counts.

So how do you know? And I can frame this question in different ways, not only how do you receive the Spirit, how is it received, but can you be a Christian and not have the Spirit into all of you? If so, having the Spirit mean that you're more advanced as a Christian. We can be able to judgment thought. I do know there are those who do think of it in that term. What conditions must be met to receive the Spirit? You know, is there any context for this? So that's kind of where I'm going with this and I hope as we walk through this building block as we get onto some deeper things later that this will be helpful to you. These are all filters. It does matter and you'll hopefully begin to see the practical issues as we get onto some other things.

What I'd like to do, and it's not working Chris, tell me when it's ready. The meaning. I think it's very important to first side. What does it mean that you are actually in dwell for the Spirit in the first place? I think when you figure that out, it perhaps the answer not question. How many read the email I put out today? I just raised the basic question. All right, you know, I hope that this will take you there. Let's

look at a couple text. Romans chapter 8, Paul talks a good bit about the actual indwelling of the Spirit and he keeps saying the Spirit in you, in you, in you, in you. He says it's a multiplications in that text and he says, you are our control not by the sinful nature but by the Spirit if the Spirit of God lives in you.

And if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, notice he does not belong to Christ. All right, think of implications of that. If a person does not have the Spirit, he is not an inferior Christian and if you have the Spirit, you are an advanced Christian. No, it just says you're not a Christian. If you have the Spirit, you're not superior. You know what simply means that you are Christian. Simple enough. You all know about parallelism. If you're teaching this, even remember from high school they come up parallelism. Two statements that are put side by side, one defining the other. Well, you'll find a good bit of that in the Psalms.

Now remember Psalm 51, there's a context for Psalm 51 and remember what it was. King David, you're right, who said that? All right, what was going on in King David's life and context? What prompted him to write this song? Yeah, he had, this is that moment with Bathsheba, it's in the aftermath of all of this. He's caught, you know, red handed, trying to hide it from God. God's people, life is a downspin and he's committed adultery, a child out of wedlock, he's murdered the husband. It's just a really thought thing, but it's pretty deep. He dug for himself. And in the context of this, he writes the song in the aftermath and of course there's a lot of beauty that comes out of this song, his understanding of forgiveness. But he also understands some other things and you'll know what he says and there's a reason that therefore he says it.

That is this. Do not cast me from your presence or paralleled, do not take your Holy Spirit from me. Now, if you pay attention to that in the context, he's telling you what the actual indwelling and presence of the Spirit in your life means to you. If you remember back in first Samuel, when God had identified David as being the new future king and Samuel was the prophet and David shows up where he goes to David and he says he annoy some of the oil and said the Spirit came upon David. There is the reception moment and David knew about the Spirit's empowering of his life and presence in his life. And so in the aftermath, now he's wondering, well, God, are you now going to withdraw yourself from me? And there was his concern.

So what are we learning from this? Very simply that the indwelling Spirit means something. It means that we have fellowship with God, that God has fellowship with us through His Spirit. That's what the actual presence of the Spirit means in your life. It's a relational issue. Of course, as I just simply raised a question, if the Holy Spirit is God, then how do you answer questions? How do we receive the Holy Spirit? It's the same question as how do you receive God? Is it not? Well, it should be. You should find some parallels with that.

So now, let me take you to this. And this is one of those little filters that makes sense if we get more into this context of this. But let me play this out for you. This is a little taste of theology. And yes, it does have some practical implications later on. So pay attention. This is something that I encountered a great deal of in my college years. There was a time that this is where I saw it. And if I were to teach it, this is what I would have taught. But some things kind of intervened on that. And I said, I don't think I agree with this anymore. That is this. That conversion or your Christian life basically comes in two stages. You have your initial moment of conversion. But you're not complete yet as a Christian. You're considered incomplete. That is, you receive a partial filling of the Spirit. The Spirit comes in fragmentation.

And later on, you kind of get to this upgrade. We'll get to this in a minute. You go through kind of an upgrade, a supplement. That is what it actually returned the second work of grace. Which is a bit interesting. The second work, grace, when you get to this up here. But that you receive the Spirit later on. And some reason I put a question mark is the timeframe is unknown. It's different between person

to person, depending on your experiences. That later on, you receive the second work of grace where the Spirit of God comes in fullness to your life.

So now if I hold on to this as a framework of how things work from God, then I'm going to be obviously pursuing this. And how you pursue this is you do certain things. You yield your life more fully. You surrender your life. You go through a purifying. You perfect your life. You get your life at a state where the Spirit can come in its fullness. So just kind of let that settle with you for a second. And start thinking what are the implications of this.

By the way, this is a very common framework, although you may not hear it articulated this way. This is what's being suggested to you. In fact, I would say this is probably the most common hell view in Christendom in America today. Now, let's go to some texts. And I think we'll find that God does help us frame this. I don't want to finish this class. I want you to just give you enough to start weighing some of this and then we'll finish this up next week. Galatians chapter three. Now, before we actually read the text, you all start looking at the text. Tell me what Galatians is about. There's a context of this. It's always important to understand the context. Don't just plop in the middle of something. Start reading it. If you don't know context, then you can run a thousand different ways with this and miss the actual fundamental point.

Why did Paul write the letter of Galatians? It's really one fundamental issue. Yeah, pardoned. It's over one issue. What is the one issue that keeps coming up? The Paul keeps talking about Galatians. And it was a Jewish thing that was being bound upon Gentiles. Circumcision. All right. Now, Galatians, you got the Mediterranean Sea. You got Palestine and up. North region up there is Galatians. One of the first places Paul went when he did his first missionary trip and started sharing a gospel and a bunch of people up there were Gentiles became Christians. Word got down to Jerusalem to Jewish Christians. He said, hey, there's these Gentile creatures up there. Some of them were sent up there and traveled up there to go check them out.

So it was their job to check them out and be the gatekeeper of the side. Whether or not they could be really Christians or not. Redox, it comes out of this. In fact, Acts 15, a big pow while I have one of all the leaders of church came together and ironed us out. And it was almost duked out. It was over this issue. Those are the big to do. So these Jewish Christians come up there and said, oh, are you Christians? They said, yes, we're Christians. They said, that's wonderful.

So have you been circumcised talking to, of course, the nails and they said circumcision? Well, no. Oh, well, that's a problem. You're not really a Christian then. What you've Paul didn't finish up the message. He didn't give you everything you needed. So what you need to do now is you guys, I mean, sorry to say, but if you really want to be a Christian, you want to be a completed Jew. Because that's where it came from. We're the origin of this thing. God gave the law. The law was not meant to be put aside. So here, you guys just line up and let's go. And we're going to make you real Christians by being circumcised. Of course, Paul gets wind of this. And man, if you read this letter, he starts off saying it's anyone. I mean, anyone preaches you a gospel other than the one you've already received from me, let that person be condemned. Let him go.

If they say something different, what I've already told you, big issue. This is not some peripheral issue. It's not Jesus plus circumcision. It's just Jesus. And Paul went to Jerusalem, ready to fight this one out. Acts 15. Of course, they were all listening to the spirit of God, which is the language used in Acts 15. They all came to peace on this one. And they didn't bind us on those Gentile Christians. So the church listened to God. So let's remember the bottom line was they were really sensitive to God and they did what they were supposed to do. But it was a really difficult issue for the Jewish Christians to see these Gentiles on equal footing when they weren't following their law.

So there's the context of this letter. Now, it'll make more sense then when you read how Paul comes at

them to remind these now confused, baffled, disoriented Gentile Christians up there, who've been having these influence from these Jewish Christians who've been telling them that they weren't really Christians, how to work through this and those he does it theologically. That is, he hasn't even thanked. How does God teach you? How did it work out? And he's going to ask a question, how did you receive the Spirit? He actually asks the question. So it's a very direct text. You foolish Galatians because some of them had bought into this and Paul's really getting on to them. They should have known better. Who has bewitched you? Is there so someone cast a spell on you and you just forgot everything that I told you and you just jipped on the van wagon and bunch of you have already been circumcised thinking that somehow that earned you a relationship with God through the law.

What's happened to you before your very eyes, Jesus Christ was clearly portrayed as crucified. Those crucifixion of Jesus and grace go together. I would like to learn just one thing from you. Now, notice his argument. Okay, I just want to make sure I didn't break this text down. Did you receive? Now, notice I got an old phrase in here. I define the grammar of this. The word receive. What is it? What is it? What? What tense is it in? It's a aorist tense. Now, I'm not trying to get you technical. I'm not trying to lose you guys. I just want you to understand that Paul's saying something very specifically and you want to study this text. You got to know this stuff. aorist tense is something that took place at a specific point in time in the past. Did you receive a spirit in the past and they were there for or it's assumed that Paul says, you know what I'm talking about. When you see the spirit, I said, yes, remember, see even a spirit back back in our past, the spirit by observing the law or by believing what you heard.

One question and there's only two options. Do you see that? How did you receive the spirit? You got one, two ways. You can work for it or you receive it as a grace. So which one are you going to choose? Now, when you see the grace issue, you see how that affects us up here? You're doing it by your own actions or you're doing it by grace. You can't have both. Same framed idea. Today, and what I was referring to, what I struggled with is that the Holy Spirit comes to different people in different ways, different times under certain conditions. And it's kind of a just, you know, yeah, we all get the spirit of God, but you know, every person is comparing an apple with an orange there. You just can't put them together and say there's some consistency in terms of how God approaches people when it comes to receiving the spirit.

But Paul seems to frame this in very simple terms. How did you receive a spirit? Works along. You work your way. You earn it. You just get a position where God says, OK, this guy's life is so ready now. I'll just give it to him like he's not now that he's got his life where it's ought to be. Because that's a certain theology there. We'll get to that in just a minute. What that assumes that you get your life together before the spirit comes. So you could get your life together without the power of God. If a spirit of God is indeed doing us, we'll talk about that later. I want you to say that Paul holds no such idea. Paul's question, did you receive the Holy Spirit by heroic deeds, yielding, surrender, purifying your life where by another means that he says down here, I believe in what you heard. We'll get to that in just a moment.

There he goes on to say this. Notice after what? Beginning with the spirit. So where does Paul place the reception process? The beginning of what? Beginning of faith, the beginning of keep, keep translating. When you became when you believed what you heard. Some texts have a hearing of faith. You hear the message of Jesus, you believe it and you receive the Holy Spirit. So, you know, in quote, did you receive Holy Spirit by doing all the law? Did you simply listen to the message of Jesus and it was as it was proclaimed and believe it and you get the spirit. When does the Holy Spirit come? At the beginning of the Christian life, not somewhere undefined and unknown portion later on, a second work of grace, but in the beginning. It seems very simple and you all also assume that these people got this. They knew this. In other words, he's asking rhetorical questions and they're answering it.

The Holy Spirit doesn't come after yielding and praying and proving yourself. It's not now that I'm a Christian. I'm going to seek the Holy Spirit now and its fullness. The Holy Spirit really does help as it

seems to me that I need them in the beginning when my life's amassed, not after I've somehow worked it out of my own and made myself a better receptor for it. Understand? The practicality of this? If you accept the theology that you get your life together, then you receive the false spirit. You're saying that you do this on your own power. Can you live the moral ethical demands of living like Jesus in this world unless God is empowering you to do it? If you can, then you don't need God and you don't need the Holy Spirit. Nor do you need Jesus dying on the cross for you to do it. But if I need God, if I need His empowerment, His help in my weakness, then I don't need Him after I've worked and surrendered and done all these things I'm supposed to do. I need Him in the beginning because I can't get there without Him.

I can do nothing apart from Him. Jesus felt that way. We should feel that way. I think it was on the side. Have you suffered so much for nothing? If it really was for nothing, does God give and hear its presence? That is, He has presently given and is continuously given. In other words, God gave you the Spirit, a *orus tense*. Now He's saying, does God continue to offer a Spirit to you? Does it continue to reside? Does God continue to stay in a relationship with your life personally? Does He give you a Spirit and work miracles among you because you observe the law or because you believe what you heard? Again, grace, grace, grace is constantly the argument of Paul. And I understand my way is arguing about He's talking about the circumstances in issue with those Christians up in Galatia.

You understand the context and this makes sense. So I answer the question so far, how do we receive the Spirit? Number one, grace simply by faith. And very specifically, again, number two, in the beginning. When Jesus and I connected. Okay, now let's build on that. John 7, very interesting text. I love the gospel of John. On the last and greatest day of the feast, I need to give you a framework for this as well. It's worth knowing. First of all, do you know what Feast He's talking about? It is Feast of Tabernacles. Now, there were three major feast days in the Jewish year. Big celebrations like our Christmas and Easter was the Feast of Pentecost, Feast of Tabernacles and the Feast of Passover. On those major feast days, every male I think was 15 or over, if you lived within a certain, you know, within 15 or so miles, you're expected to be in Jerusalem engaging this moment.

It was, you know, I mean, who would want to, you know, take time off of work and feast for a week. So it was a, you know, a big deal. It's like someone invited to the Super Bowl. Come on and come to Super Bowl and everyone wants to go. And that's why people from all over the Mediterranean world, even those who live very far away, would take long, long pilgrimages, sometimes, you know, months at a time just to arrive in Jerusalem. So they can at least once in their life experience these moments in the presence of God, because we're the dwell in the temple. And that's where it was and that's what they wanted to be. So the closer you got to the temple, the closer you were to God. Well, that's for free. At least in their minds. The, you know, Feast of Tabernacles was rather interesting. Every day for the seven days of the feast, you know, since the last day of the feast was the seventh day, they carried on a water ceremony.

So the priest on duty that day would take one of the golden, holy vessels, a pitcher, and he would walk down to the downhill outside the water gate, which you'll see why it's called a water gate just a minute. And there was a, the pool salon. And he would fill it up. Now all the people were, were following in a parade and they carried two different kind of branches in their hands. One was a citrus branch. And once was a lullaby camera, which kind of branch it was. We're just seeing old oak tree and maple tree branch, right? And they're walking down and they are singing songs as they're waving the branches. And they're singing the Hallel Psalms, Psalm 113, 118. You can read them later. They would sing these songs. They would also be citing certain texts like Isaiah 12-3, which speaks about how God will draw water from the well of salvation.

And he's talking about Isaiah 44-3. We're talking about he will pour water on the thirsty land. And streams will, will go out onto the dry land. And I will pour out my spirit upon all mankind. You see that he associates water with the spirit of God using the imagery that

they experienced in the desert. And this is very extra in their mind. It's their history. They understand this stuff. And they understand when they're singing these verses. And so we sat in these verses in celebration of this moment. Now what did God do in the desert when it came to water? They got thirsty so God supplied water from a rock. And of course that's the Moses figure. Remember Moses predicted a prophet would come greater than him. And Jesus is associating him here himself with this moment. I'm that guy by the way. He's being very direct about it. And by the way at the end of this chapter they want to stone him. Well there's a reason because he's claiming something that he's not allowed to claim. He's claiming to be God. And they don't like this.

– [Isaiah 44:3](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

So rather than hiding back, this is really what you got to get out of this chapter in John 17. Jesus is almost antagonistic about this. I will not go and hide about this issue. You want me just to go with the flow? Just acknowledge myself as a typical frat rabbi like the rest of you guys being underling under you. Great superior guys. But I'm telling you I am this God. The one promise from the Old Testament. The one is calm. I am the Messiah. I am the anointed. And I've come to offer you the spirit of God. And they understood this by these ceremonies. Well this is the last and greatest day of the feast. And they've just there somewhere in this parading process. Jesus stops it.

Now in that context, notice what he says. Jesus stood instead in a loud voice. A lot of people. If anyone is thirsty. But it's thirst. Hear these people thinking about being in the desert that our ancestors parched. But they understood it was more than simply the tangible water that God brought from the desert. And not only thanking God for the rains that they currently received. Because they were agricultural society and how they needed God to send the rains so they could sustain life. Which is part of what the Feast of Tabernacles was about. But they understood it also metaphorically, spiritually.

Notice whoever believes in me as the scriptures has said. Stream. Those are trickles. Overwhelming flood of waters will flow from within him. Now if you know the gospel of John, John will often say, you know, we didn't really get it when Jesus said it at that moment. But now that I've thought about it, the spirit of God has illuminated this in my life. Let me tell you what it means. And he gives these parentheticals. And he does it throughout the gospel of John. He goes, here's one of those moments. Let me tell you what he meant. By this, he meant the spirit whom those who believed in him were later to receive. Most hadn't been given yet. Up to that time, the spirit had not yet been given since Jesus had not yet been glorified.

So John, been very careful so you can see the connection between Jesus and the receiving of the spirit. You disconnect those, you got bad theology. Now, beautiful context. But the simple question, again, trying to answer the question, how do you receive the spirit? Well, thirdly, faith, not just faith, but faith in Jesus. I already knew that. That's assumed. No, it's not assumed. Whether it's assumed to that audience, that's what got him as much trouble when he said it. It's not what people necessarily believe today. Not what I was taught for a portion when I was circulating around certain groups and trying to learn and figure this out. I wanted to spirit and wanted to make sure I had all of it and wasn't sure if I did or not. I went through this process and basically I was told to have faith in the spirit.

In fact, I was articulated out on more than one occasion, very directly. Not by assumption, but by you need to put your faith in the spirit. I said, okay, so now I got my faith in Jesus and I got my faith in the spirit. And it kind of said, well, it's the same thing to the both God. All I know is the text is very clear. Jesus says, they in need. Now, let's go back to our basic key phrase. The spirit's work is what centered in Jesus Christ. Say it with me again out loud. The spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. The spirit does not come to point to himself. The spirit is active when you see him pointing away from himself to Jesus. When you see Jesus being highlighted, Jesus being glorified, Jesus being the center of attention, you know the spirit of God has been active.

Again, I keep telling you if you pay attention to that vessel I created and fill it up with things I'm giving you here, it will actually have a practical implication of how you filter through all the narrative things you're being told or encounter. I just watch television and I run into this and I struggle with it. Man, I don't want to miss this. I mean, I don't want to miss any of God. I want all right. So, so what is the condition? I fate in the beginning, Paul says, and that fate is in Jesus. One more text will pick up next week. Well, for those views from Restoration Roots and First of Christ, this is a familiar text. It's funny though how I heard this text. I could quote it without even really caring too when I got out of high school and I always missed this.

We never talked about this aspect of it. And we're going to go back. By the way, I'm going to take you through the book of Acts very quickly. It's really fascinating to look at because the spirit activity there is very demonstrative and you learn a great deal. And it's also where there's a lot of confusion, at least why I got confused. And I would say the other is like a fusion beyond just myself, but I certainly own part of it. I remember this the first time the message of Jesus was ever articulated. It's 50 days after the death, burial, resurrection of Jesus, Jesus went through 40 days of resurrection of appearances. These guys, I mean, they knew. Jesus was physical body, but he kind of beamed him, beamed out. They knew something different about him. He didn't have the same limitations. Resurrection wasn't. He wasn't a disembodied spirit ghosting in and out. He was a tender. He ate with them. They talked with them. They got to touch him. They experienced him with all their senses.

This is these, although they had trouble recognizing them sometimes, but I always find that interesting to like the road to Emmaus, but that's we don't have time. Jesus preached. You have the outpouring of the spirit. This promise that has been made for centuries. All of a sudden happened. They preached a message of Jesus that people says are cut to the heart. You know, we haven't been really sitting and thinking where they are. We'll do this later on. These guys were just, I mean, I can't quite, you know, I remember getting caught doing some really bad things by my parents. I remember when I almost fainted. They scared my dad, but I felt like it was the wall when he caught me drinking them. And I mean, I'm talking just, well, that's what these guys were. They were just like, I mean, just a little impeter response with them.

So, you know, we hear these words. We just, you know, seem to just a little slice of theology. Here's a point 1.2. We missed the whole point of this. It bothers me that we missed the point of these moments. But if you take the time to understand the context, it means so much more. Peter replied, by the way, in between the lines, there's hope, guys, don't panic. Repent and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. The part, you know, the forgotten God part. I could quote if I had an athlete no idea what it meant growing up. And you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. Now, if you were a Jew, you understood it because they didn't promise you this all throughout Old Testament prophecies. Good theology.

And the promise is for you, you Jews right here now, and your children, your ancestors, just trace them on to the future, and to all who are far off, even to these Gentiles. Although, I'm not sure if Peter quite grasped that one yet. In other words, he's coming out of prophecies and they keep saying, you know, like the Gentiles, Gentiles get it too, but they're always thinking they're going to be kind of stepped children to us Jews. You've got superior Christian Jews and you've got these guys that won't let them come on in and it's going to live on the outhouse and claim to be Christian. You with me are Messiah to all who are far off. No, even they get the Spirit of God. Well, you put that together. You get the Spirit. What do you get? Okay, we're for all whom the Lord God will call.

Now, okay. Well, let me just do this. I would say that if you just look at justice text, it's building on the issue and we're going to come back to this. My faith in the beginning that focus of faith is in the person of Jesus. I'm not seeing with my attention and my energy put on the Spirit of God and getting them and trying to coerce them into getting into my life. No, that energy is put toward Jesus and then I

thirst for him, that relationship of God, that intimacy, that yearning that's deep inside that God put in there that I tend to ignore. Well, I'm pursuing all the other trivial pursuits of my life, the inferiorities of my life. God, but if you put your face in Jesus and you try to let him quench your thirst, you believe in him, you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.

That is a very dynamic promise. So I would say through or in the context of, clearly here, baptism. Now, I got more to say about this. You know, it's not the only place that Paul and other people talk about this. In this case, it was Peter. Really, it's Luke writing about what Peter said. So before we end, let me get you to just go and read something. Colossians chapter 2. I'm going to start there. I think it'd be good if I started there. I might put it in the slide. It's not in the slide right now. Colossians 2, but I'm going to ask you, what's the context of Colossians? To you understand the context, Colossians just like to you understand the context. What was going on?

In other words, why did Paul write this church in Colossians? What was going on there that made it so necessary? Paul didn't just like to say, you know, something, I just love those people over in Colossians so much. I'll just write a letter and just make up a bunch of things whether it's going on over there or not. Obviously, there were things that were, they call the occasion or things happening there. And Paul gets wind of them and goes, man, I need to, you know, I'm the apostle. I'm the one who's responsible for the faith of these people and how they develop and what they believe and how they act and live. And they need to be tweaked a little bit because they've kind of marched into something like these Galatians do that is warping their Christian lives. And they started with how they believed. And so he writes this letter and has a lot to do with Jesus again as you'd expect.

They got Jesus wrong to get Jesus wrong. You get yourself wrong. So Colossians 2, and he's going to speak about receiving God in fullness. The Greek word, *pleroma*. And now think of fullness. When you run that text in Colossians 2, you'll get, well, we'll get the fullness of God. And when do you receive fullness in God? There's the question that he's going to raise there because they're thinking they got it in stages. You get a little bit of Jesus and you get a little bit when you add all these other addendums to it.

What scholars call the Colossian heresy because of such a unique gathering of different beliefs that they can, they had to just, they just labeled it Colossian heresy. And I want you to read the chapter and that knows the question, he's answering. What happens when you get Jesus? And that word fullness is planted right in the middle of it. So what is he telling you? Yes? He goes back to the Greek word. When we said the spirit was considered in Christ, what does that say? You are a chronicle leader of the Jesus Christ who started to look into that. Is that, is that the spirit as well? Are you saying the spirit prompting his interest to me? Yes, if we don't receive it. I'm sorry to say that did you work even if those people lied for them to look for Christ?

Good question. And I'll tell you, scholarship can take you over here and over here with that. I've got some alive things. The spirit's work is centered in. If Jesus is being the emphasized, glorified, pursued person, then I assume what? That the spirit is active. Of course, you believe this. How do you resist the spirit? Not just that. God can't find invitation on coercion. Have we not all learned this in our own lives? If God worked by coercion, every one of the faces of the earth would be a believer and they would be perfect. Do this or die. Do this or put a pressure on a punch right now. Okay, I'll do it. I mean, God, God, most powerful being the creator, he can do anything he wants. He has the power to force any issue he wishes, but he chooses not to.

Thus, the whole story of Jesus, which seems rather indirect way to get our attention. There are more demonstrative ways to overwhelm us, but God chooses not to overwhelm us. He invites. Even the miracles, look at the mirror, this is all for Fred. We're out of the class here, but all the miracles, they know how subtle and non-demonstrative they are. Sometimes, Jesus would form miracles and say, I don't want anyone to know about this. So, I'll let you, Peter, you're Peter, you got to come, but, and just don't

say nothing about it. Always playing it down, always being very unassuming about the whole process when the power of God is being exerted. The Cross of Christ is an appeal. It's a, boy, I love you and please come, and it's a very powerful one, but there's another course about it. Well, God, the Spirit, is no different. That is His, He's gentle, He's patient, He's kind, He is what He produces, the fruit of the Spirit.

And so, do I think the Spirit is creating, orchestrating, drawing, yes, absolutely. And of course, the question, well, how, is it simply because of the message, you know, He inspires a message, someone gets up and preaches Jesus, so that's the Spirit. Well, I say, that is the Spirit call, that's the Spirit talking. But it's the accurate message of Jesus, that's the Spirit talking. But is there, you know, is the order of those things? Is He operate? We talk about the providence of God, God somehow involved in mysterious ways in our world and creating certain stances in our own life and lives of others, helping missionaries reach people. Yeah, I think it's a spirit of God. Well, we're going to get more into that stuff later for good question and a debated one. Well, anyway, let's end there. We'll pick up the Colossians to pay attention to us. We're going to pick up next week and it's a really, it's a profound lesson that you're going to learn when you understand what Paul's saying to the clock and the context of it.

Let's pray.

Class 4: Fullness in Christ and the Washing of Rebirth

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Summary: This class completes the receiving-the-Spirit question. Jim connects 1 Corinthians 12, Colossians 2, Titus 3, and John 3 to present faith, baptism, fullness in Christ, and the Spirit's renewal in the new birth.

Key Scripture References

- [Romans 8](#)
- [Psalm 51](#)
- [Galatians 3](#)
- [John 7](#)
- [Acts 2:38-39](#)
- [1 Corinthians 12:12-13](#)
- [Colossians 2:8-15](#)
- [Titus 3:4-7](#)
- [John 3:3-5](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

We were all baptized by one Spirit into one body and given one Spirit to drink.

– [1 Corinthians 12:13](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

God saved us through the washing of rebirth and renewal by the Holy Spirit.

– [Titus 3:4-7](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Cleaned Transcript

Through questions, they're the questions that I had and I have. I've taught this class before. It evolves because I evolve. I was there certain things over the years, theologically, that I've kind of anchored into, although I've moved a few anchors over the years. But when I say anchor, the things that I feel fairly fixed on and that, you know, I don't flippantly just pick up one and cast it elsewhere unless I really see it. And the study of Holy Spirit can be lead you into a lot of distraction or lead you into great blessings. I'm obviously hoping the latter. I guess in some ways you have to go through some of the distractions because there is so much confusion about it. And I don't know anyone that really has the absolute perfect fix on this thing. I read enough scholars and commentaries and on and on and on over the years.

And I started this study literally when I was in college. And I'll talk more about that later. But I remember sitting in the privacy of my life, being very confused about this and it mattered to me because I was really just, I guess the word would be embroiled into confusion of this. And it kind of hung me up because of my experiences. And so I remember sitting down with just a stream of three-ring notebook paper and I wrote the questions, who went where and why about the Holy Spirit? And I ran to a text that the Holy Spirit in it. I stopped and tried to answer those questions if it answered them. And then I tried to pull it all together and figure out, well, so what do I come out of this with? And that's where it started for me.

And I'm still trying to work through some of these things. But I'm hoping that I can help accelerate some of your thinking. I'm not here to have just affirm what you believe. But I will tell you what I understand from scriptures that I think God is saying. And you know, in that what we are an integrity pursuing in the first place. What has God actually said? Has he spoken and what has he actually said?

Those are really the two fundamental questions of encountering listening to God. And so anyway, that was for free. This is where we started last week, there's a question, how do we receive the Holy Spirit? And just quickly, just remember what we went.

First of all, it said it's very important that we define what does it mean, though, to possess the Spirit, the meaning of it. And we understood, looking at Romans 8, Psalm 51, that understanding that it would make sense. Of course, the Holy Spirit is a person. It is the person of God. And that he actually comes in dwell us. It's really the question of the meaning behind the receiving of the Spirit as to do with God's fellowship with us. God actually relates to us. God intimately comes in relationship with us through His Holy Spirit. I think that is why, and I didn't mention this last week, why the scriptures speak about you currently present tense possessing eternal life. Eternal life is that which has relationship with God. That's what was lost in the garden, the curse, the separation from God.

And ever since that moment, God has been re-bridging that moment. Now, if you pay attention, that's what makes heaven heaven. When God ultimately, and is fully realized, the kingdom of God, coming down to earth, and we have, in the fullest sense, face to face, this renewed, restored relationship with God without the curse, without all the things that went along with that. And the Spirit is a deposit, we're going to get to this later on, that's put that seal there. He's set it in motion, and that we're already presently realizing this relationship with God on a very intimate level. So, there you go.

Then we, I just put this in front of you, because this was some of the struggles that I went through, where a comment teaching today, and it kind of hung me up, and where it's suggested that you really go through two stages basically in your Christian life, in terms of the Holy Spirit, that you receive the least of the Spirit in partial filling on the front end of conversion. But later on, a second work of grace comes your way, where the Spirit comes in fullness. And I'm asking you to stop and think about that, and the implications of that, because that will come into play throughout the rest of this semester. And you've been exposed to it, whether you realize it or not. And I hope in a way you're already beginning to connect some doubts. We're going to come back to this one in a few minutes before we get through with our class tonight, as I complete this question.

We looked at Galatians, remember chapter three, and remember the first of all that it says in this text that we receive the Spirit by faith. Not by works, not by heroic deeds, not by you're doing something. You receive it when you put your faith in Jesus, and then Paul made the commentifications. Having begun with the Spirit, are you now trying to earn him through human effort? And so, again, this idea that is in the beginning. Then we went to the text in John 17. It's a glorious text. The day of the last day of the feast of Tabernacles, when Jesus stood there, as they were just literally parched and thirst. And this ceremony, the water ceremony, where they would take the vessel, and they would scoop it up from the Pool of Siloam, and they would march back to the temple, to the Water Gate, and they would celebrate.

And it was a celebration of God sending the rains for their harvest, but it was a reflection back, and thankful that God delivered the water there in the desert, and striking the rock. But there was also this understanding of this promise. Remember, as Jesus went on to talk, he was talking about how he is the fulfillment of this promise, that God would one day, just as we see water being poured upon the parched lands there, as they walked through the desert, God would then pour forth His Spirit upon His people. And this promise has trailed and lingered with the Jews all through their history as an incredible moment of anticipation. We're going to get to that here in just a little while, but understood, as part of that theology, the Spirit, and when Jesus was on the earth, had not yet been given, not in this way, not this promise, but it is coming to fruition through the life of Jesus.

And as he parched, and he goes to his death, burial, resurrection, ascension, then the Spirit of God is going to come. Remember, we talked about that in John 14, 15, and 16 prior to this. So we talked about, not only is it by faith, and in the beginning, but I think it's very important that the focus of that

faith is not in the Spirit of God, the focus of that faith is in Jesus Himself. And I think that becomes an important focus that you're going to find, comes to help you later on as we look at this. Now, this is where we left off last week. We talked about this text, and it gives you this, and we walk through, I'm not going to walk through the whole context that's really kind of neat. Of course, Acts chapter 2, Pentecost, things are kind of storming in. The promise fulfilled of the Spirit finally coming.

This is 40 days, 50 days after Jesus' death, burial, resurrection, the Pentecost, 50 days after Passover. And of course, you see the issue here, as he responded to those people who had crucified Jesus, who had turned and blinded I to all the miracles, who rejected Jesus as God preordained and knew it would take place. But through that death, he would save all of us. And then as this appeal comes out rather than destruction, he says, there's hope for you guys. And he calls them to repent and to be able to immerse themselves in connection with Jesus. Through baptism, and another, no, the other promise is they would receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. And this is for everybody. Now, let's pick up there. I gave you all a text to read last week and told you to think about it, does anyone remember what that is?

Okay, we'll get to that in just a minute. I'm just curious if anyone actually remembers. One other text though, now, let me build upon this, then we're going to get to the clashes to passage. And I don't know how long I'll keep it tonight. I hope not the entire time that we normally do. I'm going to say my piece and we're going to be done. 1 Corinthians. Now, I'm trying to take the time to get, let you see that there's a context for what Paul writes. Don't just look at the verse and understand the broader context. Understand the broader context. You understand the specifics that he's getting into. Now, the church in Corinth had a lot of different issues going on within them. If you read the first letter to the Corinthians, Paul just basically has this long list. And he starts basically one to time choosing them out and responding to them.

Some of these issues that he's responding to are because they have written him questions. Starting in verse 70, he starts chapter 7 saying, now about the things that you wrote to me about. And now he's just lining them up and talking about them. And they come in units throughout first Corinthians letter. One of the units is chapters 12, 13, 14. And if you see the broader context, they were disunified. They were splintered and fragmented in several ways. One of the ways that they were fragmented was because of their use of the gifts of the Spirit. And you'll talk about this in context. And the fundamental problem that they were having is that they were using the gifts for all the wrong reasons.

What was in question was not the gift. What was in question was their lack of love toward each other. They were using them to parade themselves and to show off their gifts, especially interestingly enough in this context, those who were tongue speakers. And it was a very flashy gift. And so they were saying, look at me, look at me, look at what God how he uses me. And they were assuming that because they had the gift that they somehow were also that was equivalent to being mature. And Paul says, possessing a gift does not make you mature. You guys may call them infants in Christ. You guys may be able to have some talented gifts that the Spirit is trying to work through you. But you're acting like children because you're so selfish in how you're going about using them.

If you understand the gifts, they were meant to be used cohesively together to build up all of us. And he uses the word edifice to edify throughout the text, especially when you get to chapter 14. So it's in that context that Paul begins to share these things. So there's, now let's look at the smaller window. The body is a unit, though it is made up of many parts. And though all of its parts are many, they form one body. We look at this text back. We talked about the Spirit himself talking about the idea of unity and diversity. The Spirit that God does the idea of the Trinity, that God is three and one. And it's hard for us to grasp this fully. How can God, there be one God and yet there's God the Father, God the Son, God the Holy Spirit.

I'm not going to go back and retrace all that. But we talked about this text because what God creates, you see that complexity. And we should not expect God to be less complex than what He creates. We

looked at that text as an idea, that the body of Christ, we, though we are many members, we form one body. Now there's where He's going with us. He's dealing with the disunity within their mess. And specifically, how they are being disunified by their use of the gifts of the Spirit. Now, He says notice, for we were all, or so and so it is with Christ. Now, here's how He's going to kind of draw them together. He's making an argument with them. He's trying to get, let me appeal to you to think about this. If the body is one, though it is many. Now, why would that be so?

And He makes an appeal to a universal experience that everyone who's a believer shares in common. He says this, for we were all baptized by one Spirit into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, labor free. And we were all given the one Spirit to drink. Now, if I were just simply to ask you the simple question, when do we find ourselves actually being a part of, cohesively joining in with the one body, according to Paul. The baptized into one body. Now, He didn't say some of you knows what I've underlined. All, all, all. He's referring to a universal agenda with these people. And in light of Paul's statements, is it possible that only some had received the Holy Spirit? No, because this is something that all have received. No. Paul's point. Though there are many members, we are all one body. Why?

Because there is one experience for all Christians without exception. And all Christians were made to, and I use an interesting phrase here, where we are given the one Spirit to drink. And in the waters of baptism, we drink in the Spirit. We take the Spirit in. And that interesting language there. Of course, it tends to tie itself in with, once again, by faith in Jesus in the beginning. Now, let's go back to this thing and get you to see this in contrast now with what a little bit we've looked at. Again, the idea that the Christianity comes to you in stages, your growth process. And that God acts in your life on the initial conversion stage.

The point you receive a partial reception of the Holy Spirit. And that there is this anticipation that you're supposed to carry with you, where you kind of upgrade. That it becomes supplemental. What they call the second work of grace is what you'll read scholars using the phraseology. It's the common phrase for this idea of what you should anticipate. Just God comes back kind of second work of grace. But what strikes me is that what bridges those two things together are things that you do. The reason you don't get the fullness of the Spirit is because you're not yet prepared for it. You're not holy enough. You're not yielded enough. You're not surrendered enough to God. You're not purified enough. So, after going through this, this arduous process of cleansing your life up a little bit more and making it more ready as a receptor for the fullness of the Spirit, and when you finally get to that point, and it's different from person to person, the timing is different from person to person, then bam, it just happens to you.

And we're going to talk more about that later in terms of the theology of where that comes from. So, you've seen this upgrade moment where you go from one stage to another. In other words, you see the conversion and reception process being fragmented. You'll at least see that much. Am I making sense to you? Now, let's look at Colossians and conduct this. This is the text I want you to look at, and I hope you'll see why I have you looked at this. Okay, context of Colossians. Can anyone tell you what the context of Colossians is? Because this means absolutely nothing if you don't understand the basic framework of the letter. Yes?

Okay, okay. What else? Good. Good. That's a good question. What else is he suggesting to you? What were these false teachers? Okay, well, let me tell you. I was curious if y'all looked around with this one all. He starts by saying this, see to it that no one takes you, knows, captured through hollow and deceptive philosophies. Which depend on human tradition and the elemental spiritual forces of this world rather than on Christ. Now, if you read on later on, we're going to read now what sandwich in between, but later on he starts to describe this. And he says, let me just pull through it and take you to a few texts in case you're actually writing this down.

Okay, verse 16. Therefore, do not let anyone judge you by what you eat or drink, so we're dealing with dietary laws. Sound familiar? The Jews had a very clear dietary laws, so you see some Jewish elements

where people were binding upon these Christians in class, I say, you're not a real Christian unless you also keep all these Jewish dietary laws, or with regard to religious festivals and new moon celebrations and Sabbath day. Not only did it go, maintains the eating dietary laws, but there were all these feast days that are also mandated to make your Christianity legit.

So you've got all these feast days that were bound upon your life. And then he goes on and said, these are shadow. Then he goes on verse 18. Do not let anyone who delights in false humility and in worship of angels disqualify you for the prize. You have this interesting little element of this unhealthy focus upon this worship and direction of angels in the context of this. And then he goes on, such persons go into great detail about what he has seen, so they're claiming certain visions. You got kind of an elitist Christian who's saying, well, I've had this vision about heaven, and I've seen the angels, and I've talked them about this and this, and you haven't. So, you know, I'm more connected, and if you're really full of God the way I am, you'll have these experiences too.

And that should begin to maybe connect some dots with how you hear the spirit talked about today. And then he goes on to say, since you've, verse 20, since you have died with Christ to the best principles of this world, why? As though you still belong to it and do you submit to its rules? Do not handle. Do not taste. Do not touch. Obviously there was also some elements of asceticism, Greek asceticism that was implanted into this. And so there was this lifestyle placed upon these Christians that not only had all these rules and regulations, a dendum to your faith in Jesus, but also this kind of self-abasing lifestyle of denial that was enforced upon you in specifics. You can't do this, you can't do that, you can't do this, a true Christian doesn't have that fullness, a way of life that those maybe in the world do.

So you do not handle. Do not taste. Do not touch. And it's a very unusual eclectic mixture. They don't find parallels to that in the other letters of Paul, but the other churches were having. But in Colossae, which was just kind of due east of Ephesus. So you know where Ephesus is on the shore of Asia and just go inside and there's Colossae. They call the Colossian heresy. To put it very simply, it is this to me. It's a Jesus plus religion. Jesus is not enough.

So you need Jesus plus whatever a dendum you want to add to this to make you a legit Christian because you're not full until you have Jesus and all of these things. And I hope that you're beginning to stop saying, well, do we do that today? Now notice what Paul now in addressing this issue, how he's going to draw them away from this Colossian heresy, this confusion that they've been thrown in turmoil about there at this church because they've got this kind of saved by grace, but then they're now trying to work on it. Someone had sent to the Galatian letter, except the issue there was just circumcision. Right? It was Jesus plus circumcision and Paul got rather myth about this. Now, he says this in response for in Christ, all the fullness of deity lives in bodily form. Now put that in your own words.

What did he just tell you? You can't translate that for yourself, but it's just the words on a piece of paper that make you sense. Okay, I'm not okay. In essence, you look at the bodily form, he's talking about Jesus there, Jesus in the flesh, when you saw Jesus in flesh, he was 100% full God. Okay, up to one. Now, notice what he goes on to say. And in him, like that, I'm sorry, I missed it. And you have been given, noticed past tense, completed, fullness in Christ. Now, the word, just so you know, the word fullness, play Roma in the Greek. It means it's a tick of glass and you fill it all the way up and it's full.

In other words, you put another drop in, it spills out. There's no room for some more to be added in. So just think in your mind, if you get Jesus, what do you get? You get everything. The fullness of God comes with Jesus. So if you're in Jesus, you got fullness. Because it sounds like God comes in fragments to you. You get a little bit of him here and a little bit of him here and a little bit of him here. And you add it all up and you finally become a full Christian later on. That was the problem with the Colossians. If you got Jesus, you got it all. There's no room left to put more in in terms of the blessings and relationship with God. In Jesus is the fullness of God.

So if you get Jesus, you got fullness of God. His argument is not very complicated. So he goes on to say this. His question is, well, when does that take place? I find the language very interesting. In him, you were also circumcised. Okay, remember the Jewish concept, males, eight days old. Jesus had happened to him, poor thing. All the males did. They went in. Trace took it and just sliced away. And identified them as legit Jews. He says, this circumcision is done by Jesus. And it's a spiritual surgery, not a fleshly surgery. The idea of circumcision means to cut away.

Now notice what's being cut away here. It's putting off of the sinful nature. Jesus comes and cuts away your sinful nature. A circumcision up them by hands of a man, but a circumcision done by Christ. Notice having been buried with him in baptism and raised with him through your faith and the power of God, the same power by the way that raised Jesus from the dead. Now, do you see the fundamental argument he just made to these people that helped them work through and reason out of this Jesus-plus-religion agenda that was being bound upon them? And he says, well, don't you remember you received the circumcision of the cutting away the sinful nature when you were baptized in the Jesus Christ? Same language we've been hearing all the way along. At my point, I'm trying to show you there's a kind of cohesive consistency here.

And the only way I have a problem with this is if I don't understand the connection between baptism and faiths. Now, I think you can practice baptism in a very works-oriented and blessed way. I'm going to talk that way, practice that way, some works, and I like some sort of magic wand that God owes you something if you've been through this event. I'm just trying to say, listen to what Paul said in the first century. Has God spoken? So what has he said? And knows the connection between the fullness of God and when that comes into your life? And the issue is your faith and the power of God. I think what happens, and you'll see where I'm going with this, you know, I've talked about baptism in the context of this reception of the Spirit and the whole picture.

If you drain baptism of its significance, then you basically have to go searching elsewhere for the significance. And I think that happens in our culture. And it's part of the problem. What I understand is baptism is not where new work is, where God works. I simply acknowledge God working in my life. I'm passive at that moment. I acquiesce, that's not a good word, it sounds fatalistic. I choose to submit myself to the power of God at that moment. So anyway, you see the idea there, and I think it's very important. The fullness comes with Jesus. You get Jesus. You don't get partial fillings of anything of God. You get all of it.

So I would say five faiths in the beginning, that faith is in the focus of that faith, is Jesus Himself, not in the Spirit, remember our mantra for this class. The Holy Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. So just go ahead and say it with me. The Holy Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. If we understand that, I'm filling that up, this container with these ideas. And I think it will help you filter through and making some decisions on what the Spirit is doing in your life when He's not doing in your life. And I want you to know that He is doing something in your life, and that's where we're going to go next week. But we've got to go here first. One more text, and I will be done. Titus chapter three, verses four through seven.

Now listen to the language here. Now remember, Titus was an evangelist as was Timothy. He was a preacher. He was kind of an unfortunate soul. I say that kind of tongue in cheek, because he was sent to the island of Crete. And when you hear a Paul's description of the people of Crete, it was a tough place to preach. These guys were really self-obsessed. And when you read Paul's description of Crete, it sounds like the American culture. And anyway, he was sent there to preach. So he's trying to help Timothy navigate life. And remember, I've read the verses just prior to this, the devo, who talks about how we were all, you know, we too were once all enslaved by all of our passions and pleasures.

Remember that text from Titus and I? How we were hating and hating one another. And then you, of course, you come to the, you know, the butt. You know, the radical change that takes place. The God

has got something that's going to save us from all of that enslavement in life. That's really the meaning of this text. But notice what he says in the context of it. But when the kindness and love of God, our Savior appeared. Notice the context. He saved us. So we're dealing with this point where God saves us. And all the language of this whole text has to do in the beginning when God saves us. Not because of righteous things we've done, but because of his mercy. He saved us, notice, through the washing of rebirth and renewal by the Holy Spirit. I have a Greek word up there.

It's not the frightened. It just has significance. The *loutron*. L-O-U-T-R-O-N. L-O-U-T-R-O-N. *loutron*. The *loutron* was that, that of water, that side outside, where the Holy of Holies was. Remember the, the setup of the temple area? You had the, the, the, the temple proper to be huge area. And then you got closer as you walk through the, you had the court of Gentiles and the court of women. And then you had the, the inner court. And there at the inner court where they had this, just where they offered the sacrifices on the altar and had this bath of water. And the priest before they would go into the presence of God would go to this ritualistic washing process and water. There's the word, and that was the *loutron*, okay?

So my point is, Paul is simply using imagery that all these, these people in that culture would clearly understand. He saved us through the washing of rebirth and, you know, all scholars across the table will tell you that they're, they're, they're dealing here with baptismal language. The washing of rebirth and renewal by the Holy Spirit. Notice whom God has poured out on us generously, not partially. He just lavishes it on your life. Is that the idea? Through Jesus Christ our Savior so that having been justified by His grace. Again, you're dealing with the initial points where you go from darkness to light, from, from death to living again, from separated from God having this enormous, indescribable intimacy with God. Just by vice grace we might become heirs having the hope of eternal life. Obviously the fullness of it when Jesus comes and we get to see Him face to face.

So sometimes you'll see the language where it speaks about eternal life being a present tense. I write these things to you dear children so that you may know John says that you have eternal life, present tense. But here it looks like you're seeing an idea where eternal life yet is realized and it's completed later on in the future. Hope, okay? Well, you just have to kind of read the text and put those together. So the point, there are two elements in the new birth. I think in my mind as I look at this text as often as time as you pay attention, they have the words of Jesus in the background of their own thoughts. That is the New Testament writer, whether it's Peter or Paul or the other writers. They're reflecting on something that Jesus said. I'm not sure.

It didn't exactly say this but it seems to reflect and I think Paul sort of had in his mind when Jesus said in John 3, Nicodemus. And remember that in kind of which is pretty neat, pretty neat. Then I wish we had time to talk about all that. He says unless you are born again, you cannot enter the kingdom of heaven. Then you had Nicodemus kind of not quite getting it. He looked at him and said, unless you were born of water and spirit, you cannot enter the kingdom of heaven. And again, even in Jesus' mind, there were two aspects that were cohesive in his mind, the two elements of water and spirit. The bath, the *loutron* of the new birth is also the bath and where we receive the Holy Spirit, which sounded again just like all the other texts that we've looked at.

Where she says, you poured out, when did God pour out his spirit in the context of the new birth? It's not you receive the new birth and then later on you receive after dedicating yourself more completely the Holy Spirit. And so I want you to see this kind of cohesion as you look at all of this. And we're going to play this out and we're going to find us as we get into action. It becomes a big deal. In fact, someone was asking me a question before the class because they remember to text where it seems like the spirit came at odd times people. If you want to kind of think ahead, you get to act 10. And just go read that. And so how do you explain that then? It tends to at least in first readings suggest, well, you got these people, they receive the spirit of God and then later you know, then they follow it up with the baptism.

So you know, you got this kind of interesting framework.

So maybe it is different from person to person. I'll just let you kind of struggle with that a little bit. I'm just saying what I'm looking at and I'm seeing a cohesiveness here that when I look at the issues of this, the issues of faith and baptism and the Holy Spirit, that we tend to fragment them. Whereas when I hear Peter, Paul, Jesus speaking, he tends to see them as an organic whole. He doesn't separate them as different separate ideas. He draws them together as one unit of thinking. It's kind of the way we look at conversion. We tend to fragment it up. And we do this to ourselves. I talk about these steps that we go in. I never ever heard a New Testament writer speak about conversion in those phrases. Never find it. Step one, step two, step three, fragment, fragment, fragment, fragment.

What you will find is that they speak about them a cohesively. Here are the texts. Here's Paul's discussion of conversion. Look at his language. Look at how he presents it. How he talks about it. This cohesive idea of the spirit and baptism in faith. And they don't find themselves in conflict with one another. So we'll build upon this and I'm going to be getting to the book of Acts later on. It's going to take us a couple of weeks to get through that because there's a lot of interesting things that happen there. And I'm going to do my best to try to make some sense of what I think makes sense out of it. Although plenty of people disagree with it.

So there you go. How do you receive the spirit? This is on the most fundamental level. For right now, we're building these blocks. What I understand God decided. Next week we're going to tackle the question. We begin to tackle the question. Open up the idea. So what does the Holy Spirit do? Now if indeed I do possess the spirit. So what can I now therefore expect God to do for me? How does this play out? And that goes some interesting directions. And I do know this. God is doing something. The spirit of God is not inactive in your life personally. And if the spirit of God were not in you, you could not live the radical call of discipleship that God calls you to. Maybe one of the reasons we have struggles in acknowledging and recognizing the spirit's activity is because we're so withdrawn from living out the radical call of discipleship as Jesus calls us.

So we don't need the spirit's help. But we never get to that point where we sense and actually helping us as we walk our Christian life. And we'll see how that kind of works this way through. Very much, we're going to go next week. Just for right here, where we are right now, any thoughts, questions, comments? Father, we are thankful. We're thankful that you dwell in us, that you desire and cherish that intimacy with us, even though we do not deserve this. But we yearn for deep down within us. It resonates with the most basic fundamental need and desire within each of our hearts.

Class 5: What Does the Spirit Do? History, Hysteria, and Holiness

Original transcript: `hs05.txt`

Summary: After showing the Toronto Blessing as a case study, Jim traces a theological family tree from Wesleyan perfectionism through revivalism, the holiness movement, Pentecostalism, and the charismatic movement. He then turns the question back to sanctification and the body as the Spirit's temple.

Key Scripture References

- [1 Peter 1:1-2](#)
- [1 Corinthians 6:18-20](#)
- [1 Corinthians 12-14](#)
- [1 Corinthians 15](#)
- [Romans 8](#)
- [John 3:3-5](#)
- [Galatians 5:16-25](#)
- [Ephesians 4:30](#)
- [1 Thessalonians 5:19](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

Peter names the sanctifying work of the Spirit alongside the Father and Jesus Christ.

– [1 Peter 1:1-2](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit; therefore honor God with your body.

– [1 Corinthians 6:19-20](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Cleaned Transcript

What I'd like to do is, in here in just a second, I'm going to show you a video, but let me set it up first. You know, I think about the question, what does the Holy Spirit do? I don't know what comes to your mind in answering that question, if anything really at all. I can tell you that when I was in college, I'd been the church all my life. I just didn't hear really much of anything about the Holy Spirit. Part of that could be, I just wasn't paying attention, but there were certainly a good period. I was, and I don't remember hearing a great deal about it, and if anything was more in passing. And so I really didn't have much of an idea that it did much of anything. Maybe more of a, if anything, it was a token of appreciation for my saying, hey, God, I'll become a Christian.

And God kind of gives me this little memento called Holy Spirit. It was inanimate, you know, I didn't really do it. It's kind of like a paperweight that sits on your desk, and it's just there. But wasn't really doing anything. And, you know, of course, as I began to really get into this, even in my college years trying to answer these questions. You know, it, you know, I'm going to say, well, it certainly sounds like you're doing something. And I also, you know, kind of had always an impression that it was there. It's kind of like a holy helicopter, kind of hovering above, you know. But the Scriptures keep talking about the Spirit of God in dwells you. He's a living.

So I'm hoping that we go through this series of classes and we actually stop and pause, thoughtfully, scripturally to look at this thing and ask some of the hard questions. We'll find the Spirit of God is very, very active in your life and certainly trying to do some things. And it would be nice to be cognizant of it. And so, but I want to start with a video because you're going to see that if you have a very tame view of the Spirit activities, you're going to find that not everyone shares that. In the broader spectrum of

Christendom around the globe, what I'm about to show you is not uncommon. It's not the fringes, the people off the radar. In fact, as what's associated today with the term the charismatic movement, which is coined, I'm going to talk a little bit about that servicing today.

Specifically, and back in 1994, and that's what this video is from YouTube that comes from, was called the Toronto Blessing. And those in that sphere of belief suggest that it was a fresh outpouring of God's Spirit. Now, you're going to see what I think for most, if not all of you, is rather you might term it kind of very bizarre behavior. Now, I was encirculated in these circles when I was in college. So, I witnessed a good bit of what you're about to see in person and on different levels. And I will be talking about that as we move on this semester. So, don't freak out with this. Just see that. But what I want you to catch is this. The people that are doing the things that you're about to see will tell you the reason that they're doing them is because the Holy Spirit is making them do these things.

The source is the Holy Spirit. If you have the Holy Spirit, these are the things that you do. If you're really open to God working in your life, this is where you will end up, too. So, understand the connection there. That's why I'm showing this to you. What does the Holy Spirit do? And there are many different answers to that question in our culture today. So, without further ado, let me just let you say it, about two and a half minutes. And then we'll pick back up and we'll begin to look into this. It began on January 21, 214. You can watch. There is over one through some moments of you people. You can tell from all the areas that are important others probably do. There have been times where you live through it. It was unbreakable then. And because of it, hundreds of thousands of people do it with you.

But you're doing the experience of Toronto. Thank you. I want to read from Luke, chapter 1, some of you think that I don't give readings. I've been going through different stages of drunkenness. On the stage I'm out at the moment, just for outing. I love you. I love you. I love you. Thank you for coming to me. Thank you. Okay, you go ahead and put the PowerPoint on. Just turn off the Internet version. While we're making the transition, so what are your impressions? If you're getting little brief snapshots, understanding everything that you saw, if you were to talk to each of those individuals and perhaps what you might call more sane or moments, they would say, well, the reason this happened to me is because I was taken over by the spirit of God and this is where it led me.

And of course, you saw several vestiges of it, holy laughter, people, this whole congregation is uncontrollably laughing, which, by the way, was one of the signature manifestations of what is called the Toronto Blessing. If you notice, they kept showing Toronto and the airport. It was the airport church in Toronto. That's why it was called the Toronto Blessing. And again, this phenomenon really crosses the globe. And of course, people being leashed, walking around like dogs, barking, summer, acting like other animals, people just, what they call slain in the Spirit, we're going to talk about some of this.

So what are your impressions? I mean, you hear this. What does the Holy Spirit do? What are your thoughts? Well, it is because I don't know a car with Caleb, and I mean, that's no, you're all not. We started talking about stuff like this. There are people who focus on different things like that. And there are people who I don't think you can claim to have exercise in them. You know, just like, you're just saying, you don't want to judge those people and you don't want to. I guess, did not I have the fact that there is a lot of different forms that people didn't experience the things like this one of those issues where I just, that's so out of people are very, I didn't feel the same sort of film. I would experience something like that. If I would, if I would experience something like that, I would surround that with the Holy Spirit seriously.

I'm not joking, but I feel that that happens. I can really judge. Anyone else? My brother-in-law and sister have actually converted from Church of Christ to Jesus because they know. And my brother-in-law is kind of one of the people that I've been using as a tool to do my own study of the Holy Spirit. So, which I started before the class started, which I currently believe that He was the Holy Spirit's working with. It causes a class to have a semester. I don't think it's more of a conscious kind of a Christian view

in the right direction, like a whatever I'd think of. I can call this person and then I actually go do it. It's always very important to put that again in my head or in my mind.

Okay. Okay. Anyone else? I'm just kind of bad saying this, but you can play a lot of things. Like, you've got reactions to that video and then that's the end. This is, this guy is the first to be actually in the Holy Spirit. Okay. Anyone else? I'm just going to know what your impressions are and what you think as you're watching all of this. And, and entering the question was always very good. I feel it's quite great old fairy tale, the inverse is closed. Where everyone doesn't, everyone wants to say, well, I don't think this can't be right. But, everyone else sees this new city. With the naked eye, I guess I need to go along with it. It wasn't a little short of a little kid pointed out. Right. Socially anymore, with group behavior and the ability of mass behavior, herd behavior to convince, and there's one certain, there's certain truth to that that can happen.

You can drive an eye to the front of the room. This is one of the interrogations. Just to see what it was about, the herd someone's speaking in town. That makes you kept saying that one word, two word, two word, two word, two word, two word, two word. He didn't know what the word meant. I don't think anyone there knew what the word meant. A couple of years later, he was watching a western movie. And he said, it's getting running down the hill, screaming in words. And apparently someone asked, what was it that said? But it was stopped. Thank you.

By the way, there's a name for that phenomenon. I will talk about that later. I saw your hand up. Can we, we can go on now and appreciate your thoughts. I'm just trying to get your wheels spinning a bit. By the way, you can turn my mic down if you want to. It was on good. And where was it? I'm just getting the wheels spinning in your mind and thinking about this. Obviously, I'm going to explore a lot of these things and try to place them in some setting. Because I told you I used to be part of this. When I was in college, I delved in with both feet and my searching processes. And I'll tell you what my personal experiences are and what I experience and those kinds of things. You know, regardless of how you interpret this, we have to have some way of filtering this.

Of course, I know, to me, I always ask the most fundamental questions. Has God spoken? If so, what exactly has he said? You know, certainly human nature and human impulse, we can be swept off into just about anything. Human history says, tells us that very clearly on all levels, certainly within the realm of religion. That is probably one of the most obvious manifestations of this idea of being swept away into thoughts and behaviors that can be very foreign to God. And ironically, everyone reading the same scriptures, but not coming to the very same conclusions. And so, you know, I think this is an important question. And I think the spirit of God is extremely active just in short. I see this as more of a hysteria. And hysteria can move you to absurd behaviors. But I like, I'll, you know, not just say that and hit and run.

I'll come back and we'll talk more specifically about each of these things. I'd like to actually explore this idea. And I want to start by showing you that this really does come from some place in terms of what I would call a theological tree. So let me take a little time and notice this is a little bit of theology. Theology shouldn't scare you. It simply shows you that people, in terms of how they process scriptures and how they, what they come up with and create frameworks, theological frameworks, how to believe. And if I put this in there, you can begin to see where people got to where they are today with certain beliefs. They did just drop out of the sky like this. You all know John Wesley, well known Bible scholar. And he developed what was term Wesleyan perfectionism.

And some of this is not really familiar because I've already kind of hinted at it earlier as we've developed. And I'm kind of giving you further development of this. And so I hope you'll see where this goes. And the basic framework is this. The suggestion is that conversion comes in stages. That when you first come to Jesus, you're not a complete Christian. You're an incomplete Christian. And so you go through the process, when you first come to Jesus, you are justified. I understand it. It's a legal term in scriptures.

It's a, if you do the research in the Greek word just justified or justification. It's a courtroom. It's where the judge rules you not guilty. Where our sins are forgiven. Where we are placed once again back in a right relationship of God. That's justification. The other stained glass word is sanctification.

These are two separate and distinct ideas. But you'll find them in scriptures holistically placed together. Which is part of why I have a problem with what I'm about to show you. Because here you see them fragmented. Two separate stages. Sanctification we're going to talk about just a moment. And so I'm just going to put that in the whole. The idea of setting you apart and you're being a special service to the Lord. Now understand the idea again. But you are an incomplete Christian when you first come to Jesus. You are justified, but you are not yet sanctified.

Okay. And so you're dealing first of all with the understanding that there is a subsequent event that one should seek. And that subsequent event is earned. If we talk about the Galatians, remember we talked about this. The idea of I have to do some things to achieve this moment where I received this. Sanctifying moment in my life. And it comes to fully surrendering. So as I finally give my life to God and I give it holy, then this moment comes upon my life. Now there are certain things that are associated in terms of how Wesley perceived this.

First of all, he said it is a higher experience. In other words, sanctification is a greater experience than justification. So you should seek it because you're now not a nominal Christian. You're now a fully developed Christian. Which should maybe raise some flags if you get some ideas that it's separating Christians between nominal and superior in a way. I already have a fundamental struggle with that. But I can see if I buy into this that well, okay, there's the higher experience. Of course, I wonder how could something be greater than becoming a child of God?

So instead it was a higher experience. Also, it was instantaneous. In other words, you build up to this point that when you finally get to this point where you are fully surrendered to God, it hits you like a bolt of light thing. It happens instantaneously. That boom, you're also immediately fully sanctified. So you go from building up and turning on the engine and getting it revved up and getting on. And finally, when you get to that point when God thinks you're ready, he by his own initiative, boom, hits you with it. And you are now have this experience where you are now fully sanctified. You became a full Christian now. That's why I used the idea of fullness. We talked about that in Colossians, if you remember. And not only is it a higher experience than it happens instantaneously, later on in the subsequent event, fragmented conversion, one stage, two stage, but it's also entire.

Wesley actually spoke in terms of you do not sin anymore. You become sinless. Now, maybe you've been hearing the quantum discourse preachers out there. Apparently, they've been us days. Have you picked up the fact that that's their theology? In fact, I was told they had a t-shirt that say Christian, or I am perfect. Yeah. And it comes out of this roots, by the way. Not enough time to walk you through all of that. We can talk about that. That really bothers you in how they get there. There are certain passions that they go to. And for us, John, Hebrews, where they suggest, well, Christians can't sin. If they're truly fully sanctified Christians. But they're working off of Wesleyan perfectionism. They may not know that that's where it comes from. But this is John wanted to develop this idea. And thought it through and said, here's where you go with this.

And so, by this framework, it sets to stage for some rather interesting things. And this is not a matter of hypothesis. This is a matter of what actually happened in history. I'm going to give you what is the theological family tree that developed, based upon Wesley's, developing this idea that conversion takes place in two stages. You were justified. And then there's a subsequent event. But it was kind of a big question mark. How do you know you had it? And it was kind of what you call the inner witness. That you just kind of know inside. And your skin doesn't change colors. The heavens don't open up in years year. You know, the angels singing. And you can see them and things like that. There's nothing demonstrative. You just kind of have this inner feeling and sense of being that I've received it.

I've had this moment, this experience in life. Now, let's build on that. And let me kind of tell you where this goes. And this will all come. This will be worth it. Just stay with me. Upon that, in the early 19th century came what is known as revivalism. We've all heard about the great awakening in America. You might even heard the name Charles G. Finney, who was one of the most prominent promoters and icons of this period of history would go across America preaching rather fiery sermons. And you know, a lot of interesting things took place.

What revivalism brought in was not necessarily a theological framework. But it brought in the idea of revivalism, emotionalism. All right. His thinking was simply this. And you can see they wake up from that people need to be emotionally charged up to open up to hear the message of God that we're so numb and we're so asleep. I'm going to get you all, I'm going to get you to a pep rally first, to get you all worked up. And then if I get your heart open, then I can preach to you and you'll listen to me. And there's some truth to that. I mean, people have to be awake to hear. And I like to wake a few people up here right now in the end, and you know, go a chalkboard out of them or something. But you know, if you stop thinking, you know, you can be swept away into anything.

And so it had some interesting things. Now, During, it's not a coincidence, therefore, given this was the emphasis of that era. I want you to know that there were certain phenomena that began to surface during this period of history in America. Some things you just noticed. First of all, the overall is godly hysteria. For example, holy jerks. You saw, you actually picture this. I've witnessed all of these things in my life. I think seeing people do these things in person. People that would be sitting in a class like you, very normal, some were students, some people worked for universities here, some worked in businesses in Auburn, because most people, like normal people, but in the religious setting, they went to their church. This is the things that they would do. Holy jerks. Just lower your body, going through convulsive behavior.

Sometimes standing up, sometimes laying down. By the way, what do you think the Quakers got their name? Then you have being slain in the Spirit. You saw one of those where they lay hands on you, and you'll notice that people, they just like to get mocked out. You can't get mocked out of the spirit. I've witnessed this a lot. I never had it happen to me. I was kind of like telling you this. It's really true, let it happen. I'm open, and I've had people come up and put the oil on my head, and put their hand on me. But I've always kind of, you know, I'm not really giving the hypnotism. I'm not being facetious. I'm just saying I'm not. God's going to do it. He's going to have to do it. I'm saying, and I just never had it happen to me.

But I've been around people. They just boom. They lay out. I'm not trying to be silly, but you know, these ladies, of course, I worry about if they short dresses, they go falling around in front of me. People would run up and put blankets on them and stuff. That's what you see. A lot of people laying on the floor covered up. You know, and they will stay there for five minutes, 15 minutes, sometimes the whole church service. And they would always wake up at the closing song. I don't know how to put that, but that's what happened. And we came down to eat. You got up. And so, you know, I guess the spirit gets hungry too. But I shouldn't say that. I'm sorry. Holy, holy, holy laughter. I'm talking about whole congregations literally We saw some tanguins. I've witnessed where I mean, they're just literally rolling on the floor and laughter.

And again, if you say, why are you doing this? And when they can stop laughing, they say, because the Holy Spirit is making me, I can't help it. I mean, just literally just, you know, if I have the giggle box, it was just unbelievable. Holy dance. It's just that. I used to have a woman, I used to sit next to, and it was really kind of interesting. She would always have the spirit take over her. And she would just, she would leap up on the chair and shed her tambourine and value me. She just went nuts. And she would just dance. And, you know, of course, you know, I kind of got into it. And she was, you know, the both dynamic presence in that building. And I touched it. Well, what's happening? She was the spirit just

takes over.

Now, this is going to find this is where you're going to see it's a little bit harder to train the devil. Now, unless you saw it, you wouldn't believe it. But during the spirit of history, what the people would do, they would get down on all fours and they would bark. And what they thought they were doing was chasing the devil out of the building. They would literally go out the building doing this. Whole groups of people on all fours. And barking the devil out and chasing him up a tree. And they would be sitting at the base at the foot of a tree. And the devil's up there. They've cleansed the building of evil influence.

Okay. Now, remember, all of this went together. And then, of course, the speaking in tongues, which is a much more common presence today. And what we did not sure quite do is, and I will talk about that in some degree. So, my point is, is that if, you know, when you buy into this, this went with it. Now, do I think emotionalism is wrong? No. Anyone got emotions about Jesus in this room? I hope so. Anyone feel very strongly, and it just resonates in your life. They ever go to worship. They just feel in a wonderful way overwhelmed by the presence of God. But does it lead you to do this? Is it because you guys are too resistant to this movement of the Spirit? But anyway, during this period, you had this. So, built upon this idea of the theology was, this emotionalism came in.

Now, notice what came in after that. It's what they call the holiness movement. Now, the holiness movement basically reinitiated emphasis on the Wesley perfectionism, the two stages. Entire, instantaneous subsequent event of conversion. And what they brought in, though, that was new to all of this, was the idea of the full salvation was that they actually identified that second stage with the phrase, baptism in the Holy Spirit. So, have you yet received the baptism of the Holy Spirit, referring to the subsequent sanctifying stage that comes upon your life that John Wesley talked about? It was during this period that it became labeled as this. It was not labeled as beforehand. Get the idea. Upon that, came the word, and you tend to build a little more associated with this, what they call the Pentecostal framework. In terms of churches, if you grew up in an assembly of God or a church of God, those were the original Pentecostal organizations in America.

Now, what they brought into this is very interesting. And it goes back into 1901, back on January 1st. You see, the idea of Pentecostalism is that it pushed beyond Wesley's inner witness and was searching for something that was outward and more tangible. How do I know that I have received this event? I need something more tangible because it was too vague. Other than you say, well, I just feel like I have. So, how do I know that I have? And that's what people were going to get pushing for more and more and more definition historically. And so, out of this emerged, this passion for more came this event. It was one of those, it's the first documented historical moment where someone actually received through the laying on of hands, a baptismal spirit. Her name was Agnes Ozman. It was at the Charles Parham's Bethel Bible School, and a group surrounded her.

And then she began to speak the ecstatic language known as speaking in tongues. And that became the outward manifestation of the inward reality of having received the baptismal spirit. Now, that was unique to Pentecostalism. Remember here, it was just the phrase, but it was still identified with the inner witness that Wesley had talked about. Now, I have an outward manifested thing that, you know, when I received that voice spirit, I expect that the outward sign of that to validate that I have actually received that voice spirit is, I begin to speak in tongues. Now, remember, speaking in tongues existed earlier than this, but this is when it was identified as the outward manifested affirmation that you've received this moment. Good, the idea. And then we move in to finally what is called the charismatic movement, the pentecostalism, the new pentecost.

Basically, it was this theology moving out of the framework of the assemblies of God, churches of God into every denomination. And when I was in college, this process was in full swing. They would hold what was called Full Gospel Business Men's meetings. And what it was was an invitation to go in here or the theology of this, and people would get up and they would tell you about their experiences of having

received the gift of the Holy Spirit and the baptism Holy Spirit with the evidence of speaking in tongues, and they would share their experiences, then they'd call you up to anyone here and want to be joined with this, have this happen to them too. So, really wasn't a business meeting, but they called it that. I know it's understood why, in fact, it was that a show knees here in town that you speak not here anymore.

It's a Chinese restaurant now. They're crossed from the mall, you know. And across the street from C. C.'s, that building there is where it used to be. And we used to go there and that's where they would do this. And very well respected individuals in the community, some of them, some were professors. If you associate with just absolute ignorance, that would not be realistic, nor fair. They would share their experiences, be eyewitnesses to this themselves, and then call the people to come forward and have this happen. Now, I had to happen to me, and I will tell you about that later on, and how I processed all of that later. So, anyway, there is that idea. So, you see my point. I want you to see that we didn't get into the setting of America today with the thinking that we do, with the things that are going on, even globally, it didn't just drop out of heaven.

It went through a very specific process of thinking and people seeking more and more and more definition. And finally, we end up with a theological framework that people buy into. Of course, remember, it starts here, until I can understand the idea, unless I buy into the idea that conversion comes to two stages, then everything dismantles. But if I buy into this, then this becomes a tentative, I mean, a reasonable process of thinking. So, here is why I have my fundamental questions of what I question scripturally, really how it takes place. So, you get that idea, okay? Kind of keep that in mind as we go through this, and we'll come back to some of these things. Now, what I'd like to do now, in the 750, and we're just going to start a few patches, and I just enough to what you're appetite to pick up next week.

1 Peter, first chapter, first two verses. Most people, when I read the letters of the different authors like Paul and Peter and John, they skip the first few verses thinking it's just a salutation. You know, dear John, okay? Skip that, it didn't skin to the meat, get through that, good hair from you, blah, blah, blah. Okay, skip all that, now let's get to the meat of the stuff. You shouldn't do that with scriptures, because each of these authors, they tell you basically what's coming in their introductions. There's meat in the introductions. They don't waste, they have economy of words. They're saying something to you. And Peter was writing to people who were enduring severe persecution. They literally had the sword poised over their head by the Roman government, and they never knew when it was coming down. They were having their property confiscated, they were being placed in prison, they were being fed to lions, they were being burned alive, they were being boiled alive in oil, they were being tied to the wheels of chariots and a circus maximus and just being crushed into dust, all for the entertainment of the Caesar's and the Roman people who considered the Christian to be the haters of mankind, by the way, and ironically.

So a lot of things were taking place, and this was near the period when Nero was Caesar. He called her Nero, and he did not like Christians. They were extremely threatening to him and his view of the empire. Now, so Peter writes this letter to basically this frightened group of sheep, they called Christians, in the area of Asia Minor, because off the shores of Rome, across from Greece, came up the waves of persecution into that area, and that's what this letter was written to. So he says this, to God's elect, strangers in the world. Say what? You feel like you don't belong here when the world around you hate you. Scattered, you know, it's called Pontius Galatia, Capodotia, Asia. That's that, you know, you got here, here's the, you know, here's the, here's the Mediterranean Sea, here's Palestine, up there is Asia Minor.

That's all these places that they're listening, right? You can look back, you might always look at your map, it's all there. Who have been chosen, notice, according to the four knowledge of God, the Father, through the sanctifying work of the Spirit, for obedience to Jesus Christ, which frankly, I was blood. Now, what's one of the first things you notice, because I have it all underlined? God, the Father, God, the Son, God, the Holy Spirit, with the power of the Trinity, that's one of the reasons why. God, all of God's involved in this thing, and those things, they all have very distinctive roles. Test that? God, the

Father, being the one who, for knowledge, initiates towards human beings. Jesus coming and dying as the atoning sacrifice for our sins, and the Spirit sanctifies us. Now, right there, if I know nothing else, it's the only scripture I knew in all the Bible, I know this.

The Holy Spirit is doing something. Now, the word is sanctify. So let's just start with this as a basic fundamental building block. What in the world does sanctify mean? Nothing but a stained-glass word in this room until you can tell me. Okay, what up? Okay, and it would certainly be in the context of that, although it doesn't technically mean that, but yes, it is certainly when you see the verbiage of the writers, and they will put it together with those kind of ideas. Yes. What else?

Okay, and there's your class, and go open up the dictionary, sanctify to set apart, to make holy. Now, I'm still not quite there yet. Although I'm a little bit closer to that thing, holy, holy. The Holy Spirit makes you holy. He sanctifies me. Now, deal with this one. Sometimes when you read the word sanctify, it uses the past tense, completed. You have been sanctified in Christ Jesus. 1 Corinthians chapter 6, I think verse 1. It's sanctified, past tense, completed. But other times you read it, it says, you are being sanctified.

So are the writers confused? What do you learn from that? Put that in context. It's in your Bible, people. It's there everywhere. You might as well figure it out. And it's not there just simply so you can have a nice little cerebral moment here. I think that we're going to be able to figure it out. Okay. And the spirit of God has faith in you, our right. You are already saying you are already sanctifying us. But at the same time, you're also sanctified. Okay. Okay. Good. We've got to deal with the translates up. You're no close to understanding this. If you stop a little bit and pause and think and be thoughtful in the words, you can understand what they're saying to you. They're not trying to trick you with stained glass words. They're trying to get you to think about the blessings that God has bringing to your life.

And why you should want to follow Jesus. And where it leads you. When it speaks about it and it completed, the past tense, completed. When you came to Jesus, you were thoroughly 100% set apart to God. God sees you as a child of God, not in part, but in whole. You receive the fullness of God. Remember, Colossians 2, you don't get part of Jesus. When you get Jesus, you get all of God. The fullness of God dwells in bodily form in Jesus. And you got Jesus, you got fullness. And that's why it speaks to often in the scriptures that you were justified. You were sanctified in the Lord Jesus Christ. It's all a cohesive whole. It's not fragmented. When you get one, you get the other. But we also now, having been set apart to God, we also know the realities of our actual living out of our life.

Well, there's a lot of flaws there. So God sees me as holy. Now he's saying, act like it. But the pressure I get, I can't act like it. Let's just be able to help him. Act like it. It's not just ongoing, maturing, growing process of me being sanctified by the work of the Holy Spirit. So the initial understanding of having received sanctification is the basis of my, is the basis of my understanding of my relationship with God. But then I fall into the obligation to be sanctified, living a lifestyle that actually reflects the holiness of God. You with me? Now, not very complicated. Spirit is doing something. One more text and we'll call it quick for tonight. 1 Corinthians 6. Now, the Corinthians had a lot of problems. This is one of many, many, many that Paul points to. And he just lines them up, just deals with them.

Some of them, when you hear them, say, you think there's no way they were doing that. And they were Christians. And remember, you know, we're dealing with people. You know, Christianity is just, you know, maybe 20, about 20 years old. Brand new Christians everywhere in the face of the earth. And the Mediterranean world where it started. And Corinth was a nasty place. It was, you know, sin city. It was, everyone in the Mediterranean world knew that Corinth was the ultimate place to go to get your life messed up. In fact, the Greek plays, whenever there was a character who was considered a Corinthian, he was either drunk, always. He was a drunk, or he was involved in deep, promiscuous, sexually immoral behavior. Because that's just what Corinthian was. And there were reasons for this. And I need to explain this because it gives meaning to the text.

There on the acro-chorant, there was a mountain area that bloomed over the city itself. And by the way, we have the archaeology is unearthed all of this. It's really kind of interesting. It was a temple. And it was a temple to a certain god. Anyone know where it is? Some of you know it. Dynesius, that's Ephesus. Close. Diana. Aphrodite. Now, you go do a little googling Aphrodite, and you get embarrassed reading about Aphrodite. Aphrodite looked embarrassed, first of all. And I'll not describe it to you, but it was basically the god of sex. The god of lust. It's kind of interesting, you know, who you worship. This is for free. But, you know, 50 miles away on a clear day, you could see Athens. And they're on their mount to the temple to Athena. And Athena was the god of what?

Knowledge, wisdom. So is it really a coincidence that out of the context of that worship came some of the greatest philosophical minds of that day? But over in core, we had to worship lust. What do you think they produced? And you know what was associated with this temple? Were 1000 sacred prostitutes. And, um, hell of money in your pocket? You could carry on the religious experience. This is the issue. This was a worship. Wouldn't like rain to the, you know, the computer looking at pornography, although it's not too different. But the people would go to the temple. And if temples didn't go, you didn't go to temple. It came to you because every night the sacred prostitutes would descend the mount, come into the city, and apply their trade. And they were very successful. It was said. This was a, this was a slogan in the first century.

Not every man can afford a trip to Corinth. And that's why. So I mean, it was, it was a dirty place. Uh, one scholar says if it's the mat in which the people who got off the port city there and came on the mainland would wipe their feet before going into the enchanted land of Greece. Um, it was a nasty place. I don't see. I just take quite a, so you know, it, it doesn't surprise me that this church had a lot of hangups because these are people converted to Jesus Christ. And they were, I mean, their world was, was, was horrendous. And they converted to Jesus and they were serious about it. Um, and they're called, if you know some letters, the Church of God. Paul didn't put them on probation because now some of you guys are engaged in going to the temple or joining yourself with these harlots.

You're involved in sexually promiscuous behavior. And how can you do this? So it's in this context that Paul says this. Now, just prior to this text, he's going to basically make an argument, why should you do this? I'll have time to go through the next genesis of all of this. I wish I did. But when you see the context of it, so it's very important. He's building basically a case against sexual ethics for Christians, which was radically different than the world in which they left. Right from different than the world in which we live. And if you go back to verse, this is starting in verse 18, but go back to verse 13. Basically he says, God is interested in your body. And the slogan that the Corinthians were using was, hey, food for stomach, stomach for food. That was their argument. That's what allowed them to say, hey, it's okay for us to do this as Christians.

Now, what was their argument? Food for stomach, stomach for food. What were they suggesting? Okay. Okay, you get hungry. So what do you do? You satisfy the hunger. You eat. You have a sexual desire. Therefore, you satisfy that desire too. It's already just a bodily function. Remember, they had built into this and in this culture, they dualism. This was very common. It's not too uncommon today, but we just don't think about it. We're not sitting around a bunch of Greek philosophers espousing this in front of us. But we bought into this in our culture that your physical body is evil. And you're going to jettison this physical body anyway. And you're just going to be a disembodied spirit.

So the thing that really matters is your inner spirit, your soul. So what you do with the physical body is just the temporary necessity, the evil of life. So you can go to directions. You can go to setisism. Just deny yourself everything, a bodily comforts. Or you go to the other stream, which is just absolute freedom to do anything you want with it. And you'll find in this period of history, people went both directions. And they're talked about ascriptors. It's common sense. If I bind, that makes sense. They call dualism. Now, the scripture suggests that you're not dualistic. You are body, soul, and spirit. And

part of the argument Paul makes here is your body does matter. In fact, when God raises you from the dead, he's going to raise up your body physically.

What you are in right now is not going to be solely jettisoned. This is the raw material that God is going to use to raise up this new, transformed, immortal, imperishable body. You're not going to be a disembodied spirit when Jesus comes. Listen to scriptures. It's the argument of 1 Corinthians 15, which they had problems with that too. But not understandable since they bought into dualism. So they say, look, God does care about your body. And sex is not the same thing as satisfying a physical appetite of a hunger hunger. It's something to gather all together different. And you're trading off something. You don't want to trade off.

So it goes on and say, well, your bodies are members of Christ. And because of that, when you take what God intended to be, this great moment of... The sexual relationship is intended to be the most intimate moment of communication between two human beings. How do I say that? If I take what God meant to be the deepest moment of communication in my life, and I throw it out in a non-committal relationship, then everything goes haywire. So when you understand the implications, then we understand that God wasn't just saying, hey, I gave you some great desires, men, I know they drive you so just don't get it. And I like to just sit back and watch you guys suffer. That's not what God's doing. And Paul's basically walking through his arguments. Here's why. And now, you know, some other class will talk about this.

But it's the basic meaning of sex. And he goes on and say, it's the only sin that is a sin against your own body. You notice that in this text? It's very unusual. It's the only one. If you understand the intent of the sexual relationship and why God designed this, then you understand whom? My whole body, soul, and spirit and personality is investing in this thing. And I'm trading it off. And some things are irreversible. But I mean, they can't be forgiven, but they're irreversible. So I've got to deal with this thing. And this is what these people were doing.

So I'm going to contact you. And there's this. So therefore, and after you make so much of it, flee, run as it's the word, as run as in terror from. See it goes. No! And I'll be asked to let that's the word. Panic. It's what Joseph did with Potterfah's wife. He fled. Same word. All other sins a man commits are outside of his body. But he was sexually sentenced against his own body. Do you not know? And now, those were part of this argument. Here, Paul is arguing why this commitment to sexual sanctification, sexual holiness. Because you're already set apart, but now I'm obligating you to actually live this way, because your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit. Who is in you, not hovering around you, not looking down at you from heaven? He is in you. The clear testimony of scripture.

Read Romans 8, and it will just keep pounding that word out until you get it. Whom you have received from God. No, it's passing. You've already received them. You know, here people that were involved in sexual morality, but they have already received the Spirit of God. Remember, it's at the beginning. When you first put your face in Jesus Christ. So was the Spirit with help from them? Because their lives weren't perfect? Now, you are not your own. You were bought with a prize. Therefore, honor God with your body. Now, let's look at this word. And then we'll end up the word temple. Your body is the temple of Holy Spirit. There are two words for temple in the Greek language that you'll find. One is the word here on. You'll get that, well, you don't have to worry about stolen that.

It referred to the whole temple area. Remember, you had this big, huge, walled, and area of the temple area. They had the court of Gentiles. They had the court of women. And you had the Jewish men could go. And that's where, just outside the actual building, which was the place where the Holy of Holies was, which is where God actually lived. That's where the Arketic Covenant was. And outside that room where the veil was, where the show bread, and the candle operas, and all that stuff.

So there's a word for the mass of view. But this word, the word he uses, is the Naos. And a-o-s, Naos. I'm referring to specifically the inner sanctuary where God dwells. Your body is that inner sanctuary.

You had the temple of God in Jerusalem. Guess what the temple of God is now? You. I mean, think about that. Or do you once a year? And with trepidation, did a high priest walk into that place to offer the sacrifice of the sprinkled blood of that lamb upon the Ark of the Covenant? And in case he got struck dead, he wore little bells on his garment so that when the people stopped hearing the bells, they had a rope-tie, and they could pull them out. Because we're God-dwell. It's sacred. It was the most set-apart moment of person could ever experience under Judaism to go into the presence of God.

And what he once a year, and all of you, be one of those lucky ones selected, and they were rare. It was like winning the lottery. I mean, it was, you're a millionaires a day. Woo! You know, it's just both multi-millionaires. And now we're being told that you, each of us individuals, your body, your physical body is the temple of the Naos of God-spirit. Great, amazing piece of theology there. Now, I want you to notice what he says and doesn't say, and this is very important. He's saying very clearly here that, you know, you don't cleanse your body of sin, and then God's going to give you his Holy Spirit. He's saying, you already have the Holy Spirit. Therefore, cleanse your body of sin. Very important. And what is the motive and empowering that enables this, the Holy Spirit of God?

You see, if it is true that Spirit of God is through the Spirit that I am able to be empowered to fight sin, I don't need the Spirit after I got my life all cleaned up. That's assuming I can do it on my own. If I can do that on my own, I don't need the Spirit. I'll just do it on my own. God says, do it. And I'll tell you how to do it. And we're going to get this more when we get that Romans 8, 7, 8, 9 next week. And Sean referred to parts of Romans 6, 7, 8 when he shared his thoughts. Rather, the argument is, you already have the Spirit of God. He already doesn't dwell you.

So the obligation and the empowerment come, because he's already in your life. But the truth is, without him, I could not do what he's asking me to do in the first place. It would just be frustration. So the Holy Spirit is a powerful incentive for holiness. I must keep my body as a holy sanctuary for God's Spirit himself. Remember, he's a person. Not a force. Next week, we will pick up with Romans 8. Let's see if it's kind of seep in, think through. We'll pick up. We'll talk some more about what is, when you listen to the New Testament Bible, and they say, this is what the Holy Spirit doing in your life. Where does it lead? You should already begin to get a fundamental picture when you just hover around and soak in the idea of sanctification. The more you understand that, the more you understand how to evaluate.

So what does the Spirit of God do? Does that person, if you will, on that leash barking, holy? Or is it just kind of unusual behavior? Well-intended. Does it make you more like Jesus? Did Jesus ever do anything like that? Maybe we're known with looking? But Jesus does talk about how do you know the Spirit of God is upon me? He had very different things to say, didn't it? I do it loving people. Well, we'll get there. Let's practice.

Class 6: Sanctification, Scripture, and the Spirit's Power

Original transcript: `hs06.txt`

Summary: Jim develops the Spirit's sanctifying work through Romans 6-8, Philippians 2, 2 Thessalonians 2, and 1 Thessalonians 4. The Spirit does not replace human effort or Scripture; he works through the word to empower a holy life.

Key Scripture References

- [1 Corinthians 6:18-20](#)
- [Romans 6](#)
- [Romans 7](#)
- [Romans 8:1-14](#)
- [Philippians 2:12-13](#)
- [Psalm 119:11](#)
- [2 Thessalonians 2:13](#)
- [1 Thessalonians 4:1-8](#)
- [Galatians 5:22-23](#)
- [Ephesians 4:30](#)
- [1 Thessalonians 5:19](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

If God's Spirit lives in us, there should be a noticeable difference between the person who has the Spirit and the person who does not.

– [Francis Chan, Forgotten God](#). Verified in widely quoted excerpts and reviews of the book; the transcript paraphrases it.

By the Spirit believers put to death the misdeeds of the body.

– [Romans 8:12-14](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Cleaned Transcript

We are talking, trying to do what really ends up to be just a almost a hit and run study of the Holy Spirit. I'm trying to, you know, help us all move along this learning curve, share with you from scriptures, from my experiences, and I hope that we can get to the end of this thing that you'll all feel a little bit further along in dealing with some of the ambivalence and lack of understanding of the Holy Spirit. I hope we've already challenged you on some levels already with this and that that will continue. The, remember that, you know, I said I kind of set up like a metaphorical container and I'm kind of filling it. The metaphorical container is framed by the understanding that the Holy Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. The Holy Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. So the more I understand the implications of that, the more I think it gives us a filter to discern what is it that the Spirit is doing, what he's not doing. Where can I rest? Obviously, as I showed you last week, as we started that video, and you know, there's a lot of things being claimed today and it gets really bizarre and it's not as off the radar as you might think that these are very commonly held views and practices around the globe when it comes to associating the Spirit of God Christianity with an individual. And what I gave you last week was just kind of a theological family tree to show you where some of that came from. It didn't just drop out of the sky and show up one day. It went through a progression of thought and development where people, because of what they believed, it opened the door to more and more to defining Christianity purely through experiences. In other words, scripture is not so much to find the experience, but experience to find scripture. And which direction

you go determines a great deal of whether I think it's biblical or not, whether it fits the framework that the Holy Spirit's work is centered in Christ Jesus. And so, you know, obviously when we got over in this area looking at some of these things that have been around for some decades and centuries, really we're going to find that some of these things go back into the ancient world, even before Christianity, even as the Canaanite religions and the Old Testament. And we'll talk about some of that later on. In other words, there's nothing new under the sun and we'll see just how much that's true. But when you get over here, this is where people start freaking out. They don't realize when they buy into certain theology that they're basically they're held to defining this because if I allow experience to define me, then it's a big free for all. How can you deny my experience? I had this experience. The God took over. I couldn't help but laugh. I couldn't help but go through all the jerking motions. I couldn't help but start dancing. I couldn't help but get down on all fours like a dog and tree of double. The God made me do this. And that is a giant sign of my spirituality.

That means I'm really connected with God because I do these things. That's how you know God indwells me through his spirit. And of course, I'm putting a big question mark. Says is that really where God takes us if he indwells us by his spirit? So we began to look at certain text and I talked started with first Peter, which very clearly says that one of the primary roles at the spirit takes on in the life for Christian is sanctification. And the idea of sanctification is helping us live the way Jesus did. Righteously. We use the word holiness. That's why he's the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit leads us to live holy lives. And there's common sense to this but it's amazing how you know you go back does is this holy. It just seems like somewhat absurd the hatred to me at times. And so the idea of understanding sanctifying work, creating Jesus and me, actually living under the moral obligation, the ethical standards of Christianity. All these things that we're supposed to do and how we're supposed to treat each other and love each other and purity of life. All of these things are framed under the caption, the Holy Spirit does this for you or creates this within you. And that's where I really want to keep kind of hammering away. Now we also look last week at this pass where we ended dealt with the context there. Remember the temple of Aphrodite there in Corinth, the Holy prostitution. Quoting quote, you had Christians in that culture, converted to Christianity, but they still carried on some of this old life into the church. There was a sewage kind of came into the front door of the church building. And one of the things that they carried in was some of them were arguing that it was okay to just simply satisfy your sexual appetite by going to these halls because after all the body is evil and every that was Greek Greek thinking, not Christian thinking. And so they separated the physical body from the inner spirit and soul. So what I did with my body didn't really affect my relationship with God. The spiritual things you see. And so they were arguing stomach for food, food for stomach. And that's what allows me to go to this temple and join myself with these prostitutes and still claim to be a follower of Jesus.

And Paul says, no, you've got it all wrong. You misunderstood. First of all, you don't fragment body, soul and spirit. God sees you as holistic. God created your body. And he's going to raise it again in the last day. And if you understand that, what you do with your body does very much matter to God. And there's more argument he makes of staying. Of course, his fundamental point was that your body is actually the temple, the inner sanctuary, where God himself dwells in the very presence of the spirit is an incentive. If I really believe God is in dwelling, man. He is encouraging at the least encouraging me to live a holy life. And notice that I don't get the spirit after I get my life together. I get my, the Holy Spirit in the beginning of my life when it's still a mess because I need the Holy Spirit to live the righteous life, the holy life. And there's where we've gone so far. Now, I had two choices. One is to go and break next speed and take you through a bunch of pastors and finish up this question today. We're to break into two spots, two portions. And I'm going to do that.

So I'm going to pace myself today. And we'll finish this question up next week just before spring break. And then we're going to pick up after spring break with, I think we're going to start looking at the book of Acts, which is fascinating to me when you look at all of this. So let's start with this text now that we've

seen where we have been. We're going to look at Romans chapter 8. Now, before we do that, let me do as I've done with each of these texts. It's very important. I'm also trying to teach you how I'm doing this because whenever you look at scripture, don't just look at one isolated scripture, understand the context of it. When you understand the context of a passage, you can go through the sweat equity of figuring that out. The actual specific text you're looking at, one, you, you protect yourself from saying something that God didn't intend, always looking in context. The text cannot mean today what it did not mean back then. I understand that makes sense to you. When Paul originally wrote or Peter originally wrote, if it didn't mean a fact then it doesn't mean now today.

So if I take this bridging from exegesis past tense to hermeneutic applying it to today, what does it mean to me today? Well, the sweat equity is figuring out what it originally meant. And if I do my homework there, then by building a bridge to okay, now how do I apply this to today? Then I'm going to be much more likely to be in the context of what got intended truthfulness. And it's the truth that sets us free. Error will put you in bondage. And you have a great deal of that if you leave and look in the first century when they're reading these letters for place, all these things that they did not understand that were putting them in bondage. Interesting enough of the Corinthians, their abuse of the spirits, gifts, were put them in bondage. And it wasn't too different from what you see today in the pictures that we looked at earlier with all these experiential things that were defining the presence of the spirit in their life. Now in Romans chapter 6 Paul begins an argument.

All along he's trying to argue fundamentally in Romans and it's kind of the gospel in a nutshell. Although it's very deep and very profound when you look at the context, the whole context of Romans. As Peter says, some things Paul wrote are hard to understand. And he once says that all the scriptures are simple, not reading very carefully. Even Peter noted in reading Paul writings, which were recognized as scriptures in the first century by Peter, saying some of the things Paul wrote are hard to understand, which the unstable distort to their own destruction. But if you see the very context that statement, he still has responsible to stop and think, I gave you a mind, you created you in his image, you pray and God can help reveal and help you learn and go to learn and understand the intent of passages, but it takes some work. So he's kind of walking him through this process and basically is arguing this issue of grace. The whether or not you're a Jew who's been under the law and always followed God and had this great heritage, spirit heritage, or you're a Gentile that's being grafted into this spiritual tree coming in from outside, if you will, being an outsider and becoming an insider, we're all saved by grace. And there were some though that look Paul in the eye and said, this gospel, this gospel of grace of God just forgiving you, it sounds to me that if I really just believe God forgives me, then well, I can make the argument that I can live any way I want. In other words, I don't have to change my life because God's gonna forgive me anyway, so why don't I just live this ungodly life, this God, this life, not like Jesus, but God, and I just, oh, God just forgive me and God just forgive me and I end up in the same destination anyway. And Paul says, okay, we've misunderstood grace. And so he starts with the question, shall we sin that grace may increase? That's where chapter 6, Roman chapter 6 begins.

And it begins to do a very thoughtful, intelligent response to, let me tell you why it matters, how you live. And of course, we used to go to Romans 6 to talk about the issue of baptism, which that's where Paul goes, he's not arguing baptism, he's arguing the implications of baptism. And we're obligated to live a holy life. Our lives have said no longer be instruments of unrighteousness, but there's supposed to be tools of God for righteousness. Now, there's a problem though. If we do this without the empowerment of God, you end up in Romans 7. And what he basically says is the law, the law, which pointed out what was right and what was wrong. You know, we have a conscience and God teaches us and we learn about, okay, this is where I should go. This is where I want to go if my heart's directed toward God. But if I try to walk that pathway, I keep on feeling like I'm being sabotaged. I can't get there. The law keeps pointing out defining for me what is right, but it can't deliver me from the problem that started at the fall.

My fall in nature, the curse, my DNA being whipped if you will spiritually, the Adam and me. And God wants to come and restore all of that and put it back the way he intended it. That is what the kingdom of God is. And it starts in you. And it starts with the spirit of God indwelling you, restoring your life, remolding your life and giving you the ability to be the way God originally intended us to be when he first created man and woman. So we get the first fruits of it with the spirit in our life, although it's full realization doesn't come until we have the resurrected bodies and then we're perfect. But we'll get there later. But here I am sitting there. I know what the right thing to do is, but I find that the power of sin, Paul says, sabotages my best intentions.

I can will it, but I can't do the thing. So the very good things I want to do, I find myself not doing the very things I don't want to do. The pathway I'm trying to avoid, I keep finding myself on it. And finally Paul just throws his hands up in the air and then Romans 7 says, who's going to save me from the body of this death? And of course that's where he then immediately says, let me tell you the answer. Answer is Jesus Christ. Thanks be to God through our Lord Jesus Christ. He provided the Romans chapter 8 verse 1. There is no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus. God built a put you in a right relationship. He starts you as a sanctified, completed tense. He set you apart. You are holy in the sight of God because of how he sees Jesus.

When he looks at your sinful life, what he really sees is the perfect, seamless life of Jesus because Jesus became your substitute. Here's your sinful life. Jesus stands in, cover you over. When God sees you, He sees a perfectly holy, set apart, sanctified, justified human being. The requirement for the law are met in Jesus. That is what grace is for you and me. Now, now that I am that, I'm now called to live this. And so Jesus rescues me. And I have here, yes, Jesus sets things right in this life of contradictions, of wanting to do the good and finding myself not to be able to do it. And then if you go into Romans chapter 8, what he starts speaking about, and it's not a coincidence, he starts hearing all about the spirit of God, in dwelling you. In fact, in four verses, he'll say, the spirit lives in you, in you, in you four times before this text of we're about to read.

Now, notice what he says, as he makes this point. Therefore, brothers, we have an obligation. Well, it's the obligation to live the very life that God has called us to, to live what you are holy. Now, we just got through in Romans 7 and saying, you can't do this on your own. You do it on your own, you're just going to find yourself walking, having good intentions, but being sabotaged every time you turn around. But it is not to the sinful nature that's to live according to it. For if you live according to the sinful nature, notice you will die. But, notice, if by the spirit, not by your own empowerment, not by your own volition, remember your volition shows up in Romans 7. You wondered, but you can't. But the spirit of God lives in you, lives in you, lives in you, lives in you.

You put the decimities of the body, that's how you do it. You will live because those who are led by the spirit of God are sons of God. So here is to find, where does it mean to be led by the spirit of God? The actual character of your life reflects that. Not bizarre behaviors, but if you really look like Jesus or not, and we have no excuse because God's one doing empowering. He's going to help to get over the sinful nature. I'm no longer to stalemate with myself, if I'm living by the spirit.

So in our struggle against evil, the indwelling Holy Spirit supplies enabling strength. We put to death, and by the way, that word is present and continual. I'm continually putting the death to the misdeeds of the body, and not a once and for all, you know, I just fight over Sunday. I see the spirit, he fights and eradicates and I become sinless, which remember, if you heard the concourse preachers, they were kind of espousing that theology. That's not what this word suggests. It's a continual, it assumes a long-term journey of fighting the sinful nature. If you persist in the struggle with the help of the Holy Spirit, you then demonstrate that you are Son of God. That's how I know the spirit's active in your life. That's how I know you're being led by the spirit. Look at your life.

So what does Holy Spirit do? His present encourages and strengthens and enables him a person to strive

against. Sin, I have a few phrases here. I was reading somewhere in the past couple weeks, a person made the comment. I don't want to live my life. I don't want to live my life. I don't want my life to be explainable without the Holy Spirit. I don't want my life to be explainable without the Holy Spirit. Romans 7 explains my life without the spirit. Romans 8 explains my life with the Spirit. I want to live in such a way that I am desperate for the Holy Spirit to come through in my life. Now, in part, look at this passage, we're not talking here about quietism, quietism is this philosophy of you just simply let go and let God, in other words you become someone like a puppet on a string. Just hand it strings to God and He'll just, you just become passive, inactive, we're just kind of hanging around and God will just do it for you.

And so with them we encounter scriptures like this in Philippians which kind of challenges that a little bit. I want you to understand the Holy Spirit does not displace our efforts, nor do we try it alone. Try it alone, you end up in Romans 7. So He says this, continue to work out your salvation with fear and trembling. This is serious business, living for God and living the Holy life He's called you to. And so it's helped me right here, I am not passive in this process. Now work out does not mean you earn your salvation. It carries the idea like working out like a roba sizing. A roba size the fact that you are a saved person, live out what you are, be a holy person. Clear call, you are active. Not passivity, it's not just relinquishing responsibility, there's no strings, God's pulling, He's not coercing, He wants your willingness. We keep you talking about the devils, your willingness, God has your willingness, He can direct your life. If you really wanted to do this, He will empower you to overcome the things that now imprison you and keep you in bondage, that keep you from being like Jesus. So He goes on to say this, why do I work out my salvation with fear and trembling? Well, you know the rest of this one, for it is God who is that work in you to willing to act according to his good purposes or in order to fulfill his good purposes.

I think some person called it, it's kind of the bothness of work. New work, God works. You work because God's at work. Now, God didn't come in to this too, His spirit and enable this process. You would run into the radical frustration of Romans 7, the good you want to do, you can't do, and the bad you don't want to do, you find up doing and natural, let's find your life. So Fran, Francis, I think I'll take you there next. We'll go here. Anyway, we ought to play an act of role in our journey toward wholeness. I think God could just fix our lives. We've talked about, in other words, do we expect this because God puts a spirit in us that all of a sudden I just the blink of an eye, snap a finger, I just go from here to here without really being conscious of the change. I think God can do that. God can make radical changes. I have met people who have faced very difficult circumstances in life on all levels, addictions, things that nature, and it's like God just stepped in and just because of their willingness and desire to give their life over to him, just if you ever tried to break a bad habit, you know how hard that is.

We're talking serious addictions in life. I think it takes some power that only God can offer. More than not, at least my experience is that God wants me to come along in the journey and be very conscious of it. I go through a learning curve. I have to experience this process. I have to go to the struggle, which is what Romans 8 points to continually putting the death to misdeeds and body. I'm engaged in this process. I'm not passive in this role. And I think there's a wisdom of God where he activates us, where he could just, if you will, wave a spiritual magic wand and fix us, but he chooses not to. And that's why I don't believe in a quietism approach to all of this. We work because God isn't working us too. Both of us are emphasized. God's work is the reason for my work. So now let's move into another layer of this. I'm going to take two texts out of the Paul wrote to Thessalonians and he kind of talked about something here that you may have some questions about. In other words, how does the word of God engage this process?

No, if the spirit of God is leading me, then what do I need scriptures for? I'll just kind of, just kind of just sit there and wait for some sort of, you know, the spirit of God to create this understanding. Well, here Paul speak and let him define this process to you. Let's start with 2nd Thessalonians 2, 13. But we always thank God for you, brothers. Love by the Lord because from the beginning, notice you chose, God

shows you to be saved, notice through the sanctifying work of the spirit. And again, you can't see it's not a coincidence, sanctification, holiness always has the word spirit somewhere in the context because that's what he does. That's his job and notice through belief in the truth. Now, I find that interesting. In addition to the idea of encouraging holiness, something else is essential to a life of holiness, not just having the spirit and dwelling you, but having an exposure to an immersion in an invitation to the words of God into your mind and into your life. You need to know what God's will is and you're not going to go know that just by looking inwardly and seeing that it emerges somehow.

You intentionally expose yourself to, as David said, I've hidden your word in my heart so that I will not sin. I actively immerse myself into the words of God. Now, it's what this kind of understanding is so you can maybe distinguish. Understand the scriptures, this is not the spirit. This is the words of the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit is the agent. The scriptures are the instrument that the spirit uses. Now, if you understand how they work together, you'll never find the spirit asking something from you that is a converse to where the scripture leads you. Like there where the Corinthians are arguing, stomach for food, food for stomach, let's go get involved, sexual morality, and we're okay. Well, no, because when God speaks, He says, holiness is defined through purity of sexual life. We're going to have to see that in the framework of all this. So, understand this idea. The spirit is the agent, the scriptures is the instrument, and if I understand also, if you grew up in a church of Christ tradition, and this is not wholesale, this dialogue was rather involved in our history. It's just that we lose some of this dialogue. I grew up hearing more than what they call word only, that the spirit of God only works in your life through the scriptures. So, only as you read the scriptures, you read it and it touches your conscience. That's the Holy Spirit working and that's the end of it. Well, we think you'll scriptures that suggest there's a great deal more to the spirit of activities than simply that. There's an empowering. I need that word of God in my life. I must have that to help not only define, but give me as God prompts my conscience. He brings those scriptures to mind and that helps in my battles against living, not living the sinful nature and living like Jesus. But if I take myself and I'm not really immersed in scriptures, then I'm going to find myself very enneemic where the spirit being handicapped and empowering my life. If you will, the words of God are the fuel as the spirit of God is the flame. Take away the logs, if you will, the words of God that inform our conscience and direct our conscience and lead our direction of life, then the flame just goes out. The spirit is quenched. So, anytime you see this implication where you know, people are kind of going contrary to the word, rather than conjunction with the word, or ways that seem to just not feel the need for the scriptures in their life because they have holy spirit, a red flag should go up. Another text that Paul takes you to in this context says this later on, in the first verse I was going to say, it's probably brothers and sisters, we instructed you on how to live. Here's Paul teaching them as an apostle. In order to please God, as in fact, you are living. Now we ask and urge you and the Lord Jesus to do this more and more.

For you know what instructions we gave you by the authority of the Lord Jesus Christ. So there's this context where you're being instructed by the words of God. It is God's will that you should be sanctified. Now, notice the context here, he's going to be dealing with some things going on in the church in Thessalonica. Once again, it had to do with living a life difference from the pagans, which had a lot to do with sexual immorality because that was just a prevalent thing, not unlike our culture. It is God's will that you should be sanctified, that you should avoid sexual immorality, that each of you should learn to control your own bodies in a way that is holy and honorable.

How are you going to do this, though? Remember, if you're Romans 7 trying to do it on your own, you're stuck. Not in passionate, less like the heathens who do not know God, and that in this matter, no one should wrong his brother or take advantage of him. The Lord won't punish men for all such sins as we have already told you and warned you for God to not call us to be impure, but to live holy lives. Therefore, not a coincidence. He rejects instructions, does not reject God, but man, but God, who gives into you as the actual Greek, into you the Holy Spirit. That's in the red put together sanctified, holy

spirit. How am I going to live this, right here, holy spirit, because he is the enabling power in your life, but notice it comes with instructions. The more you immerse yourself in the scriptures of God, the more you enable the spirit of God to actually energize and direct and empower your life against living the sabotage life of the sinful nature and the frustration and the guilt and the shame that constantly is in the wake of a life like that. Francis Chan says this, and this is the question I just can't get around. If it's true that the spirit of God dwells in us and that our bodies are the Holy Spirit's temple, then shouldn't there be a few different between a person who has the spirit of God living inside of him and her and the person who does not?

Don't you find it to be a legitimate question? He goes on, he says, it may be a silly illustration, but I think it's not so bad. It may be a silly illustration, but if I told you I had an encounter with God where he entered my body and gave me supernatural abilities to play basketball, well, wouldn't you expect to see an amazing improvement in my jump shot, my defense, my speed on court? After all, this is God we're talking about. And if I saw no change, if you saw no change in my athleticism, wouldn't you question the validity of my encounter? Does the world have a right to see that our lives are radically different? Why because of who we are? No, because you are a person in whom God himself dwells through his Holy Spirit. And he's not there just as a paperweight and animate object. He's actually doing something in your life. He has empowered you to live the very life that he's calling you to. You do not do this on your own, but you cannot handle this passively. You immerse yourself in the words of God. You will, you openly and willingly invite God's activities in your life. And you live a life that can only be explained if the Holy Spirit of God is living in you. Otherwise, Paul would say that we are quenching the Holy Spirit.

Now, we're going to pick up with some other things next week. Now, today we're going to go to another segment in Romans 8 where he continues this thought process. Now that the Spirit of God is dwelling you and transforming your life and restoring you to what he originally intended a human being to be like, he's going to talk about acknowledge that we go through a lot of groaning and struggles in this life. He says, we along with creation, all of creation, that was subject to the very same curse that our mortal bodies were. That created the sinful nature. In other words, all of creation, everything you see around you is not the way God intended it. He'll correct that later. This is he groans, but in our present weakness, he's going to tell us that the Spirit helps us. Now, I think this is one of the most encouraging, most overwhelmingly hopeful passages in all scriptures. If you understand it and if you believe it, God is doing something for you as he indwells you. And I'll tell you, this is not doing that for me. The Spirit is doing this for me. He says, he's interceding for me. He's praying for me. And we'll talk about that next week. Listen there. We'll pick up there. We'll look at a few more passages and we'll kind of summit and call us all this before we next week, before we go off to spring break, and then we'll pick up in the book of Acts following that.

Let's pray together.

Class 7: Hope, Intercession, Seal, and Power

Original transcript: `hs07.txt`

Summary: The seventh class moves from sanctification to hope. Jim teaches Romans 8 on groaning and the Spirit's intercession, Ephesians on the Spirit as seal and deposit, and several texts on the Spirit's power to form endurance, patience, joy, and hope.

Key Scripture References

- [Romans 8:18-30](#)
- [2 Corinthians 12:7-10](#)
- [Ephesians 1:13-14](#)
- [Ephesians 1:19-20](#)
- [Ephesians 3:16-17](#)
- [Colossians 1:11-12](#)
- [Romans 15:13](#)
- [Romans 14:17-18](#)
- [1 Corinthians 15](#)
- [Galatians 5:22-23](#)
- [Philippians 4:7](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

The Spirit helps us in weakness and intercedes with groans beyond words.

– [Romans 8:26-27](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

If God truly lives in us, we should expect our lives to look different.

– [Francis Chan, Forgotten God](#). Verified in widely quoted excerpts and reviews of the book; the transcript paraphrases it.

Cleaned Transcript

What does Holy Spirit do? The text where we ended up, I drew this into the context so that you could see that when the Spirit is active in your life, there are some that, you know, they think that if the Spirit is active, it basically dismisses the need for the scriptures of the Word of God to instruct and teach. And you can see in the first century and Paul's mind and the Spirit was deeply active in his life, and notice when he was telling people that the Word of God, that the belief in the truth and being instructed, that was another passage we looked at, that is, the Spirit's activity does not displace the need for the Word of God in your life, but it does work in conjunction with the Word of God in your life. And if one is animically evolved in the scriptures, you're going to have a handicap spirit of God trying to mold and make your life. And the more you are into the Word and immersing your life into the scriptures, the more you, if you will, add fuel to the Spirit's ability and how he does his work in your life, the sanctifying work to create Christ and you.

So, you know, so get into the scriptures and understand therefore, as the psalmist says, David says, I've hidden your Word in my heart and notice it's a sanctifying issue so that I will not sin. And why because the Spirit of God activates and, you know, connected us. So, anyway, that's where we ended last week. Now, we're going to deal with some really, well, yeah, and I talk about the Holy Spirit with the agent and the scriptures and the instrument and understand the difference between this. The next text, well, yeah, I did want to go here too and this is just a, I thought it was kind of a step back and see the implications. Francis Chan, and this is the question. I just can't get around. If it is true that the Spirit of God dwells

in us and that our bodies are the Holy Spirit's temple, which we've talked about, then shouldn't there be a huge difference between a person who has the Spirit of God living inside of him or her and the person who does not?

This may be a silly illustration, but if I told you I had an encounter with God where he entered my body and gave me a supernatural ability to play basketball, wouldn't you expect to see an amazing improvement in my jump shot at my defense, my speed on court? After all, this is God we're talking about. And if I saw no change in, if you saw no change in my, or I saw no change in my athleticism, wouldn't you question the validity of my encounter? And so I think it's a legitimate thought there. And thus you see the context of these statements, the Paul and passages like Ephesians and Galatians where he talks about, you know, do not quench the Holy Spirit. Do not grieve the Holy Spirit. Keep in step with the Holy Spirit. Be filled with the Holy Spirit.

And these statements tend to take on greater meaning when you understand the context that Paul did. If you look at those context, these are the things he's talking about. God changing your life. Okay. Now, the next text I want to take you to, remember we dealt with a segment out of Romans 8 last week. I want to take you to a slice of this that specifically brings in the activities of the Spirit. Now, remember context. It's very important. And this should be one of the most encouraging texts that you'll read in the New Testament. Because that's Paul's intent in the greater context. He's talking about our hope. It's really an argument that began back in Romans chapter 5 and he takes you all the way through. He's talking about what hope does for us. Hope is the idea of you're craning your neck looking out to the future for someone or something that's coming.

And if you believe that it's just imminent, and it's a certainty, which is why Christian hope is framed. We say it's not wishful thinking. It is a certainty that you in a way already possess, but not in the most tangible form yet. It's coming and I have it and it influences my life and the quality of it, but I don't get the fullness of it till later. That plays out already, but not yet theology of scriptures. Why says you possess eternal life. Right now you have it. But at the same time, it's also spoken about as something that you possess more fully in the future, in the coming of Jesus. Where our bodies are transformed and finally the ultimate redemption of life and all of creation takes place. And Romans 8 is playing this out. And now the spirit of God has a place in creating this enormous hope in your life.

But he first talks about how there's all these people groaning. Everything's groaning. He talks about interesting enough all of creation groans. And you begin to realize if you pay really close attention to reveling up to Romans 8, and the theology that Paul had in mind, and I'm going to be dealing with this more specifically in the heaven series, and a couple more sermons, which is where one of the greater surprises comes to me, is that we have to understand that all of creation is bound up with humanity. That God, if you read Romans 8, says he's going to redeem all of creation. Remember in the fall creation was influenced too. It went awry. It carried the effects of the sinful decisions that were made in the garden. And it affected everything. The entire cosmos was changed. And so he says, first of all, all of creation groans. All of us groan as human beings. And he thought to tell us that even the Holy Spirit groans.

And it's kind of mentioning that there is a special language for believers. And it's called groaning. That's not gripping. It's groaning. There's a difference. There's a yearning for something that's out there that we see and sense and desperately want to possess, but don't have the fullness of it yet and yearn for it. And sometimes it's overwhelming. And thus we groan. And you'll see how this plays out here with the spirit and this text that we're about to look in. But this is the greater context of this. And he talks about in this groaning that we basically have limitations that in this present world we're brought with pressures and limitations and weaknesses and temptations. And we just fill enormously inadequate to handle this life on our own. We see in the context of this. And I think it's an important thing to look at the spirit.

And this is all set up. Just stay with me. Where Christianity does not offer that it's going to help you transcend all your problems and struggles. And if you listen to certain theologies nowadays, it's kind of a triumphal theology where you come to Christianity and God just fixes everything and you just fly over everything. That's never really the case. It keeps talking about how we're going to suffer for the duration of our life on this earth because we're fallen human beings living in the fallen world. And that will always be the case until the ultimate redemption takes place and everything is put right. But now that's why we groan. We always will struggle.

So how am I going to have hope in the midst of all of these limitations and difficulties that this world keeps going at me? The Christian has something radically different than the world does not have. And part of that is a certain reality that I find strength from. The three of realities that he argues are a hope and anticipation of future glory. The text we're going to skew in on now is help from the Holy Spirit. And thirdly, it's where we find that great text. Everyone quotes and rightly so, although I'm not sure we quite understand sometimes, that God will work out all things for the good to those who love them and we're called in cordialist purpose. Clean to that promise, but understand what it's promising, what it's not promising. It didn't say everything in your life that happens is good.

Doesn't mean we tend to interpret that also materialistically. This is for free because now we're going to go back to the text. Well, if I lose my job, that must mean God's going to give me a much better pain job. Well, that may or may not be. Let's talk about that text of suggested. But it's saying you step back and see the big picture where God is trying to take you in his intent towards restoration and healing and redemption. Nothing will thwart God's purpose. Nothing. All things will ultimately look at the equation. It equals and you win at the end of all this.

So those three realities of what helped me live as a fallen human being in this world, and I've got advantages. I'm privy because I'm a believer. So now we come to this technical. Let's just, you know, take that bigger window and just kind of focus in on this text. In the same way, the spirit helps us in our weakness. Does it sound like the spirit is doing something or supposed to be received as doing something for the believer? What is it? Yes. Now, let's just freeze frame for a moment. Let's read all technical. We'll come back and freeze frame a few words. We do not know what we ought to pray, but the spirit himself, listen, the spirit himself intercedes with groans that words cannot express. And he who searches our hearts knows the mind of the spirit because the spirit intercedes for the saints in accordance with God's will.

Now, let's just kind of not dismantle it, but just kind of look at this and then put the dots together and find the joy of this. If you get there, then I've done my job. The word, it says, it helps us. It's a really a picturesque word. It means that the Holy Spirit takes hold of our weaknesses and helps lift the load. Now, this may, you know, it's kind of like the basketball illustration. You always feel a bit, you know, I don't want trivializes, but I just want you to help you understand the idea. The first thing that went to my mind is an imagery. It's the old Safari movies I used to watch. And you get these guys out on the Safari and they would bag a lion or a tiger or something or a big huge out. And they had to carry it back to camp. How did they carry that huge animal back to camp?

They didn't have a vehicle. No one person could carry it because you're dealing with, you know, a ton worth of weight of something or, you know, 800 pounds of this particular wild animal. And you've got to get it back to camp. How are they going to do it? Okay. Where did I get it? They tied the front legs together, tied the back legs together, run a stick through it. And I get on one end and I lift it up to my shoulder and someone gets on the other end of the other shoulder and we share the weight. That's what this word pictures. Now, you're on one end with me. You've got to carry some weight. You're enduring things this world. There is suffering. You're not transcending it. You don't get to escape all of this just because you're a Christian.

But it's saying, guess who's picking up the other end? The Spirit is. God's free strong. Now, yes, God

could just pick up the whole thing. He's God. But he chooses not to because he's got to go for all of this. His goal is not to help you transcend all of your problems because he's trying to make something of you. In other words, he's not just trying to get you to heaven. He's trying to get a certain kind of person to heaven. So just see that word whenever you've got problems. And we're going to get to the specific here in a minute prior. But he says, he helps you in our week. You feel weak? The Spirit is trying to decide who can help. God's not coercive. He's not going to force himself upon you. You have to invite him. Thus do not grieve the Spirit. Keep in step with him. Receive him. Embrace him. Open your life to him. He will help you.

Of course, he helps you. Then you're also responsible. You can't say, well, I'm just a victim of life. I just do what I've, you know, I just can't help it. I just live this way. No, because Spirit is good. And then I find the strength to be what God calls me to be. Now, so the Holy Spirit takes hold of my weaknesses. And he helped lift me up. In essence, he places himself that I have written down on one end of a heavy load to pick up and carry it. But notice that his very transitions have been a specific need that I have. He helps me with prayer. We know we need something, but we don't know exactly what. At such times, it says that the Holy Spirit intercedes for me. That's not that complicated. If I say as a human being, I'm going to intercede for Tony. He say he put a prayer request out on the list.

And I'm interceding. What am I doing? Just tell me what I'm doing. Translate intercede. Say it again. If I'm interceding in prayer for Tony, what am I doing? Okay, I am approaching God on his behalf. Now, the Holy Spirit is interceding for you. Translate. Not that complicated. Although I've seen people do things with this passage, it has no meaning when he gets through with it. All I know is, it says Spirit doing something for you and it is an unbelievably profound. The Spirit that indwells you knows you. And when you're struggling, I mean, have any ever been in such ways you just feel overwhelmed? You're just needy at Whitsand. Don't know where to go. Those are the moments when we find ourselves most open to God. When Paul say, when he tried to have the thorn removed from his flesh, like the thorn in his side, he referred to.

We don't know exactly what that referred to. Several say possibly a physical illness, which is typically what it's translated as. And God did not fix it. He said, look, I could be a much better missionary, but I didn't have to drag this problem round with me all the time. So he just helped me fix it, so I can get on. And God wouldn't do it. What did God say? No. My grace is sufficient for my power is perfected in your weakness. Because when I'm weak, I need God. When I'm not weak, I don't think I need God.

So that's why when I'm groaning, God, I need, when up there help. Faith says, I go to Him. And it tells me that when I'm praying, and I don't know, I mean, it's somebody that's a very confusing world. It's an overwhelming world. I just groaned. Now, it says, first of all, the spirit groans with us. He's not just in us. He groans with us. Translate that one. God Himself deeply sympathizes with your struggles. That alone helped me out. But he's not inactive with it. He's not just saying, oh, it's just so bad. I really hurt for you. I'm glad he knows what he is, but he does hurt for me. But now I'm going to do something for you. Because I feel so deeply where you're at. And I don't understand why God does this. I mean, it's like David and Saul made, every week's Saul made. David was looking up his guy. He was a shepherd. He was sitting there in the fields, looking to the skies one night.

Obviously, it was a beautiful night. He looked up at the stars and the universe and the moon. He said, who am I that you would even be mindful of this? I'm just, I'm not even on the radar. I'm a blimp. I'm a pebble on the seashore and you've got me focused in and you know who I am and you know everything about me. And you care about me. I don't understand this. Oh, I know that that's the way God is. My life is a serious focus with God. And when I'm in pain, he is in pain with me. So he says, I tell you what, you may not know what you need, but I do. And when I'm stalemated in my life, I'm still getting on with it because God is interceding for me. Isn't that great? The spirit is doing something, even when I'm helpless. God cares deeply. God feels deeply.

Now, what this does not say and the reason I raised up because this is a text that's used, people say when he talked about grunting, then what we're speaking about is, oh, that's referring to speaking in tongues with words, you know, that cannot be uttered or expressed. And I was taught at one time that that's what that text was referring to. Oh, so that when you're struggling, then just speaking tongue, although you don't understand what you're saying God does, the spirit is speaking through you to God. Well, I mean, okay, I can see what I can see this picture you're painting, but just a simple question is speaking in tongues mentioned anywhere in the book of Romans at all, not to mention just, you know, chapters 5, 6, 7, 8.

In other words, is it even in the dialogue? No. So what you're seeing is, I see a text and I want to mean this so often they call I imported into the text, although it's an outsider to the dialogue. If it's nothing, Paul, that doesn't have that in mind. So we'll give you up to be very careful with these things where we go with these things, where we take certain texts. And if you keep it in context, it'll speak for itself. There's nothing to do here with speaking in tongues. It just says, God, groans, just like you've grown as creation groans.

So even when you're overwhelmed, God is there and God is active. It's great. Wonderful. Embrace the blessing. Next text, what else the spirit doing? You may think this is rather insignificant, but you ought to pay attention to this. He was right to the Ephesians. By the way, the Ephesians were, I think about the Ephesians letter. You know, I tend to sit back and see the big picture of these people. These were people, if you look what Paul says to them, it was a church that just was not thoroughly impressed with God. And they should have been. They were sleeping the pews acting like they just deserved all this entitlement of life. And Paul writes to us, you guys have any idea the blessings that are in Christ Jesus. And so he starts playing them all out throughout this letter. And then he gets the implications because of all of these blessings, live this way.

That's why the Holy Spirit's in the midst of all this. And he's mentioned several times in the book of Ephesians. And, but notice what he says here, isn't the first chapter. Part of this, you should be really thoroughly impressed with God. Let me tell you why in the Spirit is part of it. And you also were included in Christ when you heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation. So you see that principle we talked about on the front end in the beginning. He's talked about in the very initial stages when when you and Jesus came together. The Spirit is given to you. Having believed, you'd notice we're marked in him with a seal. The promised Holy Spirit. Who is a deposit guaranteeing our inheritance until the redemption of those who are God's possession to the praise of his glory.

What are the two key words in this text in terms of answering the question, what does the Holy Spirit do? Should we do hard to focus on? It's in the white words. Two of them. One would be seal. The other is the operative word deposit. So, my point is we read this word, but do you ever stop thinking what that means? Okay, doing something, let's move on. But we don't really stop thinking, what is God telling you that the Spirit is doing in your life? And it comes with some really great understanding. Remember, the blessings are received when you first understand it. How do you embrace this, the idea of word? Stop and think.

Okay, let's look at the word seal. I think of two things. Back in, you know, trying to send a communication to somebody. And, you know, before, you know, there was all the technology of today. And I wanted to send a very important communications. I would send it through a very special carrier because the carrier identified it coming from me. But there was something else that identified it and authenticated it. I would have some ranking prominence in a culture. I would have a proper ring like a king. We've seen this happen on television and they drop some alax and they pop their ring on there. And it seals the letter. You can tell what the letter has been opened or not, which would be in an authenticated letter. And it would put it to question. But it's doing something primarily when that person to accept receiver of that letter sees this and sees the seal. What do they know? The obvious.

But it's sealed. What does it do? I heard word. Okay, it gives an identity. And then the other one, you see the brand. That's a brand. You know, for all the, you know, PETA people, this is a hard moment. But the, the, but for you guys who farm, how many of you actually branded cattle before? I don't know, just one really. I'm surprised. Boy, this is the graying culture we live in is really just disappearing from the face of the earth. I just have several in the group. Oh, yeah, you know, we pop them and knock them out and do all those things.

Okay, so I, I, I, I brand a why do they do this? Because we're just really masochistic. We're not masochistic. We're just abusive and love to see things suffer. What do we do this? So if I see that cow with that, you know, circle on a K on it or circle B is make the breaker off ranch. What did they know? That, that cow belongs to me. Don't touch. You steal, you're in trouble. And, and the reason they brand version, I was just, you know, be nice and take a magic marker or something, but I can remove a magic marker. I can't remove a brand. It's permanent. That's why we brand. And I'm really thankful that this is not a physical branding, aren't you? To be a Christian. Remember, if you're a Jew, you got one called circumcision. Well, guys got one. And, you know, fortunately, I got it done when there were children, you know, babies. And I remember much days after I was born.

So I guess that's why God doesn't give us much memory when we were children, regardless, because all the things we go through, shots and poking and prodding and things they do is putting it, durvenous things in the top of our head that soft spot off. Just awful. It's a seal. The spirit is sealing your life. It is God's mark on you that shows that you belong to him. God sees it. It's spiritually discerned. I don't know. How do you feel about that? An assurance that you are a son and daughter of God. Absolutely certain. No questions. Easily identified to God. Sometimes we have struggles with that. We acknowledge ourselves as being a child of God. And, although it's really easier sometimes, I think the first to see other people children of God becomes us because I'm a real center, though, and, you know, so I'm kind of exempt from that assurance. It's funny how we are.

We think we're saved as a church, but we're not saved as individuals. I've always found that ironic, because it's supposed to trickle into every heart. And that's what that's saying. How assured do you feel? You're christianing out of the spirit. Go to the shore. That's why God gave it to you. He's doing. He's actually marking your life. Now, he says that you are that the spirit is a deposit. Okay. I will tell you up front. This word is a commerce term. Use this like it is today back in the first century. The buying and selling. Now, I remember when Mary and I bought our first house here at Auburn, both my first house period. We lived here for the first five, six years. And then when Amy came along, we told the shepherds, you know, here, I said, look, we'll live here, but we have our first child. We're out of here.

And so, you know, and comes Amy and out goes us and we go find a house. And we live on penny lane. And I think what we all like to be so much. I don't know. I don't know. I live on penny lane. I'm just not in London, but the although I've been there. It's really neat. The anyway, we bought a house. Now, you know, Mary and I live within our means. And, you know, as a basic philosophy. This is for free too. But it's good advice. Don't buy what you don't have. Don't live off plastic in living debt. But, you know, I didn't have, it was, it was a starter house. It was a three bedroom, two bath, two bath, a house. And as around, oh, 1300 square feet, which really was enormous for us up to living here.

You know, that sounds like a shack in our culture. We almost think it is. It's enormous. And, I mean, I even had an extra bedroom. We didn't know what to do with it. We had no mercy. We had Mary and I and we had this extra bedroom sitting over there. So, you know, we just stuff stuff in it because we had stuff. But, you know, I remember, you know, of course, the houses back then were not the same house now, it'd be more unbelievable now. I'm trying to remember what we paid for. But it was obviously a whole lot more than I had cash for. You know, obviously a certain expenditures that you have to, you put down a deposit. Now, think about the idea. Now, understand what deposit means.

What does it mean? So, say, I'm going to make simple. Say it's a hundred thousand dollar house, which

wouldn't get you much nowadays. But I can only release, you know, maybe ten thousand. Now, I got that nest they put there because I was preparing to buy house and so on. So, I give a ten thousand dollar deposit. Now, play it out. What is that side? Okay. It's a promise to pay and does that house belong to me? It's kind of a kind of in it. In other words, in part, yes, but not in full. In a way, you can say the bank owns it. And that's why all these four closures people couldn't finish up what they promised. Right. Now, what strikes me as so profound about this is God, like God has to give a deposit for anything. But he is chosen to give you the spirit and it says it's a deposit. He is putting payment into your life. We owe him. Why is he paying me?

And he puts a deposit down. That's doing a lot of other things we've already talked about. But part of what he does is it guarantees that this thing we yearn for and grown for. This life, this resurrected body that is promised, living in a new heaven and a new earth, a perfect world, everything is put right. No more struggle with sin. No more struggle with forgetfulness, no more struggle with sickness, no more struggle with feeble life, no more struggle with any kind of limitation whatsoever. I cannot imagine what our resurrected bodies are going to be capable of. We're going to be all be just, you know, we're just going to look good, sound good, perform good. It's just going to be just an unbelievable world. And we're going to be able to put the task and we're going to be on top everything. It's just going to be wonderful. I can already imagine.

And I'll talk about that in the heaven series too, because I think that's worth thinking about. But God's promising the possession of all that by giving you His Spirit. So, you know, that is a very active thing that the Spirit is doing. We think it's somewhat inanimate. He just shows up and it, you know, it puts a stamp on us. But understand the implications. It is assurance that God receives us as sons and daughters and it's an absolute guarantee. God getting you the guarantee. So, we deserve this. There's no way we're entitled to it. A complete inheritance. All these things promised. Things that we haven't really quite stopped to think and imagine how wonderful it's going to be. Beyond simply this kind of ethereal life and life must be good because it's called heaven. Better than that. Finally, last passage I want to look to it and everything's going to build on this.

I pray, you know, notice what, well, let me say this first. You'll find throughout the New Testament that it speaks of a power that is at work for and in Christians. I can do all things to Christ who strengthens me. Work out your salvation with fear and trembling. We looked at it last week for it is God who is at work in you creating life around and in you. Ephesians 1.19, the power that raised Jesus from the dead is the same power that God has put in you when he gave you a spirit. My point is, he pointed to the fact that this ultimate redemption moment and when the resurrection comes, this spirit is going to energize all of that. Boom, and a sprinkling of an eye. You're going to transform. That's the spirit doing this. It's going to recreate your everything about you.

And these physical bodies, these frail physical bodies are the raw material that God's going to use. Read 1 Corinthians 15. That's what the Corinthians didn't quite understand. It's really great. We're going to be impressed with it. So, but there are specific passions that tell us where this power is. And I'm speaking ahead of myself and it's passions like this. This is clear and direct as I know to read. Paul could just read my lips here it is. I pray what? That of his glorious riches he may do what? Strengthen you with power. How? Through his spirit. Where? holy helicopter hovering over your life. You're just kind of beaming down powers and you know the force be with you. No, in your inner being. How many times does God have to say in you, in you, in you, in you, in you, in you, in you?

To understand God is in us. It's the indwelling Holy Spirit. So that Christ, why so that Christ made dwell? Here's the goal. The Christ made dwell in your hearts through faith. Notice where it ends up. I look like Jesus. Now, a lot of passages, this bill just for example, I mean I'm just trying to show you some of the passions that speak about this. We're almost done. Where Jesus tells the Colossians, being strengthened with all power. Notice according to his glorious might so that you may have noticed.

Notice where it leads to great endurance and patience and joyfully giving thanks to the Father. What is the Spirit doing? Look at the words associated what it's creating in your life. Other passages, Romans 15 right here, may the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace as you trust him so that you may overflow with hope. Notice by the power of the Holy Spirit. For the kingdom of God is not a matter of eating and drinking, but of righteousness. A holy life, peace that surpasses all understanding. An unshakable joy that nothing the world should be able to do to rob it from us, unless we give it over. And the Holy Spirit. That's the source because anyone who serves Christ this way is pleasing to God and approved by men. And so I end with this. Another statement from Francis which brings us back to the quote that I read in the beginning.

And I've kind of pieced together a few. These aren't all on the same page in the book. The Holy Spirit desires to do more than help out a bit. He wants to completely transform us. So, in reference to the fruit of the Holy Spirit, notice, do you exhibit more kindness and faithfulness than the Mormons? Interesting question. Do you have more self-control than your Muslim friends? More peace than a Buddhist? A legitimate question. More joy than an atheist. I know a lot of happy pagans. If God truly lives in you, shouldn't you expect to be different than everybody else?

What disturbs me most, Francis goes on to say, is when we are not really bothered that God living in us has not made much of a noticeable difference. I mean, if we actually think God is doing all this for the Spirit that God is just going at us and trying to do all these things for us, and we're not that different, then we should stop in processing. Something's not right here. I'm in a dissonance. I want people to look at my life and know that I couldn't be doing this on my own power. I want to live in such a way that I am desperate for Him to come through. So, it's kind of a, put it in a more pithy statement. The Spirit comes.

Remember what we started to say, and I showed you all this kind of weird, bizarre behavior that's associated with Holy Spirit's activities? And I'll say, well, I have questions about that. But when I really look at scripture, that's not where it points. It points more here. It comes not to produce the weird, but what's necessary, not to do sensational things, but what's practical and profound inside of you, to turn inability to ability. That's what He's doing, to turn inadequacy into adequacy. Yes, I can become this kind of person. I can act like Jesus. I am ultimately without excuse. But why would I want to carry it? When God taking me as His life that I would have no regrets? I am absolutely convinced that the life that I live, a non-believer, wants. And the Holy Spirit is why. So, it's a Holy Spirit doing something in your life, you'd better believe this, but it's not just a big free for all doing anything that everyone says it is.

It has a focus. If you stay there, it's much more profound and much more significant. And so, I've had people in the dialogue and say, well, you just don't really believe in Holy Spirit. I said, oh, yes, I do. Well, you don't really think the Spirit of God is active in your life. I said, you kid me? I think He's enormously active in my life. And it should be part of our dialogue and we should talk about this. God changes my life. And that brings naturally the Holy Spirit's work. The Holy Spirit's work is the sanctifying work of the Holy Spirit. It covers all of this, where we started in the first class. So, I think it's a wonderful thing. The more you understand it, the blessings just overwhelm you. And we ought to be impressed with what God is doing in our life.

If we really did think of what we could become. If we started with this is the basis of why we do what we do and can we do this. I'm ready to take some risks. You with me? I'm ready to step out and do something that I haven't done before. Because I believe this. I didn't call you to be safe. Our problem is that we're maybe far too safe and far too cluttered in our life. Release some of that and let God work. Invite Spirit. Don't grieve the Spirit. Be filled with the Spirit. And that's where you end up. Well, we'll pick up an axe in a couple of weeks. Really neat. And we're going to go to all those hard passages. There's a lot of them that talk about these things. And I'm going to try to give what I think is an honest

assessment and prayers will wear.

Why I think believe certain things in terms of spirits activities. It can be at first reading. Some of them think to be kind of confusing. And what you've even seen to potentially disagree with library told you. Especially in the first couple of classes. But how do you know you have the Spirit and when does it come? And we'll look at that together. Let's pray.

Class 8: Acts Begins: Mission, Pentecost, and the Message of Jesus

Original transcript: `hs08.txt`

Summary: Jim turns to Acts, where the Spirit empowers mission from Jerusalem to the ends of the earth. Pentecost is presented as a unique public event whose miraculous signs serve the Spirit-inspired message of Jesus.

Key Scripture References

- [Acts 1:8](#)
- [Matthew 28:18-20](#)
- [Acts 1:1-26](#)
- [Acts 2:1-41](#)
- [Acts 9](#)
- [Acts 15](#)
- [Acts 16:6-7](#)
- [John 16:7](#)
- [Joel 2:28-32](#)
- [Genesis 11:1-9](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

You will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you, and you will be witnesses.

– [Acts 1:8](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

God promised to pour out his Spirit on all people.

– [Acts 2:16-18](#). Peter quotes Joel; version not stated in the audio.

Cleaned Transcript

As I mentioned before the break, we're going to start transitioning now in this Holy Spirit class looking at the Holy Spirit in the Book of Acts. My dilemma is where to go with all of this. And let's just start right in the front end where the Book of Acts starts. Of course, if you know the Book of Acts, you know that the Spirit of God is very prominent throughout the Book of Acts. It is not a coincidence. Although, again, as I began this series talking about using Francis Chan's book *Forgotten God*, certainly it's something as I reflect back on how many times I've read through the Book of Acts and just really never noticed because I was in a context where it wasn't really emphasized. And that is not a complaint. It is just the way it was for me and I don't want it to be that way, the way it is for you.

The Holy Spirit is a very important, significant, not the mention we're talking about God. And I would imagine God is rather important in what we do when we go study the scriptures. And so, you know, looking at how God is active in our world is very important that we then frame both in what is the Holy Spirit's activities. And I tell you what, God is deeply involved in orchestrating and setting the stage for what you and I are part of today in the Kingdom of God. And we see it all beginning there in the Book of Acts in certain ways. He says this, but you, Jesus says, when we see power, when the Holy Spirit comes on you, and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem and in Judea and Samaria into the end of the earth. And of course, if you understand, of course, whenever the writer is writing a book, if you pay attention, they tell you on the front end how the rest of their letter or their book is going to be framed.

You're actually seeing how the church and the message of Jesus entered into the microcosm of Jerusalem spread into the region of Judea, then into Samaria, and then it ultimately went all the world. And so,

chapters 1 through 7, you have Judea or Jerusalem, chapters 8, chapter 11, beginning of part, chapter 11, you get the moving into the realm of Samaria. And then from there on out, you've got the message just unleashing into the whole world. And the spirit of God is stepping right with the process and energizing every bit of it, you'll know. And so, it's kind of interesting where I stop to think about this, that, you know, if you look at the Great Commission Statement, we think of the Great Commission, Matthew 28, Jesus made more than one Great Commission Statement. But they were all made fundamentally between the resurrection and the ascension. And many things you learned from that, but one of those is this was a primary concern of Jesus.

Before he left, he wanted the church to know this is what I've created you to do. This is what we're about, getting the good news out into the world. And of course in America, we've kind of rewritten all of this, but that's part of what we're struggling against and trying to recapture rather than reinvent Jesus, trying to recapture where he sent us in the first place. And it starts right here in the beginning of a book of Acts, his concerns or that. And of course you notice how the spirit of God is smack dab in the center of this thing. And I'll talk a little bit more about that in just a moment, but basically this, that the spirit of Christ is the spirit of missions. The closer you get to God and the Holy Spirit, the closer you understand his dwelling in your life, the closer you're going to become one passionate about getting the message of Jesus to the lost world.

That's where the spirit takes you. Where you let God in, that's where he sent you. And it's not coincidence. So anyway, obviously Jesus's last command should be our first concern. And so as I go through the book of Acts, that's from, I'm seeing all of this happening. It's not a coincidence that wherever you see the message getting out of the spirit of God is somehow permeating those situations. And we're going to see this true. Obviously, I have, I have set a certain stage. And it's when I get to the book of Acts and it's in the spirit's activity in the book of Acts. And I begin not only to see some of the, the, the potency of God's involvement in the church and in the world today. But I also begin to encounter some things that create some, some thought difficulties as I deal with some of the questions we've already dealt with.

And some of you already raised a few of these questions looking ahead at the book of Acts. Yeah, but how did that fit with what happened over here in Acts 9 and Acts 10? And we're going to look at all of those. Now my study of Acts, the Holy Spirit in Acts is not going to be exhaustive. There's just too much that we can talk about. So I'm going to have to be selective. And I've decided what I'm going to do with this primarily is to speak and focus more selectively on the conversion processes where the Holy Spirit is involved. And you'll see its reflection on the places we've already been, as we've asked the question, what does the Holy Spirit do? How do you know you have the Holy Spirit?

How do you receive the Holy Spirit? And this is obviously the territory that we've already traveled. And so I'm hoping this will begin to connect some dots and in some way that your mind's spinning a little bit because it challenges some of our thinking and how this works. But I'd like to kind of take you where my studies have let me thus far to navigate some of these things. But you know, as I look at the Acts chapter 1 verse 8, the Holy Spirit has been involved in quite a few things about the book of Acts. It's directly associated in giving boldness to people to witness for Jesus. The Holy Spirit says the Spirit moved and boom, they began to preach the Word of God more boldly. It's specifically associated with encouragement in the church and how it grew in numbers. If you look in Acts chapter 9, it also, you see clear examples of the promise Jesus made.

You don't fear when you get placed in front of governors and political figures and people that are in very intimidating circumstances, it goes, don't fear what you will say because the Holy Spirit will give you what to say. And you see this actually occur where God helps them frame, not only gives them the boldness to speak, but He also gives them the framework of what to say. And the Spirit of God is what is energizing this clearly on those scriptures. And it speaks that it also orchestrates special witness

opportunities. And we're going to see the Holy Spirit is putting people together throughout the book of Acts. And the Spirit said the dude's essence is doing this and it's creating these moments which are putting believers and non-believers together. I don't think the Spirit of God does this. You also find with the Spirit of God forbid certain things to happen. It closed certain doors. You remember Paul, Paul, certain missionary trips, he's making his way, for example, to Asia Minor on occasion.

He said, he tried to go one direction. He said, just Holy Spirit for prohibiting him from doing this instead of a different direction. What I mentioned is how exactly he did that. And I'm not really sure how to interpret that in terms of how he actually did it. All I know is that Luke, who is the author of Acts, the author of the author, of course, the Gospel of Luke. He was a doctor, a medical doctor, but also was a constant historian of the writers. And he speaks about, he attributes those moments to the forbidding coming from the Holy Spirit himself. And so I find that interesting. It also identified and sent individuals on special missions. It simply said the Holy Spirit selected these people and sent them on their way as the church made the decisions in conjunction with the Holy Spirit's help. Interesting.

Also, the idea of teaching how, for example, in Acts 15 where James dealing with that really difficult issue between Jews and Gentile, the big gathering they had in Jerusalem with all the church leaders, molded a place, and Paul, Paul, stood up with his gospel. He had these legalists from the Christian community who were trying to cause a Gentile to become Jewish before they could be true Christians. And Paul was fighting that tooth and nail. And of course, you have James ultimately coming out with the consensus statement. He says it seemed best to the Holy Spirit and to us that we do this, this, this. And so again, the Holy Spirit was step by step by step and everything you see taking place in the Book of Acts. And he's doing many, many different kinds of things with my point.

So I said, I can't be exhaustive when looking at every text, but we are going to look selectively and more on the conversion thing. Now, just a quick step through the Book of Acts. So you can see the framework. And we're going to focus here in just a moment on the front end here today and maybe get into Acts 2. But today, I just want to set the stage. Book of Acts, as I mentioned, was written by Luke. Probably written in a very sensible, of course, there's a lot of very specific dating events that allows us to very accurately date the Holy Spirit. The events that took place in the Book of Acts. You see it took place. It starts with understanding of Jesus' death. Barren resurrection was took place. Remember in the Feast of Passover. And in there's debates on whether it was 30 or 33 AD when it took place. But more consensus seems to be around 30 AD. And you're looking at the Book of Acts about a 33, 33 year period.

And in between those 33, 33 years, you have this rather ragtag band of rejects, quote unquote, coming out of, you know, starting in this initial stage of Jesus, all of Jesus' efforts out of the gospels ends up with about 120 people showing up after it's all said and done. And then you've got a bunch of disciples that are just sitting there frightened, hiding behind closed doors after it's all said and done. To where you end up in the Book of Acts and the message of Jesus, the Kingdom of God, has just mushroomed just passionately as fire flaming through the Roman culture, growing all over the Mediterranean world. And ending up with Paul, of course, in prison. And you know that the Book of Acts kind of ends somewhat abruptly. It just ends with Paul preaching while he's in prison there, awaiting his trial and Rome.

And so most likely it was dated. It was written early mid 60s. Now, obviously as you would expect in the context of this, the history of God's activities in this world and the initial stages of the ancient church as it went from infantilism and going through this kind of, you know, progressive revelatory process of growing up and starting from scratch and moving into a major significant movement in the world where God begins to turn the world upside down. You encounter moments where people for the first time in the history of the world encountering the good news, the message of Jesus. And so there's all these conversion processes. And again, you'll note that the Spirit of God is either assumed lurking in the background or very, very demonstratively prominent during these moments. And it's during those demonstrative appearance moments that it creates some interesting dynamics and trying to work through the theology

of the Holy Spirit.

What is he doing? What is he not doing? What should we expect? What should we not expect? How do I know the Spirit of God is active and on and on? So what I'm going to do is select the ones that you see mentioned here because these are the particular events that very specifically mention activities of the Holy Spirit that create a lot of questions. That's why I'm going to selectively choose them to create a framework for you. But I also want you to know behind the scenes that we're not going to cover all other conversions that you see throughout this history, the message going from Jerusalem to Judea to Samaria and to all the world. But I would call it a quote-unquote the quiet conversion, not that they were less significant, but you just find very simple moments where people heard the message of Jesus became Christians and looped his moves on.

But other events, he kind of stops and pauses and says, I'm going to take a really close look at this event. He gives a lot of details. And the question is why? Why didn't he give enormous significant details on some of these other events, but when he gets to these events, he says, I need to explain some things to you here, so let's stop and look at this. Well, that's what I want to do with you as well. It's trying to answer that question, because it will help you understand meeting these other questions that we've already raised in the process of this class. And of course, if you've been hanging on and actually putting your mind to use in this process, you should be able to connect some dots as we go along with this thing. Anyway, there's my answer. Now, obviously the Book of Acts begins chapter one, two basic events. You have the events surrounding the ascension, which I just find out.

What do I not talk about? What do I not spend time on? Again, all we could do is just do some hit and run things. I have actually done an entire devos series on the Book of Acts that lasted around 50 devos, 51, one of the most fascinating things I've done. I've done it before a long, long time ago where I taught a class on it. And every time I go at it, it's just like a new experience. But so many, so many great things I just don't have time to talk about. But anyway, let's start the ascension so you can get a context. Jesus dies during the Passover Feast. God's timing, he is the Lamb of God. As they're sacrificing the Lamb, the Jewish mentality of understanding the sacrificial Lamb who would be the one who would bleed and give his life for the forgiveness of the Israelites sends the true Lamb of God.

He's right there and dying on a cross. And it's funny. They get the Lamb over in the temple being slaughtered, but they miss Jesus completely. It's just unbelievable. When you start thinking of the contrast of what we're taking place at those moments. Jesus was just another criminal being executed, a troublemaker, insurrectionist, terrorist, if you will, leader just being put aside and let's find that the world's finally gotten rid of this troublemaker. And that's kind of how he was treated. And it was a shameful thing. And anyway, of course, three days later he raises from the dead and that's when everything cuts loose.

Then you have says 40 days of resurrection appearances. Really interesting to me. For 40 days, Jesus selectively to his closest disciples. By the way, the first witnesses were who? Who's the first witness of the resurrection? Women. And then he got to have these appearances, multiple appearances to the 12 who are locked away behind closed doors and fear. Because, well, I killed Jesus. What are they going to do to us? So they're in hiding. And in denial the whole time. Remember the women see the, see the rest of the director. Jesus, they go back and tell the disciples, the disciples say, you guys are crazy. You know, these were not believers. These were disbelievers. It was just over their head. And it took several appearances by Jesus and they weren't ghost appearances. It wasn't UFO sightings. It wasn't seeing Elvis Presley up in Minnesota. It was coming. I'll eat with you. You can touch me. Look at the nail prints in my hands, put your hand up in the hole that was a spear went. It is me. I am here. I'm tangible. And a ghost. Jesus says it's not a flesh and blood as you see.

You're seeing Jesus in his resurrected body, which by the way is the body you're going to get when the time comes and the spirits can energize that moment. But that's what we await for. But right now we're

seeing the first fruit of it. Jesus himself raised from the dead. And it's really quite amazing. And so after he has gets many convincing proofs, then you have this resurrection moment. It was a great day for Jesus. It was a very fighting day for everybody else. You know, it was Jesus was kind of like I think I used to use this illustration a long time ago. I think it was yancy that suggests it's like like space traveler coming back to or you know it gets come back home with Jesus gets to go back home heaven. It was a great day for him, a great day of joy. And just I was saying, don't go, don't go. And he says, I've got to go. It's a good thing I go. Remember John 14-16. If I don't go, the spirit of God will not come. But because I go, that's the dead triggers to great moment when the spirit of God will be poured out on all mankind.

It's a good thing. You will not be orphaned. You'll be okay. And you'll have an intimacy with me that the whole world will all the believers around the globe. That right now the only one in me is a human flesh and blood. And I can only be right to one person at a time. But multiply that a millionfold. That's what spirit of God to do because I leave. And so that physical body it says just grew up and disappeared into the clouds. Remember, they were sitting around waiting for Jesus to kind of come back. So, okay, now what? Remember the angel showed up and said, what are you waiting for? What are you guys doing here? Don't you realize Jesus will come back exactly in the way he left? Now, Jesus told him to say, what I want you guys to do. Don't want you to go to Jerusalem.

I want you to hang out. Just wait. We'll come back to that dimension. The second thing that happens in Acts is they replace Judas. Very interesting moment. Judas of course committed suicide. We read that clinically. I want you to know some deep scars that were left in this group at this junction. Remember Jesus chose this person and he ended up being an outright ranked evil portrayer of the kingdom of God. And although it was foreseen, does it mean that it made it even better? It was still seen as a deeply painful moment amongst these Jesus and these disciples. And now they're choosing the replacement. And it's actually do it by casting lots. I've always found that fascinating. They would write the name of the persons. In this case, there were two people that were put up. Arsmas, those justice, and then Messiahs. They put him on it saying, shake it up like playing yachty, I guess.

And the stones come out and whichever stone came out, that was the choice of God. Because remember what's unique about this is these people already knew Jesus. They even see him raised from the dead. They knew the message. They knew who Jesus was. They were intimately acquainted with him. But Jesus says, you're not ready yet. You've got to wait for the spirit to come. But you tell you something. Knowledge of Jesus is not enough. If it was, they were ready to go from the minute they saw Jesus raised from the dead. They are intimately acquainted with this issue. I witness his of it. So they replaced Messiahs through this casting of lots, which is how they made decisions. You can see, this is because here they had knowledge of Jesus. What they didn't know. And they met certain qualifications. Remember the qualification was they had to be with, have been with Jesus since the beginning, since the days of John the Baptist, and experienced him up close and personal and followed him.

So this is one of those followers who started early on in the ministry of Jesus, who stayed around the whole time and were still a believer amongst those 70, for example, ever seen out. This is probably where the other guy were chosen from. But what they didn't know is the hearts of these people. The God did. So God made the ultimate choice. And the Messiahs was the first to be really very interesting. I just fascinated by all this stuff. And so now we come to this point now where we enter into the book of Acts and into chapter 2. Let me go back and start you again with our care, the central charismatic thesis. This is where I've been taking you and I've been kind of highlighting this going along. And I'm trying to help you also filter through some of this as we look at this.

Remember the central charismatic thesis that we've already portrayed. Remember the religious family tree we walk through and the development of thought from Wesley and a perfectionism splitting up stages of conversion. You become a Christian justification, but later on in some undefined period of time. After

earning or yielding or purifying your life, you receive the second work of grace, the fullness of the spirit, sanctification. And so it fragmented the conversion process from stage one to stage two. And stage two is seen as a higher experience. And so you come to this point where through striving, you receive what specifically became known as a baptism in the Holy Spirit with the expectations of speaking in tongues. And the speaking in tongues was the outward manifestation that proved that you received the inner experience of baptism in the Holy Spirit. And later on, I'll probably get to the end of this series, this mini series on Acts. I'll actually tell you what my experience was when I received the baptism in the Holy Spirit and let you know kind of, you know, kind of move the mystery from that and actually talk to you specifically what is done to that and why and how it's done.

Anyway, we'll get to that later. So what's important to understand is those who are supporters of that understanding of the spirit activity in your life. You remember that video I had you watch the Toronto Blessing that kind of leads those directions. And when you go to find proof for these things, they acknowledge that in the gospels, it was only the promise and the letters, the events have already taken place. So where you go to find proof for this premise where I should find evidence that what this acts with the Bible teaches is in the book of Acts, where you actually see the conversion process is taking place. And so there are three things that are suggested that you that we are going to find in the book of Acts. Three issues. One is that the book of Acts does indeed teach subsequent experience.

In other words, when we encounter the conversion process and the spirit activities, do we find indeed that it teaches that Luke's intent was he's writing through the book giving all these conversion experience that we should expect two stages of conversion. A second work of grace that follows your original coming to Jesus. Second of all, second evidence that comes out in the book of Acts is suggested that there is also a teaching that there are certain conditions that you must meet beyond conversion. It's not just that there's a second stage, but there are things that you're supposed to do in between conversion and receiving this supposed second work of grace, the baptism of Holy Spirit, the yielding, the purifying of your life, the surrendering more fully.

So that when you're really ready, God will then give you what you have earned if you remember it. And then third accepted understanding by those who promote this would suggest that the outward manifestation is that of speaking of tongues and that tongues is expected as evidence of having received about the Holy Spirit. So as we're going through all these conversion processes, I'm going to stop and pause and say, well, does it fit this framework? Is this actually what we see? And if you know the book of Acts well, you know there are things that send a point to that to some degree. And that's where we're going to pause and those are the troubling ones. And although I don't find them all that troubling when you really look back at it.

All right, now today, the last thing I want to do is I want to, let's go ahead and just pick out the first of the events. And we're going to pick up an Acts chapter two, of course, which is the feast of Pentecost, where it all begins. Now I've actually heard and said this is where the church was born. And I have questions about that. I think the church seemed to already exist. You already had people who believe in Jesus, who knew the message of Jesus, the resurrection. I don't think this was the birth of the church, so much as it was the birth of the mission of the church. And it's public ministry. They know Jesus what they're waiting for is to be empowered to do these things as a church. And because you already have some rather obstinate believers continuing to get together and pray and do precisely what Jesus said to do.

He said, just go to Jerusalem and wait. Now, waiting was kind of an active process. They weren't passive. They were meeting. They were worshipping. They were sitting there. So Jesus says something supposed to happen is pouring out of the spirit. But we're just supposed to wait. And they would not be able to do what they're called to do. That is the great commissions until the spirit of God came to energize and empower this whole process. Remember, they already had the knowledge. They knew Jesus after the

resurrection. That's the message. They knew better than anybody, but they weren't ready yet.

So they're awaiting this moment. And it's interesting that it takes place on one of the three major feast days. You guys know the major feast days for the Jews, right? Feast of Passover, which happened 50 days earlier, seven weeks earlier. The feast of Pentecost, Penta 50. It's also known as the Feast of Weeks because it took place seven weeks after Passover. And then the third one is the Feast of Tabernacles. Remember that when they celebrated the desert, wanderings, and God actually building a tent and living with them in the desert. The tent of meeting, Moses going in, and all that kind of stuff. And during these major feast days, and I've likened to heard me talk about this stuff, I think the best connection for your sensibilities is consider a major SEC home football game. That's what it was like.

It was a major celebratory condensed moment where people from all over the Mediterranean world, Jews, programming, plus it was mandatory for those who lived within a certain radius. I think about 15, 20 mile radius. Every mail was supposed to be there. That's what they hit adulthood. There would all be that sustained. Of course, it was any Jews dream, especially those who lived in the far-flung parts of the Roman Empire who could not afford or everyday make a trip for every feast day of the year, would at least once their life try to make a pilgrimage to Jerusalem. And you remember Jesus, when he was a child, they would make a pilgrimage from Galilee to Jerusalem for the Feast days. And this was part of a part of his systematic way of living with his parents, if you remember. That's when he got left behind at one time, that kind of stuff. It was for one of those Feast days.

Well, anyway, it's estimated that sometimes a couple million Jews would condense on Jerusalem during these Feast days. And their tents are set up everywhere, inside and outside, tailgating is going on everywhere. Of course, the central of the stadium is the Temple of God. And that's where it's all taking places where the game is played. Of course, you got to the Temple and the Holy of Holy is the closer you were with God, because that's where God dwells. It was just everything. And so that was taking place at this time. What's interesting to me is God waits for everyone to come to Him before He does this. There's the key issue to me, the wisdom of God. He could have just sent these disciples off and just started doing missionary work out in the bell. He waited for everyone to come in. And in one dynamic explosive moment reaches hundreds and thousands in a very condense period of time, using the Feast days.

Which, by the way, they all pointed to Jesus anyway, it made sense. If you understood the theology of their own Feast days, those were the shadow Jesus was the reality. And the point is that when they started hearing about Jesus, they realized that Jesus is the answer to all of this. All those sacrifices and all the things and commitment that they were doing. And then things about they're going to be told that they're going to be the Temple of the Holy Spirit, each body, each individual.

So now you've got mobile temples going everywhere as human beings. You don't have to travel to God. God travels to you. So well, so let's just kind of take a look at this. And so this is where we'll finish up today. But it's kind of, you know, take a little time to look in detail. Because this is one of those moments where you see the Spirit very active. In fact, it is the first text used to promote and supposedly support the charismatic tenants that we just looked at. And again, at first glance, it seems maybe it does. Well, let's ask those questions.

All right, chapter 2, verse 1, when the day of Pentecost came, it says they were all together. Now I remember you read just prior to this, the immediate antecedent to all is the apostles. But there is debate on whether it was 120 mentioned, the whole large group of the believers who were gathering during this period of time and the inner, after this sentient waiting for this moment, or if it was just a 12. You know, I didn't think it's just a 12 by context, but you know, it's not fatal either way. Now notice some very peculiar, unusual, democratic things take place. And they all have to do with the coming of the Spirit. Suddenly, a sound like the blowing of a violent wind came from heaven and filled the whole house where they were sitting. They saw what seemed to be tons of fire that separated and came to rest on each of

them.

And all of them were filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit enabled them. So let's stop there for just a few moments. Of course, you know, I'm not surprised that in this moment that by the way is a fulfillment of numerous Old Testament prophecies. Now again, you read that clinically and cerebrally to a Jew. This was their entire history has pointed to this moment. They have been told for hundreds of years that God is going to do something very unique and it's going to be a once in a lifetime agenda. And it's going to set the world on its ears. He is going to pour forth the Spirit upon all mankind.

Now remember that the Spirit has been involved and engaged in the Old Testament, Jewish nation, yes or no. Yes, of course it has. The Spirit of God has lit upon certain individuals, but you'll notice that the Spirit of God tended to be more associated with the corporality of the Jews, the nation of Israel. And it showed itself by specifically pinpointing and energizing, if you will, the leaders of the Jews, the prophets, the kings, the judges. But not every Jew received this promise, just selected people in leadership roles who represented Israel. Moses, for example.

Now here we're being told for the first time in God's vision of the world in this process of restoring the fall that took place in the Garden of Eden back in Genesis 1. The Kingdom of God is going to come in such a profound way that God is actually going to come in and dwell every believer. So it comes with an enormous splash, so it doesn't surprise me. Sounds amidings Russian wind, tongues of fire coming down, people beginning to speak in tongues. By the way, it's the first time we encounter what is one of other occasions where we encounter the idea of speaking in tongues. And we'll look at that more thoroughly as we go along this process.

Now let's stop and look at this for just a moment. Are they meeting any conditions, which was the second postlet given in terms of charismatic thesis supporting this, are we seeing them meeting any conditions before receiving the Spirit at this junction? What are they doing? Are they purifying themselves? Are they yielding their lives more fully? Were they told to go and swim or to God more fully? And when you guys get ready, God's going to swim in the Spirit. Were they told anything of this nature, this juncture? Jesus simply said, go to Jerusalem and wait till all they're doing is waiting. There are no conditions here and the Spirit's coming.

Second of all, I'd note that there are three manifestations of this moment, which I find interesting, the tongues of fire, the sound is a mighty rushing wind, which you know, everyone ever been through in the presence of a tornado. Sounds like a locomotive, I've never been in a horrendous hurricane and that's frightening enough. And so I've got an idea of them and it gets your attention. It's my point. It's not just a nice breeze going through with some sun shower, dropping around you and you can smell the rain. And then you get all of a sudden they are incited. This moment of being full of Spirit, they automatically start speaking, it says, in tongues. Now, why is it though that when you deal with the charismatic framework, why is only the speaking in tongues selected as being the identifying mark and the other three are basically set aside and ignored?

In other words, if Acts 2 sets the pattern of what we should expect for all believers, this is the baddest Holy Spirit for every believer, this is what you should experience. There's no expectation of the tongues of fire, there's no expectations of the sound of a mighty rushing wind. But there is the expectation that you, one, would speak in tongues. So I find that interesting as being part of the repeatable pattern, why the other two excluded. The third question is, what's speaking in tongues sought? In other words, they told, by the way, you're going to have to be filled with Spirit and by the way, the reason you're going to know your fill with the Spirit is because you're going to begin to speak in tongues.

So in tongues, when they even told this, nowhere is this mentioned, my point here, it was radically unexpected by them. This was not an expected part of some pattern or teaching, they had no idea this

was going to take place in their life. And then thirdly, or fourthly, I begin to look at the issue of the speaking in tongues itself. Now what do you find here actually takes place, picking up verse 5? Now there we're in Jerusalem, remember God framed Jews from every nation under the sun. You're about to see what in term, I kind of an unprecedented internationalism. If you think about it, it kind of reverses everything you saw, take place and babble.

Remember what happened to babble? Tell me the story, just in simple framework. How language comes in on this? This is kind of self-made, self-generated, man-made dream. And God intervenes, changes their languages, it just stops the work. So in that case, the multiplicity of languages divided everybody. And all of a sudden you're seeing the reverse of babble. Any way is the reverse of the ball, where you have a multiplicity of tongues and now it's drawing everyone back in. A very interesting moment, very profound moment in the history of God going back all the way to the beginning. And if you don't read those things into it, you're missing its point. And it goes on to give a list of people, it says, a crowd came together and noticed that what brought the crowd together? It tells you. Read the text, what does it say?

What actually drew the other people to start gathering around this geographical location there in Jerusalem? The noise of what? Yeah. Common sense. In other words, that noise wasn't just sequestered to just those were in that room. It was obviously something heard out and about. And it was so centrally located as its origin that it drew the people to it. God used that sound, and he was calling them. By the way, show up right here, right now. All of a sudden the people started gathering. And by this time you've got these 12 apostles, these 12 guys who, by the way, just a few days earlier, were sitting and hiding, shaking in their boots. And all of a sudden you got this embolded up front, speaking out, and what's interesting, they're speaking it says, speaking in tongues. Here, it seems clearly identified.

Utterly amazed, they asked women for that. When they heard this sound of crowd came together and bewildered them. Because each one heard them speaking in his own language. Utterly amazed, they asked, are these not men who are speaking Galilean? Now, just so you know, Galileans, just like we have in the United States, they just started geographical locations. If you go to the United States, we speak very differently. You know, you have kind of stereotypical, ascenutated things like the New York accent. And I grew up in Boston, and you heard me back when I was living up in Massachusetts. I was sick. In fact, when I first came to school here, they would always ask me to say certain words because I said them so foreignly to them. But you could tell where I was from, and they knew I wasn't from here when I came to school here.

And it was true between those who lived in Judea and those who lived in Galilean and other parts of the world. The dialect, the accent of Galileans was very acute. They were considered somewhat of the country bumpkins. It's not to unlike how some northerners view the stereotypical, sometimes seen on the news, southerners. Listen, they're front teeth, or they're John Deere cap and Dalton lock, they listen. That's what they were saying. This is exactly the response they were giving to the apostles when these guys are from Galilean. It was a mockery. They were making fun of them.

How is it that these uneducated men from Galilee, you know, from Podunk, Alabama are sitting up there speaking in all of the languages that we come from? Of course, you know, there was a universal language at this time because of Alexander the Great. Everyone spoke in terms of the internationally, the language was Greek. But there was also the specific dialects. In other words, most people in the first century world were multilingual. If you were a Jew, unless you lived right there, everyone spoke Hebrew, aromatic. You also spoke Greek, but you also spoke whatever dialects were where you lived in the world.

Remember the Jews were scattered all over the world at this time. And it tells you where they're from. Parthians, Mees, Elamites, first nine. Residents of Eस्पatemala, Judea, Capidosia, Parches, Asia, Frisia, Pimphilia, Egypt. Parts of Libya, near Cyrene, visitors from Rome. Cretans, Arabs, we hear them declaring the wonders of God in our own time. What's interesting is when you just follow all those places

all the way down South, that Africa, Egypt, all the way east of Jerusalem where all the Arabs live, all with Asia Minor, jumping over to Greece, jumping over to Rome, and beyond. This will be picked from all over the Mediterranean world. And they're all hearing them speak in specific languages. And so what I'm picturing here, it's kind of an interesting moment, where you've got these apostles kind of spread out, and they're speaking, I don't know if they're speaking one language, a piece, or if they're going through, over time speaking more than one language, but they're speaking in tongues, they're speaking languages that are known.

And so if I'm from Mesopotamia, and I happen to hear, this guy here, a jiver jabbering, I don't understand the language, I know it's a language, it may be French, German, you know, I'm just making up. But I don't speak French or German, I'm probably not going to gravitate him, but I'm going to gravitate to the person who I understand it. And so I'm seeing these clusters of people from these various parts of the world, find themselves standing in front of these apostles who are speaking their language, and they're sprinkled out in this area. Here in these apostles said, praising God in their own tongue, and they're bewildered by this.

So you know, actually take a few words to picture the scene. This is a phenomenal event. And it is unexplainable, and they did it. At least most of them do. So in verse 12, it says, amazed and perplexed, they asked the question that God wanted to ask. So what does this mean? Bingo! Good question, let me tell you. Although, verse 13, you'll notice that in the midst of those who are being drawn into the picture, you still find this rejection. It's met also with mockery. Some, however, made fun of them and said they have had too much wine. Oh, they're just a bunch of trunks. Interesting. That's kind of a predecessor to remind you that the message of Jesus will always meet, and we must always be ready to encounter rejection. I mean, if they can reject a moment like this, what are you and I going to encounter?

That's why Jesus makes all these problems to understand it's going to be tough. You'll always meet some level of rejection. Now, Peter then stands up, okay, now God's got your attention, and now you're asking the white question, let me explain this to you. And where does he go? Remember, speaking to Jews, if a Jew wants to reach a Jew about the message of God, where do you start? Read the text, where does he go? Give him a prophecy, and the prophecy comes from who? Joel, you guys even know who Joel is. He's a minor prophet. He's a major prophet, and you got 13 minor prophets. And by the way, all the prophets have spoken, well, not all of them, but most of them have spoken about this moment. They have all pointed for going back hundreds of years. Joel spoke probably in the ninth century BC.

Nine or years earlier, this prophecy comes from. And it's this. That which Joel spoke about, the God said he's going to pour forth his spirit upon all mankind. And then he knows he kind of delineates it. He kind of steps it down, says, he's talking both male and female get this. Rich and poor, slaves, wealthy, no distinction, and racial. By the way, he was speaking to Gentiles too, but now Peter didn't get this at this juncture. He'll get it later as part of that progressive revelation. And they figure out God's been telling them, and it's dawning on them as they go along. We'll get to that text when we get to Acts 10. The spirit has to force that issue really interesting, but that happens. The spirit makes them bridge this. But they're not ready for this yet. One step at a time, let's get the Jews in on the picture first.

And this one's been prophesied to you guys. God has been waiting to tell you this. This is that moment that you have been looking forward to anticipating your ancestors for hundreds of years have desired this moment, and you get to with us it right now. I mean, I'm telling you, it just went over your head. You didn't get it. How do I get you in a position where you can in some level appreciate this? Well, this is minuscule. I got to go to the National Championship game. I've been waiting for it all my years in Auburn. I kept hearing about 1957 they did this. I've never even come close experiencing this. And finally, we did it, and I got to go.

How many of you guys got to go that by the way? Well, was it a great moment for you? Was it an interesting moment for you? If you're really an Harvard football, it hits your passion. That was a major

moment in your life. Well, I feel almost silly. I suggest that as an example. Just amplify that 1,000 fold and put yourself in the Jews. Position at this moment. This is cosmic. And they're in on it. I witnessed this of the event. Now, after he tells them, this is that moment. And this is just like Joel said.

By the way, so does Zacchaeus, so does Isaiah, and so does the other prophets. He then kicks into the very reason of why they're there. And this is where I raised a question. What is the true emphasis of Pentecost? Is it all the miraculous dynamic events that the Spirit brought into the picture? Or is it the person of Jesus? Remember, I said that kind of metaphorical container that I created for you. And the statement is, the Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. The Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ.

How do I know the Spirit of God is active? I know He's active when He's pointing away from Himself to the person of Jesus. If that's taking place, I know the Spirit is doing something. Now, think of the opportunity that Peter could have had here. Guys, we just had this phenomenal experience. We were sitting in a room. We were just as a moderation went. Times is a fire lit on our heads. We had this great sensation. We started speaking in tongues. And by the way, you can have this experience too if you come to Jesus. That's what I expect to hear. If, indeed, that's what Luke is trying to teach us. But where Peter goes is this. He just, all of that was just a setup. Because, well, Joel said it's going to happen. That's why this is going on.

That will help create reason for this perplexity that you're carrying right now. So let's get into the real meaning of the issue. Let me tell you about Jesus. That's why God has you here. That's what the Spirit did all this for to get your attention so that you could hear this message. And if you just read your here for the first, think, guys, think for the first time in history to hear, it's never been heard anywhere on the face of the earth. The message of Jesus. And by the way, it's spoken to people who actually, many of them actually experienced Jesus in person and walked right by Him. They might have had questions about Him. They might have heard about Him through the great mind about this, you know, this rabbi who did some unique things. But, yeah, I haven't got killed.

Put aside. He was an insurrection troublemaker. Probably, you know, the Jewish leader did the right thing. Now, let's get settled down and get back to good Jewish living. I mean, this is where they're sitting. Some of these people actually witnessed the miracles of Jesus. Because they were from the regions of Galilee and Jerusalem, a Judea where Jesus traveled. Some of them might have been relatives. Some of those in that audience may have been those from Jesus actually performed miracles on. And we're a little bit further along in the learning curve at this moment. Others just heard about Jesus. Others were glad to have been able to forget about Him, thinking He was gone. And now, all of this is taking place. And what did they get? You thought He was gone? Let me tell you. He's back! They talk about the Jews of Nazareth who performed miracles.

By the way, some of you guys know this, He says. You are witnesses of these things. You know I'm sticking the truth. And guess what happened? You killed them. Put that in your, you know, kind of swallow that moment. Shoo over your heads. If you're one of these Jews. But God forgave us. That makes the event right. He just knew it was going to take place. And God, His way of taking the most atrocious, shameful events of history and turning it for our good. You meant it for evil, but God meant it to save your souls. Who would have ever figured this story out on their own? No one but God. This is not humanly engineered. I'm sorry. You just don't get those stories on our own. Coming in the back door like this. And you put them in a grave.

And three days later, He raised the dead. And by the way, we 12, along with some of these other people that are seeing in the background behind us here, we have seen Him ourselves. We are eyewitnesses of this event. And if that's not enough for you, let me take you back to our scriptures where it was said over and over and over again by the people whom you respect like David. It's predicted that Jesus would raise from the dead. The Messiah. It's happened. And that His conclusion is, no. Again, you've got to get in the moment. But all of this will be a short of this. God has made this Jesus, both Lord and Christ.

Master and Savior of your soul.

So when you really get the picture, and it's hard, and all of a sudden you hear the response, this is not a cerebral moment. This is not a clinical food. Well, what are we going to do now? This is a point of absolute panic and desperation. What are you doing? That's what they were saying. Does God just going to just eliminate all of us? Are we dead now? Is it revenge time? That's their question. Peter smiles. God giving you a second chance. In fact, not always giving you a second chance. You don't come in a stepchildren. He's going to give you the Spirit too. If you'll accept Jesus. You go from murder to a child of God in the blink of an eye.

How do you get there? Only God takes you there. At a moment like this. We missed this point. But again with our filter, Peter doesn't give a personal testimony. Rather, he says, Jesus, Jesus, Jesus. The focus of Pentecost is not the miraculous manifestations that the Holy Spirit brings into the moment. But the Spirit inspired message of Jesus. That's where it goes. That's the emphasis. And then the promise will be baptized. Every one of you in the name of Jesus for the forgiveness of your sins. And, second promise, you shall receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. The Spirit is now available to every single individual that comes to Jesus. Forgotten God. So, you know, if I get through this whole thing, the whole of salvation is received. Forgiveness and the Holy Spirit right in the beginning. And notice it's a gift of the Holy Spirit.

Any kind of condition set about this? No, it's a gift. You don't earn. You don't do anything to get the Spirit. It's a gift. Remember, end of the getting by faith in Jesus. We've already traveled that territory. And so, there you go. So, even if I look at this event, which, by the way, is used as a pattern for charismatic theology, I don't see that that's not what I'm seeing. Luke's suggesting here. What I'm seeing, Luke's suggesting is, Spirit, look at Jesus. Not Spirit. Let's have a great experience here. And notice the repeatable pattern is selective. Now, we are going to see speaking in tongues crop up. I'll be very interested in those moments. We're going to talk about that.

Why does that happen? The next event we'll look at, I want you to look ahead. It is this. We're going to look at the Acts chapter 8. By the way, I'm skipping the unique thing, which I wish I had time for that because that's pretty neat. But you'll notice that you don't see a specifically manifest mention of the Spirit activity at the moment. But when you get to the Samaritans, this is one of those texts that can get you to start from think. Well, it seems to me like you have a post-conversion experience, subsequent experience. And you also have the speaking in tongues that take place at this moment. So, it seems almost fit those three evidences that I suggested that are being suggested that's been taught by charismatic failure. So, I want you to actually read this text. Read that at the moment about the Samaritans conversion.

Notice the interactions. Notice who's showing up. Notice what they're saying. And remember, the folks is, look at what the Spirit is being said to do and not do and how it's doing it. And that's what we'll pick up next week. Let's pray and we're done.

Class 9: Samaria and the Gospel Across the First Barrier

Original transcript: hs09.txt

Summary: Acts 8 becomes Jim's first major test case for interpreting unusual Spirit events. He argues that the Samaritan episode is not a normal conversion pattern but a unique bridge over Jewish prejudice, publicly marking Samaritans as equal recipients.

Key Scripture References

- [Acts 1:8](#)
- [Acts 2](#)
- [Acts 6](#)
- [Acts 8:1-25](#)
- [2 Kings 17](#)
- [Daniel 1](#)
- [John 4](#)
- [Acts 10-11](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

The Samaritans believed Philip's message, were baptized, and later received the Spirit through Peter and John.

– [Acts 8:12-17](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Jews did not associate with Samaritans.

– [John 4:9](#). Version not stated in the audio; cited as background for Jewish-Samaritan hostility.

Cleaned Transcript

It's making a relief, okay, it's gone. I just want to listen to that for the next 30 minutes. Asked could they've made it miss a class, they can list to it. So for those class, you can get these things and list them if you need to. I won't go through all the details, but my point is if you missed some details last week, go back and just listen, get that crest and he'll tell you how to get to it and you can listen to it and I just want to kind of place it the whole thing.

Remember what I think defines the book of Acts and statement by Jesus before his ascension, one of these great commission statements. And you'll note that these took place after his resurrection, before his ascension, pretty significant moment in his life and I mean time is at hand, let's get on with it. And this is why these statements are being made. Now all this is taking place, let me tell you what's going to happen now. You guys, the church, are going to be the most tangible expression of the kingdom of God and I want you out there and I want you taking this message of my death, burial resurrection to the whole world. And Jesus says, but you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you. And you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem and in Judea and Samaria and to the ends of the earth.

And remember when Jesus spoke to statement, he was speaking to people who already knew Jesus as intimately as any one of the faith of the earth will ever know him. They have traveled with him, they have committed their life to him, they have heard all of his teachings, they have seen his miracles, they have experienced his death, burial, resurrection in acute ways. It says for 40 days that Jesus made appearances to these people very selectively to the apostles and to those who were the believers who stuck with Jesus through thick and thin of the crucifixion and were still around after it was over. He raised the dead, he

showed them to these people, just many convincing truths that he was a human being and a physical body, but it was a transformed unique global body. And so it's just an amazing moment.

But even though these people knew Jesus intimately, you notice that they were not yet prepared and ready from God's point of view to go out into the world this year of the gospel, they must first receive the Spirit of God. Because obviously that was an empowering from God himself to enable what God intends to church to do. Without the Spirit you cannot do this with the Spirit we can. So I kind of gave you a quick chronology of the book of Acts. I just want you to see a framework.

Remember I'm not dealing exhaustively with the book of Acts, I'm dealing selectively. I'm actually picking out specific texts that are used to suggest the charismatic thesis that we talked about that is suggested of what should be the repeatable pattern today. In other words, this is what those who claim the charismatic theology, they go to the book of Acts, say here are the texts that we use that suggest that one, there is indeed a conversion, there is an experience after conversion that you should expect. In other words, it's not enough to be saved by Jesus. You then have to at some time later a subsequent event you should expect to receive the baptism in the Holy Spirit. And you must pursue it. And when you have this experience then you will receive the Spirit in its fullness, that second work of grace as we termed it.

I already talked about some of this, then you deal with the issue of the conditions beyond conversion. Before that secondary event takes place in your life you must do certain things, yielding your life, praying for it, seeking it, more fully surrendering your life. In other words, you don't receive it on the front end because you're not ready yet. You're ready for it and you get your life prepared for this and do these things, then God will come upon you and you will receive the Holy Spirit at that time. And then notice the third part of the repeatable pattern that is suggested today is that how I know I've received the baptism in the Holy Spirit is that I will be able to speak in times and that it is expected as the visible, tangible evidence of having received the Holy Spirit.

Now, so basically I'm using that as kind of a filter because there's many other things we can talk about and I talked about some of that last week because it's sparse to all sorts of things in the book of Acts, but on the initial framework of looking at Acts these are the things that I want you to think through given the context of today. So last week we remember we dealt with the issue of Pentecost, very interesting as you have this church that's gathered and ready, but yet not yet fully prepared because they had not yet received the Holy Spirit. Jesus said, just go into Jerusalem and just hang out and it will happen. And they have Pentecost comes, boy you have the birth and the powering of the Spirit coming upon these people. And I mean from that second on the gospel's on the march, it just starts.

But notice in Jerusalem the nuclear, the nuclei of Jerusalem, Judea, Samaria, and into the ends of the earth. Now, and as I told you that was a preview by Jesus, so back to see what you're going to see taking into the book of Acts. So now we're still sitting right there and we're in Jerusalem. Now, most I also said there's a lot of things we're not dealing with, other conversion experiences, and that'll come into play and giving you the big picture as we move along here. Now, so there's the things for that and blah, blah. Now, now I would like for us to, as I gave you the email, do you all see the email I sent out last night? And I suggested that you read some of this. Some of you probably did, some of you probably leave the email before you read it and didn't know you're supposed to.

I also now have another email today saying, please bring your Bibles. Anyone not have a Bible or access to a Bible near them? The reason why I'm saying that is because I'm not going to be able to, I'm not showing all the text. So I really want you to see it because there are some meticulous things that we have to pay attention to in the text. So if you don't have a Bible or not sitting someone who has one, I'd get you one. Anyone need one.

Okay, we're okay. Okay, don't hesitate to let me know. I don't mind going to get one. I've got a few of

them in my office. All right. So go ahead and turn to Acts chapter 8 and we're going to be looking at some things there. So as I make references, you can actually read them with me. And I'm hoping that you're going to see that here is some of the text. You'll see why these are some of the supposed proof texts that supposedly reinforce the charismatic thesis that I showed earlier. Subsequent event, conditions beyond conversion, and tongues being expected as proof that this event is taking place in your life. And of course, you're sitting there saying, well, I've never spoken in tongues, so I guess that means you've not received this Holy Spirit in your life. And all those things we looked at earlier and answered the question, how do I receive the Holy Spirit earlier on this semester?

I seem to maybe are put in question here. And that's the reason why you look at these texts because to me, you can either just turn a blind eye to these things, or you can actually stop looking at them and think. And say, well, how am I going to process this? Now, when you come to the Samaritans, this is a very interesting thing. This starts in Acts chapter 8. Now, again, context, context, context. I do this for on purpose with you all. I take the time to get you to step back and see there's a context for these things because you want to do good interpretation, good exit Jesus' subscribers. Understand what it means. You've got to just do some of the most basic fundamental commonsense things, understand that there's a context that occasions all of these things. Now, what's interesting to me is you look at the history here.

First of all, here's Jesus' death. 50 days later, you have the events that we talked about last week on Pentecost. And now, notice what kind of jump we just took. What kind of jump we were taking from Pentecost and text we're looking at now. Six chapters later. How many years? Say it? Seven years. Thank you. Now, does that teach you anything, by the way, as you look through the book of Acts, do you ever stop to think that these things just happen? One day this happened. The next day this happened. The next day this happened. You have years spanning these events. Obviously, you look at the whole gamut of time. You're going all the way about 30, 33 years. You're seeing God working very methodically through human agency, patiently. And there's a lot of problems that fall in between every one of these things.

And not just a smooth, easy God says it's to be so, and it's just so. Inside the kingdom of God, there's all sorts of turmoil and friction and division. And there's internal problems and there's external persecutions. And all these things are being played out on this cursed world we live in. That's the kingdom of God that's representing the renewed and redeemed expectations of God. But the future will actually be like when God comes back and judges the world and He creates a new heaven and a new earth. And it's pristine and perfect status. We represent now the most tangible expression of what will be. But it's not perfect and it takes time to get these things to play out.

So I want you to see there is a time frame here and it's important to stop to think about how God works in life. And it's kind of a progressive revelation. Things kind of play out as they come along. And God reveals and He teaches and they learn a little bit more. And they take another step and God teaches and reveals and then they take another step. Now, what's actually happened here specifically if you read the very first verse of chapter 8 for a seven years the church has been sequestered where? Jerusalem basically. It's started there in Jerusalem and they are the immediate region of Judea. And you just have for seven fundamental years you've got this church that started with the handful of people the number we're given in the beginning of chapter 1 is 120 people. And if you'll notice between chapters 1 or chapters 2 and chapters 8, Luke who wrote the book of Acts takes time to give these kind of summary statements.

It's very important because I note them in my Bible. I have a little S. Bible and I've got them highlighted in pink because Luke is saying the church grew this much and the church grew this much and the church grew this much. Sometimes he says, gives him a figure. He says the church reached 5,000 men at this time. And then the church continued to grow and have favor of all the people and even priests were becoming Christians, you know, Jewish priests. And so he gives these kind of step backs, see the big

picture, give me a give you a summation with all these things happening.

Notice people are being reached, people are being reached, people are being reached, the church is getting bigger and bigger and bigger and bigger. And now it's sitting in Jerusalem if you own Judea and you're ready to explode. It's like a water balloon that's getting too much water in it. But it's also while the church is growing what's also taking place in Jerusalem. There's a lot of people don't like the church. The Jews are the members of the Orthodox Jews who were objecting Jesus to Messiah who refused the message are sitting their butting heads with these Christians who won't shut up. They will not shut up talking about God. They have been warned. They have been beaten. They have been imprisoned saying you stop talking about this Jesus. We can't stop telling us he's alive. They said, well, we can't help it. We cannot help but speak what we have seen and heard.

We have seen Jesus after his death. We've touched him. We've eaten with him. We've seen the the spear marks, the nail marks. We know Jesus and we saw him send him to heaven. And what choice do we have? He said go tell people about me. So we're going to do it. The goddess of what you suggest to us and the threat you give us and how you try to intimidate us. So they're doing this and so you know the friction is building, building, building. Finally it just all breaks loose. In the first verse of chapter 8, Stephen was just martyred, stoned to death for talking about Jesus. The real serious now. It's gone from imprisonments warnings to imprisonments to beatings to death. Now we have our first martyr. And it says that all the Christians, except for the apostles, scattered.

And what's interesting is that everywhere those Christians went, guess what they did. They preached the word everywhere they went. Just common Christians doing blue collar jobs, farming, and carpentry, and you know. And they got kicked out of Jerusalem, chased out of Judea. And they start talking to people about Jesus because that's what they've been doing all along anyway. You know, before we go on all these little short-term mission trips, it'd be nice if we did hear what we say we want to do there. That's what they did when they were doing it out there. When they got sent, if you will, find oversight water, it doesn't make you a missionary. But these guys are a missionary before they left. That's what made a missionary when they went out. And they were talking to people about Jesus. So they just did what came naturally to them. They just kept doing it.

Now, here, Luke, you know, these people by the thousands have just gone everywhere, north, south, east, and west, and everything in between. I remember they're on the run. Now, they're losing their homes and everything else and their livelihoods and some were going back home, by the way. I remember they're the ones that came all over the Mediterranean world on Pentecost. Some of them never left. They just stayed around to learn more about Jesus. Some of them are now heading back home with the message in this interesting how God works us all out. It's just all fascinating to make me think about it.

So now, when you enter chapter 8 and all this scattering, all of a sudden Luke says, and one of the one among the thousands that scattered is a goblet animal, Philip. And Philip went to the region of Samaria. And so we arrive here at this text. Now, anyone by the way, this is for free, but we're introduced to Philip earlier. Do you remember when we're first introduced to him? Two chapters earlier. We were introduced to this guy. He's one of the guys that was selected to help with the internal problems within the church there in Jerusalem, of feeding the Grecian widows. They picked out some men and said, look, we need to orchestrate this thing because everyone's at odds with each other and the Jewish widows are being favored over the Greek widows and from other places. So, you know, you see some rather petty things going on, but rather significant is people weren't getting food who needed it.

And so they took some men who were just as full of the Holy Spirit and mature people and said, look, will you help us work this through so this stuff being a problem so we can get on doing the kingdom work. And so that's the first piece of Philip. So, Philip just was delivering food bags for this in orchestrating it. But when he goes out, he's called an evangelist. And he ends up in a region known as Samaria. Now, I will tell you that this is a primary text used to support the Doctor of Subsequence. And I'll show you why.

Now, you'll note that verse starting in verse 9, you're introducing this guy Simon the Sorcerer who lives in this region of Samaria. And he's not our primary concern, although that's a very interesting thing, he's a magician. And when he saw the real thing taking place, and as Philip is performing miracles, he wants in on this, which is really interesting.

If what he was doing was real, why when he saw the real thing coming out of Philip, he goes, man, I want that. And it tells me how he hears the message of Philip, Philip's preaching the message, he says, he converts. I pick up in verse 13, Simon himself believed him was baptized, and he followed Philip everywhere, astonished by the great signs of miracles he saw. Verse 14, when the apostles in Jerusalem heard, I skipped the verse, verse 12. But when they, that is the Samaritans in general, not just Simon, when they believed Philip as he preached a good news of the kingdom of God, and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized both men and women.

So you have this conversion process, they hear the message of Jesus, and Luke says, and they're all baptized. Then, verse 14, when the apostles in Jerusalem heard that Samaria had accepted the Lord of God, knows what happens. They send Peter and John to them. When Peter and John arrived, they prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit. Question mark. Because the Holy Spirit had not yet come upon any of them. They had simply been baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. Then, Peter and John placed their hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit. Now, remember the filter. Is there subsequent event here? Does it look like there's a subsequent event after conversion?

What commit yourselves? How many of you say yes there is? How many of you say no there isn't? The subsequent event. Here they are receiving the Spirit after their conversion to Jesus, sometime later. The last question again. It looks in this text. It says they had been baptized, later on, John and Peter show up, lay hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit. Does that look like a subsequent event to you? Shake your heads. Yes, that's a subsequent event. It's something that takes place after the fact. Now, remember what we would have already talked to you about when did we receive the Holy Spirit? We looked at multiple of Paul's letters, the words of Jesus himself. I very strongly suggest to you was in the beginning that it's hearing them at when they first heard the message of Jesus by faith that faith is in Jesus Christ, at baptism, and the bigger picture of you is the new birth.

I used Titus 2 for that of you remember. It seemed to be a very consistent picture, but here it says that they had been baptized, but did they receive the Spirit? They have to wait for apostles to show up, lay hands on them, and then they received the Holy Spirit. So, does that create cognitive dissonance in you? If you've been following along, understand the framework it should say, yeah, it doesn't seem to make sense. It seems contrary to what we've already been taught. Remember the second condition? Are there conditions to be met before? Were they told anything to do before they received the Holy Spirit? Is there anything to suggest? Luke is writing this out and he's taking advantage of this moment to give you this history here. By the way, here's Peter and John showing up, did they teach them?

By the way, you guys need to be doing some things that you're not doing before this happens to you. Do you find any of that in this text? You guys should be praying more, you should be yielding your life more, you should be more fully surrendered, and when you're ready this will happen. Nothing of that nature is suggested, which would have been a primary moment for Luke, if this is the point he's trying to make in the book of Acts, this is for people to pattern that you should be taught that. But, anyway, that's obviously not Luke's concern. Now, the third thing is speaking in tongues. Do they speak in tongues? Does it indicate? But I think they did, and I'll tell you why here in a few minutes.

Okay, now let's look at this passage that is suggested here. My point is you can see why this is a go-to passage that Kirk McTeeces does fit this. Then what I've talked to you in the whole front end of this, a good portion of what I've talked to you in the front end of this series of classes is wrong. And if I'm wrong, I want to know I'm wrong, and I want to do what I want to get to the point here. So I've got to ask some hard questions. Why is it that this seems out of sync in terms of the spirits coming? It would

seem to me that the spirits should have already come, because they've already been baptized in the name of Jesus Christ, that's what I've talked about. That's what I've suggested to you. So, what are we going to do with this? Well, let me kind of walk you through, and let's see if we can make some sense out of this.

First of all, it's kind of focused on the idea of despised Samaritans. Now, you understand what I'm getting at when I suggest the Samaritans were despised. This is just interesting or boring, maybe to you, a history, this actually defines this text to me. Does anyone know anything about Samaritans in other words? Does anyone remember that the Jews hated the Samaritans? By the way, just so you know, you had basically three regions of Jewish territory in Palestine, Judea, Samaria, Galilee. Now, where did Jesus carry on most of his ministry? Did we read the Gospels? If matters, by the way, you should know this up here. He did make some frequent trips for the feast days and go back and forth, but by the way, when the Jews traveled on the feast days or whatever reasons to do business, and if you lived in Galilee, you had Judea, how did they travel to Judea?

Yeah, for some reason, it seems to me, I mean, just common sense you go as the crow flies, just go down and go. But they would purposely go over here and the other side of the Jordan River, come all the way down and then come in this way. Why? We have it, why? It's stupid. Hey, let's go to Atlanta, and so I'm going to send you to Mississippi first to get there, to make any sense whatsoever. So obviously there's a reason for this, why? This is important, huh? I'm sorry, I'm deaf. Well, I mean, they might have done that. Remember, they're in caravans traveling in large groups as Jews. My point is, they're trying to avoid Samaria. Why are they avoiding Samaria? Yeah, okay, you're getting war. It wasn't run off, there was a reason it was run off. Basically, they were run off by the Jews, and weren't allowed to go to Jerusalem.

It wasn't really their desire, it was the people who lived in Galilee and Judea's desire, not to have the marriages around, so they basically formed their own church, they built their own church building and they formed their own worship. Separate in the park from what was going on in Jerusalem, but they were Jews kind of, I say they were kind of Jews, why do I say that? Half-breeds, okay? Let me just tell you quickly, we'll move on. I'm just trying to essentially get you to think about it because it's really matters to understand the stecks to make. Samaritans, back in the Old Testament, yes, it goes back into the kingdom, split. If you remember what was really the problem back then is that the Jews kept doing what God kept telling them not to do.

What was that? They kept worshipping idols from other nations. By the way, the reason they kept worshipping those were nations because they were traveling through other people's territory, they kept worrying about all these new guys, and they said, well, we kind of liked kind of Abraham, I couldn't take them, but you know we might be missing something. There's all these other guys, these other people of worshipping, so there's all these kind of minor guys, so it turns into a polytheistic world for these Jews. Although they believed in the one guy who was the Lord God, God is one and you should worship the Lord your God while your heart, mind, soul, strength. Yes, that's right, they quoted every time they worshiped, every time they walked into the synagogue, they started their worship there with that quote, and they ended with that.

They understood it, yes, I get it. But they said, but in my back at home, I also got these little figurines because there's some God that specializes in some things that I might need. There's this God of healing that comes from over here in one area of Palestine, this God of getting wealthy over here, and so if I need certain specializations, I need to start worshiping that God so I can get His favor so that I can get the things that I need specifically in my life. And so this monotheism became a kind of a subtle polytheism, and God says, you're like people who've been married to me and you're going off and you're committing spiritual adultery. You keep on marrying all these other gods too, and I'm sorry, it's just not just going to kill you, so it kills me to see you do it, and it's unacceptable.

And so it got so rampant at times, God says, I don't know what else to do, I've seen all these prophets too, they keep telling you, don't do this, don't do this. Thus says the Lord God, God wants your false idols, and here's all the reasons why, it's going to kill you. Oh, I want to give you some wonderful things and you guys won't put your hands to me, let me fill them up. You're running all these other gods, thinking they're going to fill your hands up. There's the breakdown.

So finally, God says, I don't know how to get your attention, I'm going to have to bring in other nations, four nations come in and spank you. So in 722 BC, since then the Assyrians, and they come in and take over part of the Jewish nation, not all of them, part of them. This is the body kingdom, I think it's one of the northern kingdom went. No, southern kingdom is one Jerusalem went. Then in 586 BC, it comes to Babylonians. And the Babylonians, that's when Daniel, Shadrach, me, Shadrach, and the bed, and they go to those people. Got Waylaid and Jeremiah's the prophet when all this was taking place. He's been warning the people, look, they're coming, they're coming, they're coming. You guys don't get rid of these idols and just worship God and love him because he loves you.

These guys are coming, they're going to spank you. Well, they just turned to blind eye and harden their hearts and didn't change their lives. So in comes the Babylonians. Now, when a nation would take over another nation, they would do two things. Very simple. If I were to, if I were from one territory, and I came in and took over and said, you guys represent a nation, I came over, took over your territory. Now, I own your territory. What am I going to do with some of you? Well, you guys are intelligent, very gifted, talented individuals.

So I'm going to deport you from where you live. I'm going to take you back to my home country and let you serve me. So they pick up all these Jews selectively. And I said, amongst them in this particular deportation, it was Daniel Shadrach, me Shadrach, and the bed to go. These are the guys that were brilliant, have good artisanship, have some gifts and tools that they can bring back to Babylon and make Babylon a better place. And you can become our slaves. So I'm going to pull thousands of you out, but guess what? I'm going to import back in. Some of my Babylonians, buddies who can now come in and live in this land. And take it over and possess it.

So now, over in this area of Samaria, I've got a remnant of Jews left over. Not all of them were taken, just some of them. And I've got all this influx of new foreign Babylonians living there. And over time, what's going to happen between those two people? They're going to start meeting and becoming good friends and neighbors and sharing gods and lives and getting married to one another. Now, I've got all these mixed marriages going on. Now, remember God says, I don't want you to do this. He says, you'll be separate. He says to Lord God, it was his idea. I didn't make it up. He just said, do this, because I don't want you to fall into the God issues. And so now you've got this territory right here, where a peer is Galilee and Judea. They maintained their purity of Jewish heritage.

Their pedigree was very important, remember. It was always important to a Jew. But what happens to me when I enter Mary? I lose that clean, pristine pedigree of lineage, of being Jewish. Now you've got a bunch of mixed breeds. You've got Jews married to Gentiles, having children over multiple generations. And so you've got a Mongol nation here. Now remember, this is all a matter of prejudice. But these people who are maintaining the law of God, these people who are maintaining the law of God, are now looking at these people's sandwich in between them and saying, you guys have compromised historically. You're no longer Jews. We do not accept you as Jews. You're now to be treated as outsiders. And so there were overtures made from these people wanting to worship in Jerusalem, but they weren't allowed to. And so you find events like when Jesus was alive and he did something very peculiar, rather than going out here and traveling on the outskirts and going around with Mary, he talked about how he went right through there.

And in John chapter 4, who does he run into? In Samaria, the woman at the well. And do you remember the first thing that woman said when Jesus started talking to her? Because obviously Jesus was a Jew.

It was obviously Jesus Samaritan. And her first question is what? I'm seeing, okay, say again. Right in the world. Yeah, look. I'm a woman, first of all, and on the Samaritan. And you're also being supposed to be talking to me. You know, just the beauty of Jesus breaking barriers, where the social moray said, stay away. Jesus is forcing the issue. And of course, driving the disciples nuts. Because they're frightened to death. You know, Jesus has broken all these rules and laws and rewriting everything. And we don't know what to do with him. So, yeah, that event happening.

Then you have, when Jesus was being accused, one of the worst things he was accused of was what? What did they call him? A Samaritan. Aren't we correct in saying that you are possessed by devils? Notice what it comes to this. And that you're a Samaritan? That was a pretty ugly, nasty thing to call a person if you were a Jew. And I mean, I can't quite exaggerate the enmity, the anger, the bitterness, the historical prejudice. It would reflect what it looked like in America back in the 30s and 40s between black churches and white churches. So, you know, it's not too hard for us to figure out how that could happen within human beings. But this one had a much longer history. It was much more entrenched because it went back hundreds and hundreds and hundreds of years. Now, so here is the first time in recorded history where someone other than a pure Jew is going to be privileged as God designed to receive the message of Jesus Christ.

So, how is God going to get this issue resolved? If I'm a Jewish Christian, do I think this is okay? I'm battling centuries of barriers and prejudice. Now, you say, well, what was Philip doing there? Well, I think Philip got it. The message of Jesus for everybody. But there was still a question. Are these Samaritans? Can they be equals with us? Okay, God may receive them in as maybe red-headed, stepchildren. Get the idea? Okay, we'll let you in the kingdom, but you know, you're kind of secondary citizens. You're the plebians in our midst. And we're going to treat you like this.

How is God going to help them overcome all of these massive barriers? Now, you'll notice in the text, it brings out the issue. And we're going to pick up now in verse 14. Again, when the apostles in Jerusalem heard that Samaria had accepted the Word of God, they sent Peter and John to them. Now, if you go back, oh, yeah. Verse 15, when they arrived, they prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit. Now, of course, everything I've suggested to you is they should already have received the Holy Spirit. They've already heard the message of Jesus. They responded in faith. They've been baptized into Christ. And so this should already be an established agenda in each of their lives, but apparently it's not. Now, that word not yet, you should underline because it's not just a bridging word.

It actually suggests something to you in the actual Greek language. It means something that should have happened, but has not yet happened. Understand the implications of that. As Luke is writing this, he's acknowledging this should have already taken place. This is an abnormality. This is not what we would expect. Why is it, question mark, that they haven't received the Spirit yet? Clearly, the intent that Luke and why he writes it, they have not yet gotten it. Who can figure this one out? Because that's not in Luke's mind what was normal. So, notice what happens. I'm trying to answer the question. Now, can the despise Americans be admitted as equals and receive the Holy Spirit too? And this critical question was raised. And if the gospel was going to spread, it's calling upon God to give a very special answer to this.

And I think if you pay attention to this, this is rather unique. Notice, first of all, who they sent, not just anybody. Who shows up to resolve this issue? Who sent by the church in Jerusalem to resolve this issue? The top guys. I mean, not any top guy, but the top of the 12 apostles. Peter and John are sent. That should get your notice, first of all. How many times have you seen Peter and John being noted, being sent places for a special purpose to take care of something? Not often, but in this one they are. Again, I keep finding myself saying, why? Why? Why? Why? Why? What's going on in this event?

Why is this not taking place the way I would anticipate, not the way Luke anticipated, not yet? So, the two most noticeable apostles come and says, lay hands on them. And the Samaritan receive the Holy

Spirit. Now, your scholars will make note of this that there are two ways of looking at that phrase, receive Holy Spirit. Simply that, a literal reading that they had not yet actually received the indwelling Holy Spirit that was promised. The other is that they had not yet received the outward manifestations of the Holy Spirit that were anticipated. Now, obviously, I think there were clear outward manifestations in this event. When the apostles laid their hands on them, how did they know?

How did the people know? How did the apostles know that they had received the Holy Spirit? Very important to this text. It's in there. After these people had received the Holy Spirit. Okay. Notice what it says in verse 18, when Simon saw that the Spirit was given at the laying on of the apostles' hands. He offered them money saying, hey, I want this ability. So, when I lay hands on, I can be noted as being clear. Remember, this is the guy that's been enamored and has been pursuing celebrity status before all of this. When he converted to Jesus, he still hadn't shed his vestige of pursuing self-aggrandizement. And so, now he wants the paid to be able to carry on the work of an apostle. And, of course, you get Peter's response to all this. But, Mike, what catch me is that he says, Simon saw.

Now, does Luke take the time here to describe to you what gifts, what outward manifestations that were seen? No. That's a spirit speaking in the class. He doesn't. But, it's very clear that there was some outward manifestation referenced here. And, Simon saw it. I think likely, I think it was speaking in tongues, although I cannot. It doesn't actually state that into there. But, I'm not exactly importing it into the text. I'm looking at the grander view of the book of action. You can find on certain occasions that speaking in tongues came up when people needed to be convinced of things. We're going to see that here in our next text that we're about to look at. And, what we're going to least open it up to. This is taking me longer to get through than I anticipated. I kind of think you guys would be real ahead of this thing.

And, maybe I'm just going too slow for you. I don't know. Now, doesn't it strike you that, again, subsequent event, conditions beyond conversion that must be met before this will happen in your life. And, speaking in tongues is expected as part of the repeatable pattern. If that is true, first of all, did I see a subsequent event? Well, it's definitely a subsequent event. Is it a condition beyond conversion? Nothing was said by Peter and John. They didn't come in and said, okay, guys, we want to keep the Holy Spirit. You guys got to get your lives ready and do this, this, this, and this. And, nothing was suggested. You just want to be walked up to them, lay their hands on them, and it says, boom, they received the Holy Spirit. So, if that's what Luke is trying to teach, he just for, for went, a very clear opportunity to make that point.

Now, second of all, third of all, if speaking in tongues was to be expected, first of all, is there anything taught where the pulse is? By the way, when we lay hands on you, the Holy Spirit, by the way, we want you to know you, you will know you've received it if you speak in tongues. None of that is suggested here. So, Luke is not teaching that at all. Luke's concern is to question the status of Samaritans and the Kingdom of God. Will God receive even the despised Samaritans and the Kingdom? Now, does God know the answer to this question? Yes. Who doesn't know the answer to this question? The Jews. Why is God doing all of this? To convince the Jewish Christians who are sitting here saying, nope, not acceptable. They've already received Jesus. They're already believers. But God is now moving them outside their comfort zone.

And God's saying, these people are on equal status with you. They all are one in Christ. And they're having to learn this progressive revelation as God is dragging them. No, it's not the Samaritans in the Kingdom. But the Jews tore the Samaritans and saying, you've got to receive them into the Kingdom. So, the Spirit of God is very active in breaking through prejudice in this moment. So, the ultimate question when I stand back from this is, okay, I see why people use this text to suggest, you know, okay? All you need yet to receive the baptism of Holy Spirit by the laying on of hands, evidence by speaking in tongues, by using this text. But when I say, I really take a close look at it, it doesn't, first of all, meet

those qualifications. But the bigger issue to me is what looks real point here.

Is this a normal, everyday conversion experience that I should expect to be repeated a thousand times over? Or is this a rather unique, crucial juncture in the spread of the gospel going from this case Jews to the first time is going outside of that, that pedigree issue and receiving those outside the Jewish framework of Christianity into and received as equals? That clearly is Luke's point. Now, I was telling Christa and Derek downstairs about it, we were talking about this, and I was just seeing what they got from reading these things. And I said, you also realize that in those, in all those years that take place right here, in all of these years, you've got hundreds and thousands of conversions taking place. Doesn't it strike you that of all the thousands, literally thousands of conversions that are taking place? The reference by Luke as you go through up to this point in chapter 8.

Why he chooses this one to talk about? Why does he forego, talk about all the other hundreds and thousands of conversions? He says, but this one, I want you to take particularly close attention to, because obviously there's something unique historically taking place that in some ways is unrepeatable. This is not a normal event, this is a very abnormal, specific historical event. So, should I expect something that is unique historically to define what is the normal pattern of Christianity for all of us? Should I expect someone, an apostle, to come and show up in my doorstep, lay hands on me so I can receive Holy Spirit and evidence of speaking in tongues. So, you see the idea here, basically God is putting a stamp approval on these people. He answers the question, he raised the question, are the Samaritans acceptable and God's answer is yes!

And you'll note, from this point on, you'll never find this happening to another Samaritan. There are other Samaritans becoming Christians? Hundreds of them. But on this occasion, you have all these unusual events taking place, orchestrating, make it happen. Get the idea. But when I have time to launch this all the way, we'll pick up next week with the Gentiles. Now, if you understand the specifics of what took place when you actually look at the text in Acts chapter 8 of Samaritans, I think you'll find that there are some great similarities and parallels when you get into Acts chapter 10.

What is unique about what takes place in Acts chapter 10? It's the first time something happens. The first time, the gospel message is now moving beyond Jewish roots and is reaching in some ways of pagan. I think I'm going to call him a non-believer because he has some unique traffics to him. He's called a God fear. He's a centurion, he's a Greek, he's a Roman soldier, and he's stationed just as an accessory in Caesarea. That tells you certain things about him. There's also a lot of bizarre events to take place. Now, if God's willing to go to some extra lengths of manifesting certain very peculiar things to get the attention of the Jews about being going to accept their next-door neighbors, the Samaritans. Can you imagine the gulf that exists between the Jewish church and the mixed-breed Jewish church now to just a rank Gentile?

Remember what the temple looked like? It was broken up in certain areas and in the outside area, the farthest place that the closest that a Gentile could go to the temple was what, into the court of Gentiles. They were kind of loud in, but they were only allowed at a great distance. They were not allowed into the focal point. Of course, women were then filtered out before you got really close, close enough. There were all sorts of little barriers set up as you got close to God, fewer and fewer people could access it. To finally, only one person, the high priest, could go and meet God, and it's going to be the Holy Holies. You should see the picture is being painted when you're going through the gospel and God's breaking down every one of those barriers going through. But how is God, how are the Jewish Christians now going to react when a Gentile basically says, I'd like to become a Christian?

How is God going to bridge these two people together? Now I understand this text and act of text rate, I would anticipate, expect some very unusual abnormal events, not normal events, not repeatable events, but very unusual events to take place. If my premise is right. Now I think it's very important that you want to grasp the book of Acts and deal with all these issues about the spirit on the most elementary

level, but overall I want you to see this as you're reading. I want you to read chapter 10-11 for next week and be a little bit more cognizant of this text than you guys were this week and to understand where we're going to walk with this, if we can do it quicker. I'd like to get through Acts chapter 19 and perhaps even just complete Acts and move on.

I want you to think and see the picture of how far God is willing to go, how far He's willing to orchestrate to reach a single person. And if God is that willing to do that, He's that passionate, His Spirit, that directed, His Spirit is the Spirit of missions, if the Spirit of God actually indwells us, what would it look like in our life and our willingness? I want to look at those people the first century who received the Holy Spirit and were empowered to be His witnesses.

How empowered is your personal life in bringing the good news of Jesus to others? And how willing, if God is trying to get all this done and say, go, go, go, go, go, and I'll do this, this, this, this, this, this, this, verse to hang up or has God retired which is only in the first century when the Spirit of God was active. And so yet there might be some unusual events that I don't see as repeatable, but again, what I hope you're seeing underlying all this, the real picture, the fundamental picture of Acts is that the Spirit of God is still actively doing things today. You're just seeing it manifest in some, in some times, peculiar ways and unexpected ways and abnormal ways from time to time, getting its job done, but no big picture. It's still getting its job done.

The message is going from here to here and the Spirit of God is involved in this every step of the way. So as God involved in our lives trying to get the message of the people, there's where really why I want you to go. We look, look, look at that. So reach after 10-11 and then you will take a leap from there, notice, no, 13 years later, where we find the next conversion experience where the Spirit is specifically mentioned by Luke as actively engaged in this process and that one is very interesting. Paul gives you a theology lesson on the Holy Spirit in Acts 19, because it's very important.

Okay? Got it? Let's pray. We're done. Father, we are so thankful. We are thankful for your activity in our life. We are thankful that you and dwell us. We're thankful to be invited.

Class 10: Cornelius and the Gentile Breakthrough

Original transcript: `hs10.txt`

Summary: The Cornelius account in Acts 10-11 is treated as another decisive bridge. God uses visions, Peter's reluctant obedience, the Spirit's visible coming, and the church's response to show that Gentiles are received without becoming Jews.

Key Scripture References

- [Acts 10:1-48](#)
- [Acts 11:1-18](#)
- [Leviticus 20:25-26](#)
- [Mark 7:18-19](#)
- [Acts 2](#)
- [Acts 19:1-7](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

Peter realizes that God does not show favoritism but accepts people from every nation.

– [Acts 10:34-35](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Peter compares the Spirit's coming on Cornelius's household to the beginning at Pentecost.

– [Acts 11:15-18](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Cleaned Transcript

All the effects that Satan has put on the planet of the earth and all the people and reversing the curse. And there's a war going on here. And it is through the empowerment of the spirit that we can take on that battle. And that's what you should be seeing here. Now, first Gentiles, again, anyway, I know to help you understand this, and when we get to the end, you see the spirit coming in in the unique event that we really want to focus on. But I've got to take the time to give you the focus of the context.

Okay, now, if I were to title this thing, I would call this like the movie that I've seen a thousand times over because I have two daughters called Pride and Prejudice. I guess I would subtitle it, God working outside the bubble. Because we're going to see here that God is very manifestly forcing an issue. He is very demonstrative in taking the initiation in an irrefutable ways and very visible ways to force something to happen. Again, I've already begun to say this is not a normal event.

How is God going to bridge the Jewish Christians who are now, you know, been large-hearted and received in the Samaritan mixed-breed Jewish culture into the kingdom of God? Now how are they going to bridge this to the Gentiles? Well, this is basically, that's, I think, the story and why Luke picked this particular conversion experience that took place up in Caesarea. We start right there, it was a port city, just so you know, it was named after Caesar Augustus. It was the largest, most important Roman city in Palestine. And for that very reason, it was one of the most hated pieces of landscape in Palestine by the Jews.

What I find interesting is this is where God chose to tap someone on the shoulder who was a non-Christian, you want to talk about it outside the Christian bubble and you couldn't have gotten farther and makes this happen. So if you got your Bible, I told you to bring them, I hope you're sitting next to them if you don't have your own. If you want to go back more obviously, I'd be glad I got a few of them back there, turn back chapter 10, let's walk this very quickly and let's see if I can get you to do. Your first of all, you're introduced to a person there in Caesarea. His name is Cornelius.

Now what do you know about Cornelius, just real quickly? Okay, it's a Roman centurion and so this guy is a Greek, now what is the normal religious framework of a Roman centurion across the globe here, a polytheism, okay, they believe in a multiplicity of all the mythology of Greek mythology, that's their view of God. Now this guy's different though because he's called a God fear, now tell me what a God, this is very important, what is a God fear? What differentiates him from being a typical, which would define that the normal everyday buddy for Cornelius, they're probably in Caesarea, but he's very, very unique and very, very, he's in a very small gathering of people, uniquely identified as God fears. God fears were, okay, they believe in one God who's God, there's all sorts of God, which one they're choosing, Poseidon, Asclepius, Aphrodite, the God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, they believe in the one God of the Jews, Lord your God is one and he believes it too.

They've converted in terms of their theism, they've converted to Judaism, but there was a difference between a God fear and actual Gentile convert, Gentile convert, actually if you were a male you went through the circumcision, which probably kept a lot of them from doing it, they just stayed God fears and they began to worship the one God, they would go to the synagogue, they were respected by the Jews in that area where they went, they were even allowed to go to Jerusalem, remember there was even a place for them there in the temple area called the court of Gentile, they couldn't go farther than that, but they could go into the outer way so they could be kind of close to God. And so you have a God fear, whereas the converts actually, not only were they circumcised, they went through a proselyte baptism, they actually took them, I find very interesting, and they would immerse them in water, and it showed their entry into becoming full-fledged Jews, so they were Gentiles who had converted thoroughly to Judaism, but this guy is a guy who hasn't been through proselyte, he's a God fear, a unique group of people who believed and they already believed in the one God, so God tapping his shoulder if someone who's already taken a very significant step, but he's still a Gentile and he's still not a believer in Jesus.

Okay, now he goes on and says some things about him, he says this guy was really giving, this guy had a real heart for the poor, this guy prayed all the time, and so this is the guy that God chose, obviously you already see some sense of character and spirituality about this guy. Now here's where the unique things happen, obviously God demonstratively initiates and steps in and taps him on the shoulder in very significant ways, giving him a vision, and what's the vision, come with the vision of it, starts around inside chapter 3 and chapter 3 and the angel shows up and says what, okay, there's this guy, Peter down and Joppa, which we're going to look at in just a moment, and he's got some things that we want you to connect with him.

Now that alone since you've caused a pause, now how many times you see in the history of God where he ascends an angel or gives people visions, I mean you look at the experience all the way into the new testament, it's a very rare moment, this does not happen all the time. Again, why is Luke picking this event up because some very unusual, significant things are taking place at this moment. So God is tapping Cornelius on the shoulder, he says I want you to go down the Joppa, so what is he, he picks three guys, he picks two servants which were probably Jews and he says he picks one of his sub commanders and he sends them down on what is the two, about a two day journey, it was around 32 miles down to Joppa, okay.

So these guys are on the way, now why these guys are on the way, everything God's playing the double agent. It's about lunchtime, it says, Peter is hungry, this is scene two, and he goes up the roof to pray, which I always find interesting, you know, he's emphasized the prayer of Cornelius and God changes his life in that context, and here's Peter praying and he's about to significantly come into Peter's life during the time of prayer and change things. It might point there just to pragmatics, it really is more important, maybe the history here is, you know, I think that if we really think about it, God uses those moments of prayer to really do some rather significant things in leading us if we're open. And it's not a coincidence that we find it's a moment of prayer when God steps in because the person is already open to God.

You have to break in while their mind is traveling elsewhere, their mind is already there with God. Well, now you're listening, let's take you someplace. So what does he do with Peter? He does also some rather significant God intervening supernatural, intervening moments. He gives, as he gave a vision to Cornelius, on the other hand, these guys are traveling down, they're about a day away, and he now gives him a vision, what's the vision? Very significant. It's a vision of... Second? Okay, he's got a drop of blanket down, the bunch of unclean animals, and he goes, hey, Peter, kill and eat, it's supper time, you're hungry, so go at it, this is for you.

Now what's Peter thinking? Why is he saying no? Who says? Who says? Who says? Who says? Who says? Who says? Where? Jewish law. Huh? Jewish law. Jewish law. Go to the Leviticus 20, for example. Jewish law. Jewish law. Jewish law. By the way, do you ever stop to think why in the world did God set that emotion? Well, there's more than one reason, but this is very significant understanding of the story. If all you see is the Jewish dietary laws that God has gave them signed, warped, you know, etiquette, or some sort of a usual culinary interest, that's not the point. To the Jews, a Jewish dietary law is one of the things that gave them very visible, distinctive identity. That's why this was so important to the Jews. Remember, they fought tooth and nail for the dietary law.

They were being fed feast off the king's table and they were fused until they were only vegetable and water. Why were they doing this? Because to a Jew, this was life to them. This represented their unique relationship with the God of Israel. So you have to look beyond just the dietary law to what it represented. And it's this issue that God is starting to tap on Peter's shoulder about. It's what created the exclusive feelings that the Jews had about God, excluding everybody else. God did not mean for the dietary law to turn into a pride, prejudiced, exclusive issue. He didn't intend it for it to be an issue of loyalty and identity and purity. But it went beyond that to, they just felt that God belonged to them and nobody else. That was never God's intentions.

So now they've gotten this Jewish dietary law which represented their distinction from the Gentile world. And by the way, do you remember in the New Testament when Jesus was around, he's already shattered this issue? In fact, there's even parentheticals made by the gospel writers. When Jesus did this, he was proclaiming all food clean. That was a bombshell in that day. Remember all the ceremonial purifications? Mark chapter seven. When Jesus says, it's not what goes into a man, it makes them unclean. All foods clean. That's irrelevant. It just goes in and comes out. It's what comes out of a man's heart that makes them unclean. And that's where the parenthetical comes in by Mark and the other gospel writers. And when Jesus said this, do you realize the implications? He just made all food clean. All food clean. No dietary law.

Not by any relationship with God. No, the Jews maintained their dietary law but it was more cultural than it was spiritual and biblical at that juncture. Now, so you've got the sheet dropped down. Now, what's Peter thinking? God, you're testing me. I know better. I'm a good Jew. Follow the law of my life. That's a dietary law. I know I'm up with these those things. God, why are you tempting me on this? Of course I won't eat this. The sheet goes back up and so God comes back and knocks on the door twice more. He's doing the same thing. Peter, kill and eat. Peter, kill and eat.

Then that's it. He comes out of the trance. The dream's over. And guess who's knocking on the door at that moment? About noon. The people of that, that, that, that Cornelius has sent down. Notice the timing of this. That's been set in motion by God. Bridging these people together. Now, now you've got Peter receiving this vision. The question is, did Peter understand the vision at this juncture? Is there anything in the indication that he understands or doesn't understand the vision at this juncture? Some of you are saying, no. There's no indication he understands this yet. He just, he's sitting there scratching his head. Door knocks. Simon the tanner downstairs. They say, hey, Peter. Does someone ever see you?

Okay. Walk downstairs, meet these guys. And by the way, they're clearly Gentile. So, you get the next scene. And the next scene is they start talking. And what do they do? They say, well, we came from

a guy who's, well, it's all the way up in such a way. He's a Roman centurion. And he had an angel appear to him and sinned for you. Didn't happen every day. Very unique unusual circumstances. Now, what Peter is going to say to that? Okay. Well, then come on in. And by the way, he understands this time. Jews, that includes Jewish Christians. They carried on no association. Fellow shipping with rank, heathen Gentiles. So, Peter is already kind of walking over a very shaky bridge. In his mind and in his heart. But he senses that God's plotting him somewhere, obviously. Now, you're going to see what's neat about the story is how it becomes clear and clear to Peter as you go through the story.

God keeps on just taking him along. That's a little baby stuff at a time. Peter just took one little baby stuff towards the Gentiles. That's always going to take, though. That's all he can do at this moment. No. It says, the latter part of verse 23, the day of the chronology started out with them. And so now you've got Peter and these other three guys. And by the way, you'll find out that Peter took some people with him. He took six with him, six Jewish brethren with him. The whole entourage making the trip back up to Caesarea. They get the Cornelius' household. They knock on the door. And it kind of blows Peter away. Luke makes note the whole house is full of Gentiles. Cornelius got everybody in all of his relatives and friends there.

Now see, what I want you to see is that God has got Cornelius on page 10. And Peter's still back on page 2. He doesn't get it yet. He just knows that God is wanting me to go here. And I feel very uncomfortable about this because I'm a Jew. And God, am I really supposed to be here? Maybe we're going to have to do with that dream of vision. I've gotten. And so by the time he gets there in verse 27, it says, talking with him, Peter went in and found a large gathering of people. And he said to them, here's the first time you begin to realize that somehow between the visions and the trip up there and now at the door, step inside the living room of Cornelius, he's now beginning to interpret the dream. He says this, God has shown me that I should not call any man impure and clean.

Oh, we wasn't about the dietary law. You were talking about people. God, I get it. But now fully. What he gets is, okay, now I can be a liberal Jew and I can hang around some, you know, some of my best friends are hisons. You know what I'm saying? That's Peter right now. And then a little baby step. He walks into the living room. But you notice the first thing Peter says is, by the way, you are quite aware that I'm not supposed to be here. You know, when you go over to someone's house, it's not when you tell them. They invite you over and they're being, they're hosting you, social etiquette, which suggests, thank you for having us, Baba. Peter's first word is, I feel very awkward about this, and I should even be here, but here I am.

God has dragged me all the way. Because he cannot deny that God is demonstratively working. He just doesn't know where it's going yet. Now what Cornelius does. So Cornelius said, well, let me tell you the story myself. Just like my servant said, starting in verse 30, he says, look, four days ago, I had a vision. They told me to get you. They sent you here. And then notice. Verse 33, so I sent for you immediately, and it was good for you to come. Now we are all here in the presence of God's notice. To listen to everything, the Lord has commanded you to tell us. All of a sudden, another light goes off. And notice Peter's immediate response to this verse 34, then Peter began to speak, I now realize how true it is. This goes from baby step, baby step, baby step two.

He just took a nice big step here. He says, God does not show favoritism, but accepts men from every nation who fear him and do what is right. In other words, the baby step of just getting and accepting social interaction with Gentiles, one thing. But now he realizes, God has brought me here to preach Jesus to you. He brought me to preach Jesus to you. He's about to bring you into the kingdom. Again, this is, you know, we just sit there and we're just so clinical and lackadaisical about this stuff. This was an enormous moment in the history of the church. That's why Luke wants you to pay attention to it. And notice who's orchestrating every bit of this. Very openly, very irrefutably, tangibly visible all along. And it's going to be more tangible here in just a moment. That's where the spirit comes in.

So basically, if you pick up in verse 36 and following, what is he doing? He preached the message of Jesus. He talks to him about the miracles of Jesus, the death, the burial, the resurrection, how the Old Testament law predicted Jesus. And he ends his sermon. And now we're about to arrive at our substantial moment. He says, verse 43, all the prophets testify about him. And everyone who believes in him receives forgiveness of sins through his name. And then all of a sudden, bam, it happens.

Now here's where we're going to stop for us and slow down and just read the text. Now I want you to look at the thing. Remember our filter? Does it teach subsequent event? Does it teach that there are conditions to be met beyond conversion? And do we understand that speaking in tongues is being taught here as expected visible sign of having received the baptism of Holy Spirit? Okay, now notice what happens. He's in mid-sentence. Verse 44, while Peter was still speaking these words, God rudely interrupts him. He said, the Holy Spirit came on all who heard the message.

Now the Jesus message was out on the table by this time. Jesus didn't cut that short. Peter is still going though. You know, sometimes preachers say, you don't know when to shut up. So you know, say it, get down. Verse 45, the circumcised believers who had come with Peter. By the way, we learned later on there were about six of them. Notice their reaction to this. Obviously, we're seeing that they saw something. In other words, it wasn't this quiet, subtle moment where invisibly, non-tangibly, ethereally, they received the Holy Spirit. There was something very open and manifest about this moment where they saw, just like Simon did, that they received the gift of the Holy Spirit. But notice, there's no laying on the hands here, is there? There isn't an apostle there, but there's no laying on the hands. The circumcised believers who had come with him were astonished that the gift of the Holy Spirit had been poured out even on the Gentiles.

Now how did they know? How did they know? Look at the text. Verse 46. Because they each heard them speaking in tongues and praising God. So there is clearly an outward manifestation. By the way, in the book of Acts, this is what number of times that we've encountered specifically the issue, highlights the issue of speaking in tongues. Only the second, in all the book of Acts. Let's tell you something. Think about it. In other words, if Peter's, if Luke's, and one of his intent, going through all this process in Acts is to teach us that our repeatable patterns that people should be expecting is upon a conversion, why is this only cropped up twice in several years of history? With thousands of conversions going on, going on, having gone into the bridge. And none of them mentioning this. One other time this happens was back in Acts chapter 2.

A very similar event, by the way. The Spirit of God initiates on its own, BAM, upon the apostles, and they begin to speak in tongues. Here, if we're seeing this happen to the Gentiles. Now, I said that when it came to Samaritan's Remember, it could be the third time, but it's not mentioned specifically by Luke, because it's obviously wasn't his issue. He didn't want to make a point of that. It just simply says that Simon saw that by laying on the apostles' hands that they had received Holy Spirit. The obviously saw some outward manifestation. I think it would be legitimate to say that what he saw was the speaking in tongues. But we don't know because Luke didn't mention that. That's somewhat important there. But I think a fair assumption exegetically, interpretively.

All right? Now, so bottom line is, you've got this moment. Now, let me kind of stop here and just add this filter on here. If everyone understood, in terms of the church, what Peter understood when he walked into that living room, and Peter says, praise to us, and Peter goes, I now get it. You're about to become believers, too. You're about to be uttered into the kingdom of God. You're going to cross the bridge. And I'm a guy that's going to do it. And by the way, just so you know in the back of his mind, thinking, how am I going to answer this? Well, my brother and back in Jerusalem, who are going to call me to the carpet on this. But he's going to have courage. And he's going to do what God wants him to do, because this was not an easy thing to do.

There was a price to pay when he did this. A lot of anxiety, a lot of judgmentalism, a lot of turbulence

in the church when he goes back home. But just stay with me here for this. So he's up there, he's going to do this. And so if everyone understood what Peter knew, that is the impartiality of God, the events that we're about to see, or what we just read, would not have been necessary. In other words, why is God doing all of this? Why so outward, so manifest, so visible, so irrefutable? Well, he's going to have to convince someone. God's already convinced, and Peter's convinced. And Cornelius was way ahead of Peter in understanding this. It's all people back home and don't get it.

How are we going to get the church to accept this quantum leap through this major paradigm shift, socially, spiritually, in the Kingdom of God? Well, you see the answer. God sends a spirit in very visible manifest terms. Now, what is interesting to me, frees frame the moment, the spirits come upon them, and the experience is happening. Now, if I'm looking at the charismatic thesis, what I expect Peter to say at this point is this. Hey, since you've had the real experience of the spirit, well, you don't need to be baptized in mere water. That's what I expect in the sight. That's just a symbolic, you know, secondary event. You've got the spirit of God in you, so why bother? But you'll notice that Peter immediately doesn't separate the two issues. He immediately puts them together in a cohesive hold. And remember what we've been teaching all along?

We've started in the very first couple of classes about how you receive a spirit. When you receive a spirit, I made a very plan. You look at those tech, Galatians, Ephesians, to come out and put tech. In the beginning, by faith in Jesus Christ, having in the initial stages of hurting hearing the gospel message, end baptism at the New Birth. Now, immediately, Peter says this verse 47. I find it very interesting. Then Peter said, well, you guys see what's going on here? Obviously, God has put his seal of approval upon these Gentiles, so what is there left to do? Well, can anyone keep these people from being baptized with water? No, I can't prevent them. I said, do you, I want to prevent them? The Jewish Christian with all the enmity and prejudice, don't do this. It's not for you, but God says it is.

So I have no choice. They have received the Holy Spirit just as we have. And most commentators make special note of this, and it's certainly strike struck me when I read this back many years ago under this filter and trying to think this through, that Peter is going all the way back to the day of Pentecost to find another moment in history that paralleled this one. This is not something that happened every day. And notice then, verse 48. So he ordered that they be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ, and then they asked Peter to stay with them for just a few days.

So when he compares this, Peter can only compare to Pentecost. It's not something he's seen every day, and that was 10, 11 years ago. The meaning is surely no one can refuse them water baptism to become children of God. God wants Gentiles as well as Jews to become Christians. Now, quickly to summarize this. You know what happens in chapter 11, don't you? It's part of the same story. It's what took place after Peter went home and got called to the carpet. He goes back to Jerusalem, and they say, Peter, did we hear that gossip correct? Did you? Did you actually go to a Gentiles house? And did you actually praise the messengers of Jesus? Did you actually baptize somebody who has a heathen Greek? And Peter goes, well, yes, let me explain. And if you read chapter 11, it is Peter standing up in front of this almost inquisitorial, while intended, but very ignorant court of Christians, Jewish Christians back home in Jerusalem, and pleading his case, explaining to them that this was God's idea, not his.

Again, the bridge is not yet gapped yet, because only Peter's walked across it. All the other Christians haven't yet. So how is the rest of the kingdom of God going to follow along and join the rest of the Gentiles now? Of course, it's heaven before Paul is unleashed on him. And so if you get to chapter 11, he's telling the story, if you get to the end of chapter 11, around verse 14, and this is Peter now telling the group, is Peter giving first person narrative. He told us how he had seen an angel, and this is Peter saying, well, Codegas told us, verse 13, how he had seen an angel appear in his house and say, sin a job for Simon who's called Peter, he will bring you a message to which you and all your household will be saved.

I find that very interesting, because obviously they were not yet saved until Peter got there and preached a message. What does that say? As I began to speak, the Holy Spirit came on them as he came on us at the beginning, Acts chapter 2. Ten year leap to find a parallel event to what we just experienced when I went to the Gentiles house. Then I remembered the words, what the Lord had said, John baptized with water, which you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit. So if God gave them the same gift as he gave us, who believed in the Lord Jesus Christ, who was I to think that I could oppose God? And then in verse 18, really, the capital. Yes, there was a lot of prejudice, a lot of human ignorance. We have a real difficult time, the changes in the King of God today, as well as they do.

– [Acts 11:15-18](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

We have our own issues. But you see the heart of the church here. Notice verse 18, when they heard this, they had no further objection. Now remember, who has orchestrated this entire thing, the Spirit of God? The Spirit of God built the bridge, the Spirit of God forced the issue, the Spirit of God, allowed the question to be raised, and then the Spirit of God answered the question. And it was irrefutable. When they heard this, they had no further objections, and they praised God saying, God has granted even the Gentiles, repentance to life. Now, is this supposed to be a context that I'm supposed to take as a normal pattern for everybody?

So in summary, let me just ask the questions. Where's the doctrine of subsequent? It's not present here. In fact, the only way to prove subsequent is if you could somehow show in context that Conews was already a Christian before Peter showed up. But verse 14 says, we want to hear a message from you, now that you're here, so that we can be saved. So you saw Conews perceived themselves. A man desiring conversion, wanting this, hard open, seeking, but not yet having arrived. Where's meeting conditions beyond conversion? Every bit of this, just like with, just like with the Apostles on Acts 2, was completely surprising, radically unexpected. No one's being taught, by the way, we're going to lay hands on here, and a few minutes you're about to be hit with the Spirit, you're going to start speaking in tongues, so that should be expected.

That's how you'll know. None of that. It just happens. It's all spontaneous by the activity of God. So there's no subsequent event, and no conditions being taught beyond conversion. And what I do find interesting is yes, tongues are present, but notice the Peter gave no instructions on seeking Holy Spirit, or how there's expect tongues as evidence of that moment. It just happens. So again, if I understand the Samaritan event, I begin to understand the Greek event, the Gentile event, that this is not a normal event. This is chosen by Luke to be talked about, because it's such a radical, critical, unrepeatable moment. Now, if you stop to think, though obviously in the conversion experience, there are some things that are parallel, and there are some things that, that all of the conversions kind of hold in common, in terms of the Spirit's activities.

But in the context, there's also some unusual things that don't seem to fit any pattern. Quite the, and that's why I say, hallelujah, so can you explain all the bizarreness of it? Well, with Samaritans, who's going to build the bridge? Only God can do it, so he's going to do it visibly. And with Gentiles, who's going to build the bridge? Only God will do this, because no one else, no human being is going to take care of this on their own. So God's got a forced issue, and a very visible, supernatural manifest way. And so I do find at least some sensibility, and I am correct with this, and it certainly seems to make sense to me. I hope it is to you on some levels, that this is not a norm, this is an ab norm event. And I don't go to this to find, well, by the way, this is what you should expect to happen, conversion moment from the Spirit activates itself.

Okay. 715. Well, I want you to like me after today, so we're going to stop here. Next week, we're going to look at the last text out of Acts, that I'm going to, just for time's sake, we have time to look at. But it's also another one, it's chosen because it is a very specific text that has to do with very manifest teachings

and activities of the Holy Spirit. And I find this one, like the other, is very interesting, but it's a different animal. But I will tell you very clearly, it's in all takes place in seven verses. Now, I do want you to read, in the only seven verses, Acts 19 verses 1 through 7, for next week. And I want you to, you got to do a little something here, though. And I'm going to give you a little bit of heads up.

What is unique about this, is Paul goes into the city of Ephesus, and he runs into a group of people. Now, obviously, you're getting conveyer condensed cliff notes of this actual narrative. I'm sure Paul didn't just walk in, see 12 people start talking to them, you know, out of the blue. Obviously, there's other thing, you know, Paul's walking, he's eating, he's carrying on relationship, well, Bob, but in the context of his going into the city, on his third missionary trip, he runs into, it says about 12 men. And these men, there says, are disciples, but it says, and it has, it's centered around their baptism. That's the key issue of this. And their baptism was the baptism of John. Now, you're dealing with about 17, 20 years later after Acts 2, and you still have a lot of confusion floating out in the learning curve of the church.

See the wisdom that you gained from some of these things, and you see the actual historical perspective of Acts. And so, you know, you're precious, and I don't get it. I mean, you know, Jesus has been out there being preached, who can mess that up? But there it is. There is that phrase frame moment. It's a central part of this discussion, and basically it's a dialogue, a very clear, very specific condensed dialogue that Luke gives you, that obviously he interviewed Paul about, and Paul said, well, this is what happened. And he very selectly says, here was the conversation we had. It was his conversation with these 12 men, his questions, their responses. And if you pay attention to it, you're going to see very clearly what Paul's theology is. Paul's questions tells you what he believes, and what he expected.

And there's an aha moment in there. Oh, now I get it. The question that I have for you, just want you to think about a little bit, if you'll actually do this, is how did those guys get like that? In other words, how did they arrive at that kind of, kind of confusing status about themselves? They were great hearts, well intended, but they were confused. And Peter, basically Paul, I mean, surfaces to confusion, and then he resolves it. This was a major issue in the first century we find. Because he had disciples of John, even when Jesus mentioned, he had disciples of John and disciples of Jesus, and they kind of butted heads.

By the way, that didn't just evaporate away when Jesus raised from the dead. That conflict still remained we found out in the first century. There were still those who were following John the Baptist over Jesus, or kind of put John the Baptist on equal with Jesus. It's kind of interesting. And my question is, how did they get there? And what I'm pointing to you, is if you will just read at the end of Acts 18, although Luke doesn't specifically say this is the reason, certainly in context, it suggests the rationale for it. We'll just read it for yourself, and it has to do with the Paulos. Because the Paulos was preaching in Ephesus before Paul arrived. And what was Paul?

What was the Paulos preaching? Just read it in Acts 18, then go to the Acts 19 verses 1 through 7, and basically I'm just going to walk you through the simplicity of Paul's dialogue as he plays it out with these 12 men, and notice the spirit is smack dab in the middle of it. That's the reason we're going to take it and selectively use this text and the filter that we're using through the book of Acts. And then if I have time, what I'm going to do in the class is to, because I'm asked about this. You know, I told you in terms of charismatic framework that I was very deeply involved with that when I was in college in my middle of the year, when I got out of my before Christ's days and came back to Jesus. And I had this experience by my choice.

I circulated in the context of the charismatic Pentecostal realm, and this is what really kind of launched my questions, because I got so confused with a lot of things, but I really believed, and I was just doing the best I could. But I received this moment, this experience, as it is framed today, this thing called baptism in the Holy Spirit. And so I'm just going to play it out for you and tell you exactly what happened. And I'd like to take away some of the mystique of it, first of all, but I'm also giving you an honest assessment of what I experienced and what I think actually, as I looked in the mirror and said, okay, well, what

actually happened to me?

How can I explain this to that and the other? And then I'm also going to maybe take you into a very simple, but yet profound look at, what is baptism in the Holy Spirit from a purely textual point of view? And I find that helpful, too, because if I'm encountering all this confusion, see, if you understand where I'm going with this, and why I'm dealing with this filter is going along, because I feel if we're not careful, we should pursue the Spirit, we should understand it, and I tell you why we are, we in the Restoration Movement are some of the most ignorant people that I know when it comes in, because we've avoided it for so long, and we put our heads in the sand, and everyone else is talking about over here, so we can avoid perhaps some of these extremes, so we just kind of just withdraw, and turn into a rather, I'm not trying to, I'm not dissing, I'm talking about me.

I was like this, I grew up this way, but it's just an honest assessment that we just did not acknowledge or talk about this. We still don't. Although, if you notice, I've tried to be more open and being very biblical, talking about the Spirit's activity in our lives, and just dealing with devos and stuff, because Paul did, and Peter did, why don't we? Or did the Spirit just disappear somewhere along the line? And I'll tell you that's bad theology, if that's what we think. What we're saying is, we can do this on our own, we don't need God. That's why the Spirit was given.

So this is a rather crucial issue, and maybe why we're so stalemated in our influence in the world in which we live. We put the Spirit on the margins. We do this on our own. We do good businessmen and run things, and all the machinery won't well, and then we'll just grow churches to be fine. By the way, you can grow a church and never once give God the time of day. You'd go for a stop to think about it. And so, but I, but even though that's true from one end, I also feel, I also, let's say, well, if we pursue the Spirit and being filled with the Spirit and being led by the Spirit and walked from the Spirit, to the Lord of all, right at His own letters. I do not want to get preoccupied with things that are, I think, I think are just like these shows where they're chasing ghosts.

It leads nowhere. And I don't want to get caught up in all this preoccupation because I think that leads to just an empty end for you. I think the Spirit is doing certain things but it's substantial. That's why I keep on telling you, the Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ. The more you understand filling that up and understand the substance of that, the more you'll have a filter to discern, is the Spirit active here or is it? And I think it will help you in your daily walk and in your encounter with, even with others within the under the umbrella of Christendom, because you can go lightweight. I spend a lot of time pursuing things and, you know, I guess I kind of came out empty-handed. I had all this bundle of experiences I could tell you about, but I'm not sure where it led me.

And I wasn't sure, I really kind of trained the devil, remember all that stuff. It was kind of like, I kind of came out of that stuff and said, is that really what God meant? And so anyway, I'm going to try to talk a little bit about that on the tale into this. And the last thing I'm going to talk about is we have three weeks left. I want to talk to you straight up as best as I know how about this year of miracles. And I think you might find that interesting and perspective.

So let's pray and we're done. Father, we thank you. We love you. We wish to the same passionate degree that you desire it to be filled with your Spirit, to be influenced by your Spirit, that you help us overcome our fears and not quench the Spirit of God in our lives that we will keep in step with Him, that we will acknowledge that you are orchestrating and leading and empowering and affirming our lives through your Spirit and that we are desperate for you. We cannot do this on our own. And so we receive you into our life and we make that conscious decision every day. And we ask you help us to be sensitive to your prompting that you will help us to do what you helped your children to do in the first century. That is to connect with people who need the message of Jesus and your love and your compassion and who ultimately they need Jesus.

And Father, I feel like so often in our ministry we're just kind of groping and darkness. And I pray that you help us. It's in Jesus' name we pray. Amen. Amen.

Class 11: Acts 19, Baptism in the Holy Spirit, and Experience Tested by Scripture

Original transcript: `hs11.txt`

Summary: The final transcript studies the disciples of John in Acts 19, summarizes Jim's view that salvation is an organic whole, explains baptism with the Holy Spirit as the historic outpouring begun at Pentecost, and then weighs Jim's own charismatic experience against Scripture.

Key Scripture References

- [Acts 18:24-28](#)
- [Acts 19:1-7](#)
- [Galatians 3:1-5](#)
- [Matthew 3:11](#)
- [Acts 1:4-5](#)
- [Acts 2:16-18](#)
- [Acts 8](#)
- [Acts 10:44-48](#)
- [Acts 11:15-18](#)
- [Acts 16](#)
- [1 Corinthians 15:14-20](#)
- [Joel 2:28-32](#)

Quotations and Source Notes

Paul asks whether the Ephesians received the Holy Spirit when they believed, then points them from John's baptism to Jesus.

– [Acts 19:1-7](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

John baptized with water, but the apostles would be baptized with the Holy Spirit.

– [Acts 1:4-5](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Cleaned Transcript

At the end of Acts 18, before you arrive at Acts 19. Do you see any connection in other words? Okay now I want you know to be very careful to say that Luke doesn't actually point this out so there is some assumption on this but I'm trying to find some rhyme and reason why is Paul walking into running into people who claim to be believers and then basically putting them through an acid test of questions. He's checking them out. Now he didn't do this elsewhere elsewhere, why is he doing it right here this moment with these people? Well again it seems to be more alluded to but perhaps Apollos' activity because we do know that Apollos was, although he knew, he said, taught about Jesus' accurately, he was very passionate about preaching and in fact was known as quite, I mean he was like the guy who wanted their retreats and at their seminars. This guy was from their estimation of how they evaluated speakers. This guy was really good and in terms of how they saw Greek oratory and it wouldn't be like we view today. You guys would probably find them quite boring unless you like to hear Shakespeare spoken from stages but in that case you might like him. But point being that Apollos was really really a very passionate about this but he also had a very sketchy understanding about some things which I find very interesting. Of course that's when Aquila and Priscilla says, took him aside and they taught him the word of God more accurately and had to do it because he was preaching the baptism of John. Now there's the predecessor to this and where was he doing this? He was doing this in Ephesus. Then it says that Apollos goes to Corinth. So he's left, he's stood on his way and Paul and his third missionary trip ends up in Ephesus.

So again I'm making some assumption connections but you know there is some contextual reasons maybe for this but there are also some things that don't jive with me completely either so that's why I put a question mark that you know I'm making an assumption there. Now we pick up Acts 19 verse 1 and Paul comes into this group of people and he asks them a question. Notice the question. Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed? Now either this is just a random mindless question or Paul's taking us somewhere and he's got a certain theology in mind and to me it's very clear what his theology is when you get through it this time. Would it Paul believe? It's built into his questions. Paul expected the spirit to come upon belief and by the way the just so you know if you want to get into it beyond the cursory devotional reading level and you want to actually look at the Greek text which is what it originally written in and understand that there are some depths of understanding of this text when you begin to understand the original language. The word believe is in the ingressive aorist which means retranslated. Did you receive a Holy Spirit when you first heard the message of God and believed in the beginning and by the way that should quickly echo to you a passage that we looked at in the beginning of this semester Galatians chapter 3 one and following were Paul asked that exact same question of the Galatians. He goes, did you receive Holy Spirit by works of law or by believing what you heard? Same word, same context in the beginning by faith in Jesus the Holy Spirit. How do Holy Spirit come? To Paul in Galatians 3 he said it comes in the beginning by faith in Jesus when you heard the message of Jesus.

Well Paul's asking the exact same question, I pointed simply this, if Paul was very consistent in his theology. He didn't change his mind, he went around, you don't find a lot of confusion when you go from one text to the other. Paul said the same thing Galatians is saying right here in front of these people in Ephesus. So he asked the very simple question, did you receive Holy Spirit when you believe? Notice their response was, and why is it not working again? That's twice I've pressed. There we go. No, we have not even heard there is a Holy Spirit. Interesting response. Now, now by understanding all the New Testament teaching and all the Paul's written letters that was certainly very clear that in the New Testament conversion to Jesus that the Holy Spirit was expected. And here's some people who claim who are belaborate but remember Paul's putting them through somewhat of a framework of acid test and talking to them not in judgmentalism but trying to say you guys have you completed your journey yet basically. And right away there's a red flag. We don't even know about the Holy Spirit. Now, some scholars point out that the actual sentence structure may better read rather than not that they didn't know about the Holy Spirit at all because we'll find out in a minute that they've been baptized in John's baptism. Remember when John was baptized they were speaking about the Holy Spirit of God. In fact, remember that's when even John said, I baptized you with water but one who comes after me will baptize you in the Holy Spirit. In other words, that was already on the table. What they weren't ignorant about the coming of the Spirit. That goes all the way back to the Old Testament prophets. They knew it was coming. It was going to happen. We read about that in Joel's prophecy that we're going to come back to him into this class. My point being is that it may be read this way.

Now, no, we have not even heard that the Holy Spirit has yet been given. Maybe a more accurate way of looking at this text. Either way, the Holy Spirit was clearly placed in question mark. Whether they didn't even, what they hadn't even heard of the Holy Spirit yet, red flag. In other words, can you connect the person with Jesus? They haven't even heard of the Holy Spirit. There's a immediate cognitive dissonance in Paul's mind. Something's wrong here. Something's not right. Something's not completed yet. Or the Holy, they have not heard that the Holy Spirit has been given yet. Either way, you have clearly a Paul saying, okay, hmm, there's something I need to inquire further about. So then he raises the question, then what baptism did you receive? Interesting.

Notice Paul's connections. It's very simple, very clear, very reasonable, rational, theologically. What did Paul expect? Paul expect the Holy Spirit to come at belief. If they had not yet heard that the Holy Spirit had been given, or they had not yet heard that there is a Holy Spirit. Either way, you want to

translate that text. His next question, interesting enough says, well, then what baptism did you receive? Now already, what did you see in Paul's logic? Tell me. May. I'm sorry. Okay, what baptism we're talking about here? What baptism is Paul asking, we're inquiring about. Look at the entire scope of the book of Acts. It's cropped up on several occasions. What is he speaking about? Acts 2, Acts 8, Acts 9, Acts 10, Acts 16, Acts 18. Huh? You don't. Notice their answers we're about to get into.

First of all, when you see the clear connection in Paul's thinking that Paul was connecting belief, initial belief, Holy Spirit of baptism, clearly in his questions. Very clear is the origin. Read, Titus 2, Galatians 3, all the past. We've already looked at Acts chapter 2. Cohesively, very consistent with all those pictures. Now their response is John's baptism and there's the aha moment. The light goes off in Paul's head and goes, oh, that explains it. Why? Okay, there's the easy answer because it tells you that. Why is there? Why is this clearly an answer to Paul? Where do you know the question, can you explain to me what John Baptist meant? John's baptism was a baptism of repentance. It was just kind of an outward sign that you were turning away from your life and you were going, you know, you were turning away from the things you've been doing and trying to live a more pure life. But it didn't really have anything to do, I guess, with Jesus, didn't have anything to do with Christ.

Nothing to do with Jesus at all. And what was John's ministry, by the way? Of course, figure out John's baptism, you have to understand John's ministry. What was John's role? Was he a prophet? Yes. And what was his role as a prophet? It was very unique, prophesied the Old Testament and he's the one that was identified as being this person. Okay, John's primary goal was to prepare, to smooth out the streets, pave them for the coming of someone who's coming behind me because I'm not the primary attention person. The one behind me is, so I'm trying to get you ready for this. And I'm going to do this by calling you to a baptism of repentance that says, for the remission of sins, quote unquote. And he said, he went out by the Jordan and the people started flocking out to him by horns and he started baptizing him in the river Jordan where there was, he says, much water. Now, of course, that during that time, even Jesus himself shows up just a common show looking just like everybody else. And when he walks up to John, he goes, hey, it's my turn. And of course, John bulked on that one because John knew.

Because look, I can't, this is about the repentant remission of sins and I know who you are and you ain't supposed to have this done. You're him. You're the one that, you know, my cousin who I'm supposed to pave the way for here. And Jesus said, well, permitted so that all righteous may be fulfilled. You know, there's a phrase, you guys, do you have any idea what that means? Well, we don't have time for that today. But Jesus is giving some rather succinct answers about his role and what baptism was to him. But he submitted to this identity with humanity. And the sins of man. And he at that moment very visibly took on the mission of God. That's where he stepped out of the carpentry shop, if you will. And started becoming the earth changing evangelist, if you'll know. And now this transition takes place. You'll also note this time that even Jesus disciples were also carrying on the same baptism, if you remember reading in the gospel. By the way, did you realize what John was doing, what they call a limited commission?

Did John just baptize anybody? Do you understand what I say when I mean he sits a limited commission? Okay. Who is the baptism of John for? Very specific group of people. Jews, only for Jews. Wasn't for everybody. It's just the Jews. You only find Jews walking into the waters there where John would be baptized. John was called to the children of Israel calling them to repent. The people of God who had the identity of God, who were to glorify God in the face of the earth, whom God had risen up historically, had protected, nurtured, carried up to this very moment. Here are the people of God and they needed to repent and changed their hearts because until they turned their hearts to God they would not see the Messiah when he actually showed up. By the way, how many actually recognized him when he did? Very few. Their hearts were too impure and they saw all the wrong things. So we had all these people walking by God and never knew it. It's just one of the most amazing stories of the gospels to me. Well that was all for free. John's baptism.

Clearly what you understand here is that it was not based in faith on Jesus Christ. It was only based on a promise of the coming Messiah. It was very clearly I'd do with Jesus but he was not yet identified. The reason that you got baptized is because John was saying he's coming. It's really close at hand. So repent and be baptized. And so they came and then they had out their binoculars and they're looking. All the visuals looking. They knew the time was ripe and they're waiting for the Messiah to show up except they had a certain view of this Messiah and in Jesus didn't fit that billing and so they kept overlooking them. So here Paul notes, well you had John baptism. Well that's good. In other words they were looking forward to the cross. They had repented but they had not yet turned to Jesus because they didn't know about him yet fully.

On some level that is they were a remnant of Old Testament saints still looking for the Messiah. John's baptism was a baptism looking forward to this unidentified person. Now he is identified. Now he's been through the death, burial, and resurrection. Now we have New Testament baptism as we call it. Baptism into the name of Jesus. Starting there in the book of Acts chapter 2 and going on and on from that moment. Now once Paul defines this for them, he says, oh look John, baptism was a baptism for repentance. He told the people to believe in the one coming out for him that is in Jesus.

So having now identified and putting them through this identity of questions based on this, this, and this. That was the asset. How do you get there? He got there through belief, received Holy Spirit baptism. Obviously clearly in Paul's mind there was an expectation when you put those three together. They had no about the Holy Spirit. They had not yet received Holy Spirit. He was like, oh okay there's something wrong with your baptism. What is it? Because he expected the Holy Spirit to come about. John's, ah there's the problem. Let me explain to you what John was all about and then what is he going to do? On hearing this he said they were baptized into the name of the Lord Jesus Christ. Now I find this very interesting on a lot of different levels. To me Paul's theology is rather clear. Again why he actually walked in and started asking this particular group of people these questions. I'm not quite sure other than the allusion to Apollos' activity prior to his arrival. And there was some confusion out there.

What I find also interesting, I go back to that timeline, it's here 25 years later, you still have people who are disciples of John who are still awaiting the coming of the Messiah and haven't put all the dot, haven't connected all the dots yet. Although their hearts are bent that way and they want to find it, they're still looking. So again I'm trying to show you if you look clearly in the book of Acts there was not this clear cut black and white roll where everything worked very precisely and then you took one step, another step, another step. There was a lot of confusion, there was kind of a convoluted picture here where you have New Testament Christian springing up all over the Mediterranean world, you still had people who were still kind of in the pre-Jesus stage of belief. Interesting. All I know is that where they were when you run into this people. Of course you pick up, I don't know if I got it in there or not, well I was showing you obviously the connection, obviously the problems are about this and why? Well he baptized them there, that was his immediate response. And then this is where the interesting thing comes in and where again the confusion, potentially, verse 7, verse 6, when Paul placed his hands on them, the Holy Spirit came on them and they spoke in tongues and prophesied. Interesting.

There were about 12 men and all. In the story, move on, talk about something else. So he comes in, finds group people, says, do you receive the Spirit when you first believe? What Spirit? Oh, then what baptism did you get? Well, John's. Oh, I don't understand now. Well, John's baptism was this, but that's from the Jesus, does promise Holy Spirit. So let me tell you about Jesus and now put your faith in him. That's what you've been moving toward. That's where John was trying to get you to. Now you're in all this state of confusion. Let's resolve this and then it says, he laid his hands on them and there was for the third time in the book of Acts, this very outward manifest moment of speaking in tongues and prophesying. So what am I going to do with this?

Well, let me just make a few notes and we'll create some closure to this and leave you to let your will

spin and think some more and study some more. I want you to note that Paul does not teach to laying out of hand or the reception of the Spirit. What he is teaching here very clearly is faith in Jesus Christ. That's the focal point. That's where he takes them. That's what they were lacking. Paul does not teach the necessity of speaking in tongues or that it should be expected as evident. So although I think it's interesting that that happens here, it still doesn't fit the Pentecostal experience and the charismatic thesis that we talked about. That there is a subsequent experience that there are conditions to be met beyond conversion and that speaking in tongues is expected as an outward manifestation of sign as having received Holy Spirit. I asked you this question earlier, how many times is speaking in tongues even mentioned in the book of Acts with all the conversions it took place? How many times? More than two, three, Acts chapter two, Acts chapter 10 with Cornelius, and Acts chapter 19 here. 25 years apart, hundreds of converges mentioned, no only three times as Luke mentioned it. Let's strike you. In other words, if it was Luke's intention to teach this, it was a repeatable pattern that everyone should be pursuing so they can know they have received the Holy Spirit. Well, he's foregone all these other conversions where there's no mention of this whatsoever.

Only on three occasions makes me think that I would say four if you assume Acts chapter 8 with the Samaritans when it said Simon saw that by the laying on the apostles' hand that they received Holy Spirit. What he saw, I don't know, but my assumption it was probably speaking in tongues. So you can say four maybe. In no case, though, in any of these situations, our conditions laid down for receiving Holy Spirit not once. There's no interim period saying, you know, yield your life, purify your life, it's self-ready, and now you've received the second work of grace, the second stage, a subsequent reception of God where he gives you a Spirit. None of that is ever suggested. In no case, the Christians taught to be satisfied until they've spoken in tongues. There were three occasions when they did, but it was completely unexpected.

And therefore, in no case, our tongues said to be expected or required as proof of the Holy Spirit's coming. Because I can show you occasions where people were beginning Christians and they did not speak in tongues or we try and suggest they did not receive Holy Spirit. What about the eunuch? Did he leave empty? Or did he have the Spirit of God when he walked away? What about Lydia? What about the Philippian jailer? What about the Corinthians and Acts 18? No mention whatsoever of having hand laid on them. No mention of received perception of the Spirit. No mention whatsoever of speaking in tongues. None of the above. Just quiet, simple hearing the message, believing Jesus and being baptized. And this is one thing that strikes me and it finally dawned and made us back many years ago. But where my mind began to coalesce a little bit, that in every instance that tongues speaking is mentioned, it is never an individual. It is always a group of people.

The group of the apostles, the group of the Gentiles in his household, and this group of 12 men who were disciples of John. So by kind of step back from this thing, look at the big picture. Let me just kind of suggest where this leaves me as I look at the big picture of the book of Acts. Does Acts teach us that there are different stages of salvation, conversion, justification, sanctification, second work of grace, some subsequent event? I do not see it. Salvation I see in New Testament is an organic whole. It is given all at once, thus Paul's questions. They Holy Spirit, that is all a cohesive whole. He does not fragment them. He puts them all together and sees them as being a cohesive moment in life with the believers. Acts does not teach coming Holy Spirit must be accompanied by extraordinary signs because there are too many other conversions where no extraordinary signs are given unless they are being robbed of their experience or being left incomplete as Christians. And I note that it's certain critical junctures in Acts. For good reason, there were miraculous Spirit incited unusual events.

And you'll note that the speaking in tongues was circulated in either moments where there was great confusion, potential confusion, or resistance. It was always a group of people that were sending the message and God's wanted to initiate it, made it happen. In each time I can find a very clear question about God raising a question and answering for people who were resistant to the will of God or were

confused about the will of God. The event I find the most difficult to translate is this one we just looked at in Acts 19. I can find a clear one with the Samaritan bridging, the Gentiles bridging, but what about this one? The rationale here to make sense to me is just not as clear as you have the clear issue and this is spoken about even in the turn of the first century where there was a lot of confusion between those who came to follow John and those who came to follow Jesus. And here very clearly God was saying if there's any confusion about who the Messiah is, let me make it really, really clear here, it's Jesus, follow Him, not John. And so and God again in a very audio visible, irrefutable, tangible moment made it very clear what His answer was in each of those confusing, resisting moment. So there's where I walk away with the book of Acts, when it comes to this particular issue and that particular grid I placed on it. Of course, I showed you in the beginning, we looked at Acts, I showed you the Spirit is involved in so many things and this is not a handicap of Spirit's activities in my life, but it does give me a filter of the side from the Spirit and what is not. Now let me raise this question because this is one I'm asked a lot and then if you guys are interested I'll tell you about when I went through all this. This phrase, baptism in the Holy Spirit or baptism with the Holy Spirit. Let me see if I can take you to just a clear textual framework for this out of the book of Acts and see if this makes some sense to you. What does it actually mean? Well, first of all I want you to see that it's spoken of back in the first chapter. This came from the lips of Jesus himself when he was commissioning them before his ascension after his resurrection. 40 days of resurrection of parents was giving many convincing proofs that he was alive and bodily form and in his new transformed glorious body. And it says:

once when he was eating with them, he commanded them, do not leave Jerusalem until the Father sends you the gift he promised. As I told you before, John baptized with water, but just in a few days, you will be baptized with the Holy Spirit.

– [Acts 1:4-5](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

So you see that phrase right there, baptized with the Holy Spirit. A few days later, probably around 10 days later in actuality, on the day of Pentecost. After four days of resurrection of parents, Jesus ascends and so I know it's at least 10 days later. We read this. Remember we read the verses beginning of chapter two, you had the sound of the mighty rushing wind, the tongues the fire lighting upon them and it says they all began to speak in tongues and other tongues. And they get out there in the porticole areas and people start drawing to this, having heard the sound of the mighty rushing wind and they each heard them speaking in their own language and praising God and so it all begins. So after all the people are getting there, people are beginning to raise questions like what's taking place here. Peter then steps forward amongst the 12 and says, let me tell you. Chapter two, verse 16. And this goes after the, he says, no, remember the guy said, oh, they're just a bunch of drunks, which I find interesting. There's more already in the beginning of this thing, making light of it. He says, no, what you see was predicted long ago by the prophet Joel. And those to phrase the Joel uses.

In the last days, God says, I will pour out my spirit. Upon all people, your sons and daughters will prophesy, your young men will see visions, your old men will dream dreams. In those days, I will pour out my spirit even on my sermon and men and women of light and they will prophesy.

– [Acts 2:16-18](#). Version not stated in the audio; class wording is NIV-like.

Now, what I want you to see here is that you've got the word baptism, baptism in Holy Spirit here. And obviously, very clearly, you're seeing this event is this event. Baptism used as one perspective pouring being the other. I meant to have a glass of water with me. And then another glass that was empty and and pour one into the other. And I'll, so you just kind of put that image in there, thus the background graphic there that you see water pouring out, pouring, clearly see that you're seeing the same event referred to from basically two different perspectives. Baptism is from the recipient's point of view, being immersed in the spirit, and pouring, being from God's point of view, God's doing the pouring. Obviously,

again, speaking about the same event. So when you're here about the pouring out of the Spirit, referring to the same moment of the Baptism of the Holy Spirit or with the Holy Spirit. Now, let me reveal a bit more specific and talk to you about this word, pour. The word pour means to absolutely empty of content.

In other words, if I have a cup and eight ounce cup with eight ounces of water in it, and I pour it out, the word actually means to empty the content. So I'm going to pour out eight ounces of water to pour out the content of it. That's what it means. The point being that God poured out empty heaven of the Holy Spirit and poured it out upon mankind. Get the idea. It wasn't a little bit, a little bit, a little bit, a little bit, a little bit. It is a pour. It's emptied out. And this phrase right here, by the way, when he says, now what you see, the actual Greek word is this. Peter said, this is that which Joel referred to. I was speaking right now, historical event. You hear what Joel said, this is happening right now in front of you.

Then you move to the events and today's households. Next time you find this phrase, the circumcised believers who had come with Peter were astonished to notice that the gift of Holy Spirit had been poured out even on the Gentiles. Let me make some distinctions between this thing because you'll note that it's spoken of, this idea of baptism with, and pouring out come in different, with different understanding and meaning. When you look in chapter two, when he says, this is that, it's aorist tense. What that simply means is it's a past event that is completed. So Peter says, when you see this happening, Joel prophecy, this is that, it's happened right now, past tense completed. God's already poured it out. He's emptied heaven. He's made the Spirit of God available to everybody.

Then you find Peter referring to it later on in chapter two, and he's speaking about this, and he uses the phrase, God has poured out. There is, they call it, Ingressive aorist, basically meaning that something has been completed and once and for all time, get the idea. Then when you get to Luke referring and defining the moments with the Gentiles, he uses present tense, which means it is completed and continuing. In other words, God poured out a Spirit and it continues to be available. Now if you put these three things together, it becomes very clear. Peter and Luke and Joel are all very consistent on this thing. Luke looks at it from a futuristic point of view. Peter speaks about it as, happening right now and past tense completed, and then Luke later on, years later refers back to it, says, because of that event, it's still now available and being given now even to the Gentiles. This is what they call the historical view of Beth and Holy Spirit. Now if you really want to get into this study of some, and I would encourage you to do some, there are basically three or four different basic views to this, that it takes you.

To take the contemporary view would leave, I would assume, most not all of you knowing that most of not all of you grew up in Church of Christ, Restoration, Theology, has rather incomplete Christians. Unless, of course, you hadn't handled on you, received the baptism of the Holy Spirit with evidence of speaking in tongues. So if you're missing something, you ought to have it. If God wants you to have that. If you're not missing it, then should you be pursuing it? And there's becomes an issue. Now you define this. So it's not just theology, it actually matters to your life. If indeed you want to have everything God offers you.

So anyway, there is a picture for this, and I do have some things I can give you. They succinctly walk you through and think through the text and point out things of this nature and help you see, but my personal view after walking through all this and being on both sides of it, this textually makes the great deal more sense to me. That God poured out his Spirit, emptied the contents. It was a full pouring out. The Spirit, from that point on, that occurred back in Acts chapter 2 from historical point of view, was complete. The Spirit is now available to anyone who comes to God, and that pouring out is to his body, this church. And the chorus, obviously, we tend to think of things very individualized in our culture. In the New Testament, it's thought about it in terms of us, not I.

And they were added to their number daily, those who were being saved. They met together and enjoyed

the favor of all the people. They worship God. They were into the Word and breaking the bread and on and on. So the Spirit of God is now available to the church and engages and empowers and makes us the witnesses to this world that we ought to be. Now, there's baked the general framework for this. Some of you expressed interest in hearing about this, and so I told you I'd share it if you wanted me to. It doesn't matter to me. Where I had this event happen in my life, what was known as baptism in the Holy Spirit from a contemporary point of view. So I'll just tell you how it happened, and part of the reason I'm doing is to kind of break it down a little bit so you can see and maybe remove some of the mystery of it, because if only if you've just heard about or read about it, you sit there and have all these wondering, so what does the person actually think who's actually been through this?

And you can find different stories. I'll just let me tell you mine. But there is a basic fundamental consistent pattern around the globe with this. My experience was really not very different. I've met people from Africa, I've met people from South America, I've met people from Asia who've had the exact same experience done in the exact same way as I did. So I know it's a global issue, but there are a little tweaking differences, and you can read about different things. Let's start here. I was very dissatisfied. I came back to God when I started coming back to God when I was a junior in college. I looked at the base, looked at the mirror, didn't like what I saw. And I asked the question, do I, you know, if I keep going direction, I'm going, do I want to end up where that leads me? And I just knew better. I knew I didn't want to go there.

And I was doing fine. I had friends. I was, you know, making pretty much straight A's and doing good in school. And wasn't that my life was falling apart. And I was some sort of addict on the street living, you know, begging for money or anything. I just looked at what I saw inside of me was a mess. And, you know, we can cloak it with a lot of good things. And you talk with that, you know, story of the particle standing in the pig pen. Some of our pig pens look really good, you know. And mine looked pretty good. I got stereos in it. And I had, you know, all the gadgets and things and money and cars and whatever. Although I lived in somewhat of a slum area, but that was probably my choice. Very dissatisfied with life. And I started reading the New Testament again. And I started with the Gospels. And I read the New Testament eight times one semester.

And if you ever just read through the whole of the Testament, it takes a little bit of time. My point is I became obsessed. And I still make good grades. I'm kind of glad I've probably said and done, but I started reading about Jesus and started working through the hard questions that I kind of ignored earlier on in my life. Like, how do I really know this is true? And you've heard me talk about some of this for you for me. Say this, but it was true that I decided back in the beginning that I wasn't going to follow a dead man. It all had to do with the resurrection. If he's raised and dead, then it's true. If he didn't raise and dead, it's all just a bunch of crocs and just walk away. Why waste your time? At least that was what I think. And I, by the way, I found out that I agree with Paul. That's where he says in 1 Corinthians 15, read it for yourself.

Jesus raised and dead, it's just, you guys are, we're always wasting our time. This is the biggest hoax ever placed upon mankind. And so we better figure this one out. And so I looking at this, decided, yeah, I think I actually believe that Jesus bodily raised from the grave. And that proves that his death was not just the death of a criminal, that his death was the death for the sins of all the world. And I wanted to end on it. Of course, part of what attracted me with it, because I've been around a lot of Christians who are really genuine. We always worry about all the hardware, you know, all the hipper crids and all that kind of stuff. But by the way, I think we all know some people are really genuine with this too. And I happen to know a little bit of both. And it was people that were really genuine about the kind of grooming. My mom was one of them.

My dad was not a Christian, so I couldn't go there. But my mom was a genuine Christian. And she and some others, you know, I just knew there was something about their life that I wanted in on. I knew

where I was going. Well, it wasn't good. And as Paul says, the things of now which I am ashamed, that's how I thought. So I was yearning for something. But I also looked back at my old religious life I had growing up in church like all of you. And I thought it's got to be more to it than this. So I started thinking, well, I just didn't have a complete view back then. And I had some friends that were very strongly engaged in what was considered charismatic movement. And so I started going church with them. And went home that summer and started reading books.

And there were books written by Charismatic, well-known Charismatic writers. Jamie Buckingham, for example, you can go, you can look at some stuff Google. And he's got good books. They talk about receiving the baptism in the Holy Spirit. And I'm thinking, then this must be what I'm missing. So I was reading about it and already kind of acclimating myself to it. People having hand laid on them, having this experience where the spirit floods into their life. And there were different things tweaked. People said they felt like electricity going through your body or had this sensation. Somebody said it wasn't so much sensational. But it was just something they knew that God had taken over that they began to speak in tongues. And that's how they knew, remember, evidenced by speaking in tongues, that they knew that experience they knew they had received the Holy Spirit. And so I started journeying for this. In fact, I was doing so much reading while I was home that summer. My dad got real concerned about it because I wasn't going off and playing basketball like I did pretty much every day with my buddies. And he said, he came in my room one day and I was going to read my Bible. I had the other books next to it and I'm sitting there comparing notes and I said, what's wrong with you? And I said, well, I'm just reading, trying to figure out some things. And of course, my dad wasn't a believer. So he had a really hard time connecting dots with any of this. He was really concerned I was getting into a cult. Yeah, you're getting you're okay. And I said, well, yeah, I just want to pursue this. So you know, a mom's a Christian. So he had to handle this delicately. And but even my mom was a little bit concerned.

Because you know, it would be on simply showing up the church once a week. And so anyway, I'm searching. I'm already kind of feeding myself and I'm seeing this idea. And I had a friend who for this summer went to a place called the end of the last resort. And basically it was a place where most people that went there, they were either addicts or they had some really severe defunctional homes. There was a place that was opened up by a very well-known, very wealthy businessman who was a believer. And basically he bought this huge mansion, lots of property in Franklin, Tennessee, and he called it the end of the last resort and invited people to come so that they could kind of restore their lives with Jesus. But it was a very charismatic world. And this person who was a friend of mine was there. And so on my way back to Auburn, that year I just took a little detour and went there. But I'll tell you, I also went there thinking, you know, that this person I'd talked about that fully spared me, maybe getting this event happening and how they did this all the time in the last resort. And so I kind of went with some sense of anticipation. So I was already kind of acclimating to the idea, although kind of frightened me a little bit, wondering what would actually happen. And Clyde read so many stories and some of them were so off the radar that, wow, what a guy just lifts me up the air and floats me around or something, you know. And I wasn't just about anything. I'm be honest with you, I was.

And so anyway, I got there and talked and most of everyone, during the break period, so most of everyone was gone, but my friend and a few others were there. And this individual who was the leader of the place that owned there, he and his wife and a few others. And I see my good place for me in a last resort. And I felt like I was kind of down to my end of my rope. And so we started talking and saying, you know, I've been reading about this. And I don't know what it is, but I like to have this thing called baptism in the Holy Spirit. And I go, it's great.

So this is what happened. This is actually just, I'm just telling you, just breaking it down to the simplicity of this. I said, this pattern is very similar around the globe. And you'll find this issue of subsequent experience, which is what I was seeking. Conditions beyond conversion. And speaking in tongues as evidence of having received this baptism in the Holy Spirit. First of all, Pete called together a group of

the believers that were there. We walked into a room with a bunch of rocking chairs and they said, go sit down on the rocking chairs, like sat down on the rock chair. And so I'm sitting down here. A bunch of guys, they came around me and surrounded me. And they were all laid hands on me or on the person behind them, you know, we do. And I think it's a neat thing, a good thing. But there's different ways they laid hands on New Testament if you pay attention, by the way. This one specifically for receiving a baptism in the Holy Spirit, kind of like when Peter and John went to the Samaritan and laid hands on them, and they received Holy Spirit. And when Paul said, laid hands on those 12 men, they received Holy Spirit. And it was evidence by speaking in tongues. So there's that idea.

So then the guy said, now what's going to happen to you is you need to do a couple of things. And basically what he told me was this, and I've actually heard this taught him more than one occasion. And I don't have time to expound on this fully. But basically he said to put your mind in neutral, and with your tongue pressed on the gas. You understand the application to that. He's telling me you are about to speak in tongues if you're open to receiving the spirit, but your mind's going to get in the way. So just release yourself, take away any inhibitors, don't think about it, just release. Because I'm a little bit dubious anytime I'm told to shut down my mind. I can't find anywhere in New Testament or Paul ever suggested that. But we'll get to that later some other day. Anyway, okay, okay. So it was almost the view here Eastern religion.

It was empty your mind. I was, okay, empty my mind. I didn't do this, but empty my mind. And the guys were laying hands on me, and they all began to speak in tongues. And identified as kind of an ecstatic gibberish. Each person in this understanding contemporary view each has their own personal prayer language directly to God. The God gets it. And if you've been in a room and I've been in a room where you have multiple tongue speakers and individual tongue speakers and I used to speak in tongues, everyone sounds different. And I can mimic it for you right now. Although it's considered a miracle in New Testament, if I could do it for you right now, does that tell you anything? Maybe it's not miraculous. And anyway, he told me that, you know, he told me, you're not a complete Christian yet. You need the full gospel. The full gospel is receiving the gift of Holy Spirit. So I'm not thinking, okay, I don't have a Holy Spirit yet. What I get is, this is going to be great. And I'm going to know it when I start speaking in tongues. So they all stand around me and begin to speak in tongues. Notice there's kind of suggestion just by the very nature of it. And I'm hearing them all speaking in tongues. So they can do it. In other words, it breaks down the natural inhibitions that any of us would have. And again, I already have an inclination to want this. And that was, I'd already crossed several bridges before I got to this moment. And I was just kind of ready for it to take place. And it was basically, I said, I'm going to go right out. Well, I just spoke in tongues in front of you, which is very similar to what I used to do back when I was really speaking in tongues. Well, I thought I was.

And they were all doing their own language. So they're all doing this. And I'm sitting here, and they got hands laid on me. And I'm ready. I'm serious. I don't want to tell you. I'm being very honest with you. Let's get home with this. So, you know, my mind started traveling, saying, okay, okay, okay. And of course, my first thoughts, what's wrong with me? Because there wasn't an immediate response. I wasn't speaking in tongues. So I heard what the guy said, he said, put your mind in neutral. Get your mind out of the way. If you think about too much, you won't do it. And I'm thinking, why? Why? Why do you think about too much? I mean, was that a problem with the Ephesians? Was that an issue to the Samaritans? Was that an issue to the apostles? They just started doing it. It doesn't matter whether they were thinking about it or not. In fact, they were there devoted and praying to God. They were thinking very clearly. It seemed to me. But that I came, those are conclusions I came to later on. So, I said, well, maybe it might just release and just start doing it. So, that's what I did. I'm very, and you know, it said, the embarrassment wasn't there because everyone was doing it. It was cool to do it then. And so, and so I, it's kind of to myself, I knew I was doing it. They could hear me do it because they were speaking so loud. And because, you know, the sing song was kind of surrounding me. And finally,

you know, I just kind of unleashed. I let it go. And after about a minute of me going and them going together, obviously it was understood by one of the room and myself that it happened.

Because I was tend to be speaking in tongues. Therefore, that was evident that I had received the Holy Spirit. And it was. It was a great experience. I'm not mocking it. I'm just saying that that's what I did. And I didn't have feelings of electricity. I didn't have levitation. I didn't have any bizarre events that unquestionably suggested, boy, God, this is really unique with you. It was a very normal, baptism in the Holy Spirit, which was more common to what I've experienced and talked to other people who have been through the experience. And but very genuine. I was very open to it. And so, you know, that's the spirit. If you let it into my life, I'm now a new person. I was I was on fire for God. It came back to Auburn University. And I was ready to save the world.

And could I kind of felt that way before I came there? But I was even more convinced. And basically, I've kind of sold out now. Let's get on with it. And, you know, this was real than I'm ready. And so I came. And the group, Maranatha, was on campus. You can look it up in Google it. Maranatha was a well-known campus ministry program around the nation headed by Bob Weiner, who was a Messianic Jew, a very strong charismatic environment, but like a military charismatic, versus the butterfly charismatic. So it was not just, you know, night, but it was like, here's a very specific way of living. And this is expected of you, basically, you were to sell out and give all your possessions to the movement and move into the house. And they had a house that was an old fraternity house over there in Magnolia Street, where I think Chick-fil-A is now. And basically, they recruited and people lived in the house. They've given all their goods and everything to the people. And then they usually got shipped off to the other campus going elsewhere. And separated families, a lot of things happened. It was registered amongst the cults in America. And I came that close moving into the house. And I had another charismatic person saying, you think you need to think about this, because they were differentiating.

They're different kind of charismatic movements, and this one may not be healthy for you. And I said, why? But anyway, at that juncture, they wanted to baptize me again. This time, I went through a water baptism, and then they lay hands on me again, and then I was prophesied over. So, you know, I'm pretty confused at this juncture. But, you know, bring it on. I just, well, it's whatever, because whatever it is, I want it. And if you don't think I've got it fully yet, I'll have it again. And so I went through a couple times. And, you know, there were both interesting experiences. You know, it is what it is. No one put a gun to my head. No one tied me up and did these things to me. I chose these things. But I was clearly, you know, bewildered on some things. But I was doing the best I knew how to do. I can tell you, my heart was right.

I'm still a simple person. I was a mess. But I was, you know, moving toward God, and that's the reason I did these things. Of course, in the aftermath of all this, I'm still trying to pick up the pieces and trying to find, okay, now, I have these experiences, and I don't deny the experience, what I'm trying to figure out is the discomfort from God or not. And I was still going to, you know, a charismatic pinnacle of churches. It was rather a lively environment. A whole lot more lively than our rather dull environments of church to Christ many times. And some of that was rather welcoming. I'll be quite honest with you. But, you know, they literally dancing in the aisle where I was in the church. And I took my late tambourine and got in the chair and just went nuts. And I loved it. See, she was great. If you weren't fired up for you, you have fired up for you. He said, next to her, you don't know why, but you were. But I had to start working through all of this. And because in all honesty, I also knew, well, okay, this, this, and this.

But when I start to really think about it, not trying to get my mind in the way of God, but trying to think about God and how God's spoken, and what is he actually said, and I started looking to the scriptures, I said, well, I don't know. Some things just aren't jiving. And then all honesty, I spoke in tongues, but I, you know, it was either there was something wrong with me, and I was denying quenching the spirit, which is to phrase use, people like this.

In other words, you're just not open to God. You're just not doing it right. And again, I didn't see the effigions having to face that. I didn't see the pulses having to face that. I didn't see the, the Gentiles faces. I just knew that when they did it, they did it, and they knew it was real. And I don't know. All I know is my heart was hungry. And I'd yielded and surrender, as much as I know how to yield the surrender at that moment in my life. And yet, you know, I did speak in tongues. I practiced it. I carried on the other activities of this. This used to prophecies and all the above. But when I began to look at consistency with it, and really looking to mirror honesty about, well, it's really from God, and there was nothing that I could tangibly say, I know that was from God. And then it began, my studies have again realized that every major religion in the world has its tongue speakers, and that kind of caught me. And we'll talk about that in the next week. But if the same phenomenon is spoken about people who are followers of Krishna, and followers of the Hindu gods, and the followers of Buddha, and the followers of the, you know, the various sects and cults and world religion, just having the experience doesn't necessarily validate it from being God, because there's all sorts of gods that are claiming the same exact phenomenon, ecstatic language speaking in tongues.

And so I said, okay, so how did they know that it was from God? And I doubt. See the question? And I knew when they had it, they knew it. And so it naturally led me to some questions and doubts and thus the long term getting into scriptures and trying to figure out, okay, has God spoken what exactly has he said? And I had the choice. I had to allow the scriptures to define my experience, or I'll have to allow my experiences to define scriptures. And those two ways lead to very different results. You understand? And I knew this, and I would strongly advocate, let the scriptures define your experience. Do not let your experience define scriptures. And doesn't make the world easy, and it doesn't make everything simple, but I know it's the right direction. And it helped me kind of navigate some things. And for me, as I resolved all of this after multiple events, I decided that although tongues speaking does have a psychological releasing, you could even argue therapeutic event, it wasn't a miraculous event. And while I had this experience of receiving the Holy Spirit, I decided that I already had the Holy Spirit. It's hard to receive again what you already possess. And so as I began to look at scriptures and look at my experience, which again, there was nothing miraculous to anything I did. I could do it right in front of you, and I can mimic it right in front of everything I just said. And do it very genuinely, and honestly, I'm not trying to do anybody. And no one who was doing this to me was trying to do me. Everyone was very sincere about this process. This just comes down to, yes, is it from God or not?

And if it's not from God, then I wouldn't suggest you chase after it. It's just a preoccupation. There are things to do with your time and effort. And if it is of God, then everyone is room ought to go pursue it right now. And that's since there is no, there is a black and white world there. Either it either is or it ain't. There's no, it's only for some people. That's not what being taught. That's not what being suggested. And so you have to resolve this in your mind, because at least the very practical implications for your life and how you believe the Spirit is active, whether you have the Spirit, what he's doing in your life and how he's doing it. And I come back to the edit, the mantra of this class, the Spirit's work is centered in Jesus Christ.

Did that event make me more like Jesus? No, not really. It did make me less like Jesus, but it did make me more like Him. It was just an experience that was associated with Christianity in this case. And so anyway, there it is. Obviously we can move a lot of places and don't want to bore it, but some of you want to know, so there it is. Next week, I want to pick up with the issue of miracles. An interesting discussion. I believe in miracles. I also believe that the Bible defines them in certain ways. There are certain things in miracles and certain things that are not. And there's a purpose behind them, a specific nature to them. And again, there's a lot of people claiming lots of things even today. And I might remind you that part of those experiences are the things I showed you in that videotape, the Toronto Blessing, training the devil, swooning in the Spirit, speaking in tongues, the holy laughter, the holy jerks, all those things go together.

How do you know the Spirit of God is active? Those are all experiential things and everyone goes there to say, God made me do this. This is a Christian experience. I would be who it would be who viewed to figure it out. Maybe I want to look at the issue of miracles and try to at least point a very strong direction with that and we'll deal with that for two weeks and we're done. Okay? Let's pray. Father, we are thankful and we are receptive to everything you want in our life. Often we are resistant. Our hearts are hard. Our heart and stubborn. But you've given us your word. You pointed and defined life for us and we're trying to work through some things and figure it out. I asked Father as we stayed devoted to abiding in your word that you will indeed set us free, body, soul and spirit and that you will fill us with your spirit and that you will as we open our lives to you lead us into having the life and experiences in life that you design for us and we do not wish in any way to quench your Holy Spirit to be resistant to grieve Him and we ask that you educate us and motivate us and Father in what ways you can intervene in our life to bring about the fullness of Jesus and us. Again, we are thankful for Jesus who showed us the way. We pioneered all of this for us. We simply follow in his steps.

He received the Spirit. May we receive it in the same way. In Jesus' name we pray. Amen. Thank you.

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